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Kamen; Dean et al.

Pumping fluid delivery systems and methods using force application assembly

Abstract

A method of dispensing a therapeutic fluid from a line includes providing an inlet line connectable to an upstream fluid source. The inlet line is in downstream fluid communication with a pumping chamber. The pumping chamber has a pump outlet. The method also includes actuating a force application assembly so as to restrict retrograde flow of fluid through the inlet while pressurizing the pumping chamber to urge flow through the pump outlet. A corresponding system employs the method.

Inventors: Kamen; Dean (Bedford, NH), Gray; Larry Brian (Merrimack, NH), Yeaton; Eric (Epsom, NH)
Applicant: DEKA Products Limited Partnership (Manchester, NH)
Family ID: 38805798
Assignee: DEKA PRODUCTS LIMITED PARTNERSHIP (Manchester, NH)
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Primary Examiner: Stimpert; Philip E

Attorney, Agent or Firm: McCormick, Paulding & Huber PLLC

Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/227,892 filed Apr. 12, 2021, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/082,579 filed on Nov. 18, 2013, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 11/704,896 filed on Feb. 9, 2007, which claims the benefit of provisional application 60/772,313, filed Feb. 9, 2006, provisional application 60/789,243, filed Apr. 5, 2006, and provisional application 60/793,188, filed Apr. 19, 2006, each of which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) This application relates generally to pumping fluid delivery systems and methods using force application assembly.

BACKGROUND

- (2) Many potentially valuable medicines or compounds, including biologicals, are not orally active due to poor absorption, hepatic metabolism or other pharmacokinetic factors. Additionally, some therapeutic compounds, although they can be orally absorbed, are sometimes required to be administered so often it is difficult for a patient to maintain the desired schedule. In these cases, parenteral delivery is often employed or could be employed.
- (3) Effective parenteral routes of drug delivery, as well as other fluids and compounds, such as subcutaneous injection, intramuscular injection, and intravenous (IV) administration include puncture of the skin with a needle or stylet. Insulin is an example of a therapeutic fluid that is self-injected by millions of diabetic patients. Users of parenterally delivered drugs would benefit from a wearable device that would automatically deliver needed drugs/compounds over a period of time.
- (4) To this end, there have been efforts to design portable devices for the controlled release of therapeutics. Such devices are known to have a reservoir such as a cartridge, syringe, or bag, and to be electronically controlled. These devices suffer from a number of drawbacks including the malfunction rate. Reducing the size, weight and cost of these devices is also an ongoing challenge.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(5) In one embodiment, the present invention provides a method of dispensing a therapeutic fluid from a line. The method includes providing an inlet line connectable to an upstream fluid source. The inlet line is in downstream fluid communication with a pumping chamber. The pumping chamber has a pump outlet. The method also includes actuating a force application assembly so as to restrict retrograde flow of fluid through the inlet while

pressurizing the pumping chamber to urge flow through the pump outlet.

(6) In a related embodiment, actuating the force application assembly includes using travel of the force application assembly during a work stroke to restrict retrograde flow and to pressurize the pumping chamber in a single mechanical action. In a further related embodiment, a given degree of travel of the force actuation assembly restricts retrograde flow, and a greater degree of travel pressurizes the pumping chamber.

(7) In a further related embodiment, actuating the force application assembly includes restricting retrograde flow toward the fluid source by occluding the inlet line. Alternatively or in addition, the method also includes preventing reverse flow of fluid from a dispensing chamber into the pumping chamber by using a passive valve placed therebetween.

(8) Optionally actuating the force application assembly includes using a shape-memory actuator. Also optionally, using the shape-memory actuator includes inducing a phase change in a shape memory wire to transmit a force around a pulley to the force application assembly.

(9) In a further embodiment, the method further includes measuring a parameter related to flow through the line; and adjusting operation of the pump based on the measured parameter. Optionally measuring the parameter related to flow through the line includes determining a change in volume of a resilient chamber disposed downstream of the pumping chamber. Optionally, measuring the parameter includes using acoustic volume measurement.

(10) In a further embodiment, a tortuous flow-impedance located downstream of the resilient chamber supplies a fluid impedance sufficient to cause the resilient chamber to expand in response to pumping.

(11) Alternatively or in addition, the method further includes causing fluid to flow downstream from the pump outlet through a tortuous flow-impeding conduit. The conduit may have various forms. It may have at least two turns. It may be coiled. It may have a serpentine shape. Optionally, the conduit has a length and an internal diameter selected to provide a predetermined impedance based on at least one of a viscosity and a density of the fluid. Optionally the internal diameter of the conduit is sufficiently large so as to prevent occlusion due to flow of the fluid through the conduit.

(12) In a further embodiment, the inlet line, the pumping chamber, the pump outlet and the force application assembly are enclosed inside a patch-sized housing, and actuating the force application assembly includes using a processor inside the housing to cause actuation of the force application assembly.

(13) Optionally, the housing has a largest dimension, and the conduit has a length greater than the largest dimension.

(14) In a further embodiment, actuating the force application assembly includes inducing using a shape memory actuator. Optionally, using a shape memory actuator includes using one of a plurality of electrical paths of different lengths through the shape-memory actuator, and each electrical path provides a different actuation force.

(15) In a further embodiment, the force application assembly has a normal mode for normal operation in urging flow through the pump outlet and a priming mode for priming the pumping chamber. In this embodiment, using the shape memory actuator includes using a shorter electrical path of the shape-memory actuator during the normal mode of the force application assembly and using a longer electrical path of the shape-memory actuator during the priming mode of the force application assembly.

(16) In a further embodiment, the force application assembly has a normal mode for normal operation in urging flow through the pump outlet and a priming mode for priming the pumping chamber. In this embodiment, using the shape memory actuator includes using a shorter shape-memory actuator during the basal mode of the force application assembly and a longer shape-memory actuator is used during the bolus mode of the force application assembly.

(17) In a further embodiment, actuating the force application assembly includes inducing using a plurality of shape memory actuators. Optionally, using a plurality of shape memory actuators includes using them to provide for redundant operation. Optionally, using a plurality of shape memory actuators includes using different numbers of shape-memory actuators to provide different actuation forces, stroke lengths or both. Optionally, using a plurality of shape memory actuators includes using shape-memory actuators of at least two different lengths.

(18) In a further embodiment, the force application assembly has a normal mode for normal operation in urging flow through the pump outlet and a priming mode for priming the pumping chamber. In this embodiment, using a plurality of shape memory actuators includes using a shorter shape-memory actuator during the normal mode of the force application assembly and using longer shape-memory actuator during the priming mode of the force application assembly.

(19) Optionally, using a plurality of shape memory actuators includes using shape-memory actuators of at least two different gauges.

(20) In another embodiment, the invention provides a system for pumping fluid through a line. In this embodiment, the system includes a pumping chamber having an inlet connectable to provide fluid communication with a fluid source, and a pump outlet. The system also includes a force application assembly adapted to provide a compressive stroke to the pumping chamber. In this embodiment, the compressive stroke causes a restriction of retrograde flow of fluid from the pumping chamber through the inlet while urging fluid from the pumping chamber to the pump outlet.

(21) Optionally, the force application assembly is coupled to an inlet valve actuator and to a pump actuator, so that the compressive stroke actuates an inlet valve coupled between the inlet and the fluid source to close the valve when the pump actuator causes fluid to be urged from the pumping chamber to the pump outlet.

(22) Optionally, the force application assembly includes a plate coupled to the valve actuator, to the pump actuator, and to a motor for coordinated operation of the valve actuator and the pump actuator. Optionally, the motor includes a shape-memory actuator. Also optionally, the motor includes at least one pulley for folding the shape-memory actuator to fit within the reusable portion. Optionally, the force application assembly includes a motor.

(23) In a further related embodiment, the motor includes a shape-memory actuator. Optionally, the shape-memory actuator is electrically coupled so as to provide a plurality of electrical paths of different lengths through the shape-memory actuator, each electrical path providing a different actuation force. Optionally, the force application assembly has a normal mode for operating the pumping chamber under normal pumping conditions and a priming mode for priming the pumping chamber; in this circumstance a shorter electrical path of the shape-memory actuator is used during the normal mode of the force application assembly and a longer electrical path is used during the priming mode of the force application assembly.

(24) In another related embodiment, the motor includes a plurality of shape-memory actuators. Optionally, the plurality of shape-memory actuators provide for redundant operation of the force application assembly. Optionally, different numbers of shape-memory actuators are used to provide different actuation forces, stroke lengths or both. Optionally, the plurality of shape-memory actuators includes shape-memory actuators of at least two different lengths. Optionally, the force application assembly has a normal mode for operating the pumping chamber under normal pumping conditions and a priming mode for priming the pumping chamber; in this circumstance, a shorter shape-memory actuator is used during the normal mode of the force application assembly and a longer shape-memory actuator is used during the priming mode of the force application assembly.

(25) In a further related embodiment, the plurality of shape-memory actuators includes shape-memory actuators of at least two different gauges.

(26) A yet further related embodiment additionally includes a downstream dispensing assembly in series with the pump outlet. In this embodiment, the dispensing assembly includes a resilient dispensing chamber. Optionally, the embodiment further includes a sensor for measuring a parameter related to flow through the line. Optionally, the pumping chamber, the inlet the outlet, and the force actuation assembly are components of a fluid delivery device sized to be worn as a patch.

(27) In a further related embodiment, the system additionally includes a tortuous high-impedance conduit located downstream of the dispensing assembly. The conduit may be implemented in a variety of ways. It may have at least two turns. It may be coiled. It may have a serpentine shape. Optionally, the conduit has a length and an internal diameter selected to provide a predetermined impedance based on at least one of a viscosity and a density of a fluid. Optionally, the internal diameter of the conduit is sufficiently large so as to prevent occlusion due to flow of a therapeutic liquid through the conduit.

(28) In a further related embodiment, the system further includes a passive valve for enforcing unidirectional flow toward the output. Optionally, the passive valve is positioned downstream of the pumping chamber. Optionally the passive valve is positioned upstream of the dispensing assembly.

(29) In a further related embodiment, at least a portion of the line is integral to a disposable component, and the force application assembly is integral to a detachable reusable component, and membrane material on the disposable component is contiguous to the reusable component. Optionally, the membrane material overlies regions in the line that define the pumping chamber, an inlet valve, and a passive valve for enforcing unidirectional flow toward the output. Optionally, the force application assembly causes application of deforming forces to the membrane material overlying each of the regions defining the valves to effectuate closing of the valves. Optionally, the force application assembly causes application of a deforming force to the membrane material overlying the region defining the pumping chamber to effectuate urging of fluid from the pumping chamber.

(30) In a further related embodiment, the force application assembly effects sealing of the inlet prior to compression of the pumping chamber to urge flow through the outlet. Optionally, the force application member comprises an inlet sealing member and a pump compressing member. The force application member may include a driving member that actuates the pump compressing member and also actuates the inlet sealing member. To actuate the inlet sealing member, the driving member may compress a sealing spring so as to increasingly load the sealing spring even while the pump compressing member exerts a pumping force upon the pumping chamber.

(31) In a further embodiment, the system further includes a driving member that actuates both the inlet sealing member and the pump compressing member, the inlet sealing member including a sealing spring positioned between the driving member and an integral support of the sealing member. The inlet sealing member is slidably seated in an opening of the driving member. The pump compressing member includes a return spring positioned between a distal compressing member support and the driving member. In this embodiment, during a work stroke, the driving member compresses the sealing spring to transmit a driving force to the sealing member via the integral support while the driving member slides along a shaft of the sealing member, even while driving the pump compressing member toward the pumping chamber.

(32) In a further related embodiment, the sealing spring is compressed even while the pump compressing member exerts a pumping force upon the pumping chamber.

(33) Optionally, the compressing member further includes a distal stop that limits the return stroke via contact with the support. Optionally, the sealing member includes a proximal extension that extends beyond the opening of the driving member so that during the return stroke, the driving member engages and displaces the extension to allow flow through the inlet.

(34) In a further related embodiment, the force application assembly is actuated by a shape memory actuator. Optionally, the passive valve includes a poppet biased against a seated membrane by a poppet biasing spring. Optionally, a mechanical advantage favors lifting of the poppet.

(35) In another embodiment, the invention provides a valve for unidirectional flow. In this embodiment, the valve includes a first portion having an inlet and an outlet, the outlet having a circumferentially disposed valve seat; a second portion having a force application member; and a membrane separating the first and second portions. In this embodiment, the force application member applies a biasing force to sealingly hold the membrane against the valve seat so as to restrict flow to the outlet or from the outlet, unless fluid pressure in either the inlet or the outlet is sufficient to overcome the biasing force, thereby unseating the membrane from the valve seat and establishing flow through the valve. Also in this embodiment, when the membrane is sealingly held to the valve seat, fluid upstream of the inlet contacts a larger area of the membrane than does fluid downstream of the outlet, thereby giving greater mechanical advantage to the upstream fluid and causing the valve to open in response to a lower pressure at the inlet and to a higher pressure in the outlet, and encouraging unidirectional flow from the inlet and to the outlet.

(36) In a further related embodiment, the first portion is a disposable portion and the second portion is a reusable portion. Optionally, the force application member further includes a spring and a poppet. Optionally, the valve further includes a mechanism for adjusting the spring force.

(37) These aspects of the invention are not meant to be exclusive and other features, aspects, and advantages of the present invention will be readily apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art when read in conjunction with the appended claims and accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The foregoing features of the invention will be more readily understood by reference to the following detailed description, taken with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 depicts a patient with a patch and a wireless handheld user interface assembly;

(3) FIG. 2A is a schematic diagram of a fluid-delivery device with feedback control;

(4) FIG. 2B is a schematic diagram of a fluid-delivery device with feedback control and a reservoir;

(5) FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram of a fluid-delivery device having an un-pressurized reservoir;

(6) FIGS. 4A, 4B, and 4C are schematic sectional diagrams of various embodiments of a flow restrictor;

(7) FIG. 5 shows a resilient dispensing assembly in series with a flow restrictor;

(8) FIG. 6 shows a dispensing assembly having a metering chamber and a sensor;

(9) FIG. 7 shows a dispensing assembly having a metering chamber with a dispensing spring and a sensor;

(10) FIG. 8 shows a sectional view of a dispensing assembly with an alternate acoustic path;

(11) FIG. 9 shows a schematic view of a dispensing assembly;

(12) FIG. 10 shows a diaphragm spring for use with a resilient variable-volume dispensing chamber;

(13) FIG. 11A shows a kinetic profile of an exemplary basal fluid delivery;

(14) FIG. 11B shows a kinetic profile of an exemplary bolus fluid delivery;

(15) FIG. 11C shows kinetic data representing a normal fluid delivery;

(16) FIGS. 11D, 11E, and 11F show kinetic data representing various fault conditions;

(17) FIG. 12 shows a flow chart of a sensing and reacting process of an embodiment of the fluid delivery device;

(18) FIG. 13 shows a block diagram of a fluidic line with a pressure generation assembly;

(19) FIG. 14 shows a block diagram of a fluidic line with a valving pump;

(20) FIGS. 15A, 15B, 15C, and 15D show schematic diagrams of a pumping mechanism;

(21) FIG. 16 shows a schematic diagram of a pumping mechanism;

(22) FIG. 17 schematically shows a sectional view of an embodiment that includes a shape-memory-wire actuator capable of multiple pumping modes;

(23) FIG. 18 schematically shows a sectional view of an embodiment that includes two shape-memory actuators and is capable of multiple pumping modes;

(24) FIG. 19 schematically shows a sectional view of an embodiment that includes shape-memory actuators of differing lengths;

(25) FIGS. 20A and 20B schematically show embodiments for attaching a shape memory actuator;

(26) FIGS. 21A and 21B schematically show embodiments for attaching a shape memory actuator to a pumping mechanism;

(27) FIGS. 22 and 23 show pumping mechanisms employing a finger;

(28) FIG. 24 shows a pumping mechanism employing rotating projections;

(29) FIG. 25 shows a pumping mechanism employing a plunger and barrel;

(30) FIG. 26 shows a view of a shape-memory actuator in an expanded state;

(31) FIG. 27 shows a view of a shape-memory actuator in a contracted state;

(32) FIG. 28 shows a view of a pumping assembly employing a plunger and barrel, and a shape-memory motor having a lever;

(33) FIG. 29 shows a view of a pumping assembly employing a plunger and barrel, and a shape-memory motor;

(34) FIG. 30 shows a view of a pumping device employing a plunger and barrel and a shape-memory motor having a wire in a shaft of the plunger;

(35) FIG. 31 shows a flow line embodiment with a combined pump and reservoir;

(36) FIG. 32 schematically shows a sectional view of a valving pump in a resting position;

(37) FIG. 33 schematically shows a sectional view of the valving pump of FIG. 32 in an intermediate position;

(38) FIG. 34 schematically shows a sectional view of the valving pump of FIG. 32 in an actuated position;

(39) FIG. 35 schematically shows a sectional view of a pumping diaphragm for use in a valving pump;

(40) FIG. 36 shows a perspective view of a diaphragm spring for use in a pumping diaphragm;

(41) FIG. 37 schematically shows a sectional view of a valving pump employing a lever and a shape memory wire actuator;

(42) FIG. 38 schematically shows a sectional view of an embodiment that includes a valving pump which employs a resilient cylindrical flexure;

(43) FIG. 39 schematically shows a sectional view of an embodiment that includes a valving pump flexure having a resilient member and a rigid support;

(44) FIG. 40 schematically shows a sectional view of a valving pump, in a resting state, with a diaphragm spring upstream of a flexible membrane;

(45) FIG. 41 schematically shows a sectional view of the valving-pump of FIG. 40, in an intermediate state;

(46) FIG. 42 schematically shows a sectional view of the valving-pump of FIG. 40, in an actuated state;

(47) FIG. 43 schematically shows a sectional view of a valving-pump with a diaphragm spring upstream of a flexible membrane, in which a flexible membrane is circumferentially attached to a force application member;

(48) FIG. 44 schematically shows a sectional view of a valving-pump with a diaphragm spring upstream of a flexible membrane, which includes a rigid ball for transmitting force;

(49) FIG. 45 schematically shows a sectional view of an embodiment that includes a valving pump having a resilient pump blade;

(50) FIG. 46 schematically shows a sectional view of an embodiment that includes an alternative version of a resilient pump blade for use with a valving pump;

(51) FIG. 47 schematically shows a sectional view of an embodiment that includes a valving pump having multiple force application members;

(52) FIG. 48 schematically shows, in a resting or filling mode, a pumping mechanism including a bell-crank driven valving-pump and a flow-biasing valve;

(53) FIG. 49 schematically shows the pumping mechanism of FIG. 48 in an actuated state.

(54) FIG. 50 schematically shows a sectional view of a flow-biasing valve in accordance with an embodiment of the invention having a raised valve seat and in a closed position;

(55) FIG. 51 schematically shows a sectional view of the flow-biasing valve of FIG. 50 in an open position;

(56) FIG. 52 schematically shows a sectional view of a flow-biasing valve in accordance with an embodiment of the invention without a raised valve seat and in an open position;

(57) FIG. 53 schematically shows a sectional view of the flow-biasing valve of FIG. 52, in a closed position;

(58) FIG. 54 schematically shows forces that act upon a poppet in the vicinity of a valve outlet in accordance with embodiments of the invention;

(59) FIG. 55 schematically shows, in close-up view, forces that act upon a poppet in the vicinity of a valve inlet in accordance with embodiments of the invention;

(60) FIG. 56 schematically shows a flow-biasing valve with an adjustable cracking pressure in accordance with an embodiment of the invention;

(61) FIGS. 57 and 58 show schematics for flow lines utilizing un-pressurized reservoirs;

(62) FIGS. 59A, 59B, 59C, 59D, and 59E shows schematics of a fluid flow in a fluid delivery device;

(63) FIGS. 60A, 60B, 60C, and 60D shows exploded schematics of the fluid flow in a fluid delivery device;

(64) FIGS. 61A, 61B, and 61C show schematics of a fluid flow in a fluid delivery device;

(65) FIGS. 62A and 62B show schematics of a stand alone device;

(66) FIGS. 63A, 63B, and 63C show cross sectional schematics of embodiments of a device;

(67) FIGS. 64A, 64B, 64C, and 64D show cross section schematics of embodiments of a device;

(68) FIGS. 65A and 65B show cross section schematics of embodiments of an infusion device connected to a fluid line;

(69) FIGS. 66A, 66B, 66C, and 66D show cross section schematics of a sequence of inserting a reservoir into a device;

(70) FIGS. 67A, 67B, 67C, 67D, 67E, and 67F show schematics of embodiments of the fluid delivery device;

(71) FIG. 68 is schematic of one embodiment of the portable pump embodiment of the device connected to a patient;

(72) FIGS. 69A and 69B show schematic views of the underside of the housing of a device;

(73) FIGS. 70, 70A, 70B, 70C, and 70D are a diagram depicting the various components available in embodiments of the fluid delivery device;

(74) FIG. 71 schematically shows components which may be assembled to create a fluid delivery device in accordance with an embodiment of the device;

(75) FIG. 72 shows a side view of a fluid-delivery device with an acoustic volume-measurement component;

(76) FIG. 73 shows a printed circuit board for acoustic volume measurement;

(77) FIG. 74 shows a pictorial view of an embodiment of a device;

(78) FIG. 75 shows a pictorial sectional view of an embodiment of fluid delivery device;

(79) FIG. 76 shows an exploded pictorial view of an embodiment of a fluid delivery device;

(80) FIG. 77 shows an exploded view of components which may be assembled to create one embodiment of a fluid delivery device;

(81) FIG. 78 shows an exploded view of an embodiment of the fluid delivery device;

(82) FIG. 79 shows a top view of a base of one embodiment of the fluid delivery device;

(83) FIG. 80 shows the underside of the top of one embodiment of the fluid delivery device;

(84) FIGS. 81A, 81B, and 81C show a sequence to illustrate the process of sandwiching the reservoir 20 between the top and base;

(85) FIG. 82 shows an exploded top view of a device;

(86) FIG. 83 shows an exploded view of the bottom of one embodiment of the device showing the fluid path assembly, the bottom housing and the membrane and adhesive;

(87) FIG. 84 shows a bottom view of the base showing a bottom view of a fluid path assembly;

(88) FIGS. 85A, 85B, 85C, and 85D show exploded, partially exploded and non-exploded views of an embodiment of a device;

(89) FIG. 86A shows a schematic of an infusion and sensor assembly having an infusion device and analyte sensor connected;

(90) FIG. 86B shows an exploded view of an infusion and sensor assembly as shown in FIG. 86A with introduction needles;

(91) FIGS. 87A, 87B, 87C, 87D, and 87E shows a sequence of an embodiment of the infusion and sensor assembly being inserted into a device;

(92) FIGS. 88A and 88B show one embodiment of an inserter device in a sequence with an infusion and sensor assembly;

(93) FIGS. 88C and 88D show a partial cut away view of the inserter in FIG. 88A-88B;

(94) FIG. 89A shows a front view of one embodiment of an inserter device for the insertion of an infusion and sensor assembly;

(95) FIG. 89B shows a rear view of insertion device of FIG. 89A;

(96) FIG. 90 shows a perspective view of one embodiment of a cartridge for an infusion and sensor assembly;

(97) FIGS. 91A, 91B, and 91C show perspective front and side views of an inserter device for insertion of infusion and sensor assembly;

(98) FIGS. 92A, 92B, 92C, 92D, 92E, and 92F schematically shows a temporal sequence for the operation of one embodiment of an inserter mechanism;

(99) FIG. 92G shows an inserter mechanism having a catch and a cocking lever in a closed position;

(100) FIG. 92H shows an inserter mechanism with a catch and a cocking lever in an open position;

(101) FIGS. 93A, 93B, and 93C show a time-series for the insertion of a cannula into a base of a fluid delivery device;

(102) FIGS. 94A, 94B, and 94C shows a temporal sequence for the insertion of a cannula into a base with co-incident connection of the cannula to a fluid line;

(103) FIG. 95 shows a top view of an adhesive patch for holding a fluid delivery device;

(104) FIG. 96 schematically shows a sectional view of a fluid-delivery device under an adhesive patch;

(105) FIG. 97 shows a perspective view of two overlapping adhesive patches for holding a fluid delivery device;

(106) FIG. 98 shows a top view of two semicircular adhesive patch portions;

(107) FIG. 99 shows a perspective view of two semicircular adhesive patch portions holding a fluid delivery device;

(108) FIG. 100 shows a perspective view of a semicircular adhesive patch portion being removed by a patient;

(109) FIG. 101 shows a perspective view of a fluid-delivery device being held against a patient using multiple adhesive members and tethers;

(110) FIG. 102A shows a clamp for assembling a device;

(111) FIG. 102B shows a base of a fluid delivery device having keyholes for inserting clamps;

(112) FIG. 102C shows a sectional view of a fluid delivery device assembled with a clamp;

(113) FIG. 103A shows a perspective view of a cam guide for use in assembling a fluid delivery device;

(114) FIG. 103B shows a top view of the cam guide of FIG. 103A;

(115) FIG. 103C shows a perspective view of a clamp pin for use in assembling a fluid delivery device;

(116) FIG. 103D shows an embodiment of a fluid delivery device assembled using a clamp pin and cam guide;

(117) FIG. 104 shows a sectional view of a collapsible reservoir in accordance with one embodiment;

(118) FIG. 105 shows a perspective view the reservoir of FIG. 104;

(119) FIGS. 106A, 106B, and 106C shows a series of steps for securing a septum to a cap to produce a reservoir in accordance with one embodiment;

(120) FIG. 107 shows a reservoir filling station in accordance with one embodiment;

(121) FIGS. 108A and 108B shows an embodiment of a reservoir filling station in both the open (108A) an closed (108B) positions;

(122) FIG. 109A shows a block diagram of one embodiment of a data acquisition and control scheme for an embodiment of the fluid delivery system;

(123) FIG. 109B shows a block diagram of one embodiment of a data acquisition and control scheme for an embodiment of the fluid delivery system

(124) FIG. 110A shows a flow chart describing the operation of a fluid delivery device according to one embodiment;

(125) FIG. 110B shows a flow chart describing the operation of a fluid delivery device according to one embodiment;

(126) FIG. 111 shows a block diagram of a user interface and fluid delivery component in wireless communication with each other;

(127) FIG. 112 shows a data flow diagram showing the use of an intermediate transceiver in accordance with one embodiment;

(128) FIG. 113 shows a block diagram for an intermediate transceiver in accordance with one embodiment;

(129) FIG. 114 shows a data flow diagram for a universal patient interface in accordance with one embodiment;

(130) FIG. 115 shows a non-disposable portion of the fluid delivery device and a battery recharger in an uncoupled state in accordance with one embodiment;

(131) FIG. 116 shows the non-disposable portion of the fluid delivery device and battery recharger of FIG. 115 in a docked state in accordance with one embodiment; and

(132) FIG. 117 is a flowchart depicting a process for measuring the volume of liquid delivered in a pump stroke, in accordance with an embodiment of the invention.

(133) It should be noted that the foregoing figures and the elements depicted therein are not necessarily drawn to a consistent scale or to any scale.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF SPECIFIC EMBODIMENTS

(134) Definitions. As used in this description and the accompanying claims, the following terms shall have the meanings indicated, unless the context otherwise requires:

(135) A “user input” of a device includes any mechanism by which a user of the device or other operator can control a function of the device. User inputs may include mechanical arrangements (e.g., switches, pushbuttons), wireless interfaces for communication with a remote controller (e.g., RF, infrared), acoustic interfaces (e.g., with speech recognition), computer network interfaces (e.g., USB port), and other types of interfaces.

(136) A “button” in the context of a user input such as the so-called “bolus button” discussed below may be any type of user input capable of performing a desired function, and is not limited to a pushbutton.

(137) An “alarm” includes any mechanism by which an alert can be generated to a user or third party. Alarms may include audible alarms (e.g., a speaker, a buzzer, a speech generator), visual alarms (e.g., an LED, an LCD screen), tactile alarms (e.g., a vibrating element), wireless signals (e.g., a wireless transmission to a remote controller or caretaker), or other mechanism. Alarms may be generated using multiple mechanisms simultaneously, concurrently, or in a sequence, including redundant mechanisms (e.g., two different audio alarms) or complementary mechanisms (e.g., an audio alarm, a tactile alarm, and a wireless alarm).

(138) “Fluid” shall mean a substance, a liquid for example, that is capable of flowing through a flow line.

(139) “Impedance” shall mean the opposition of a device or flow line to the flow of fluid therethrough.

(140) “Wetted” describes a component that comes into direct contact with the fluid during normal fluid delivery operations. Since a fluid is not limited to a liquid, a “wetted” component will not necessarily become wet.

(141) A “patient” includes a person or animal who receives fluid from a fluid delivery device, whether as part of a medical treatment or otherwise.

(142) “Cannula” shall mean a disposable device capable of infusing fluid to a patient. A cannula as used herein can refer to a traditional cannula or to a needle.

(143) “Analyte sensor” shall mean any sensor capable of determining the presence of an analyte in a patient. The embodiments of analyte sensors include, but are not limited to, sensors capable of determining the presence of any viral, parasitic, bacterial or chemical analyte. The term analyte includes glucose. An analyte sensor may communicate with other components within the fluid delivery device (e.g., a controller in a non-disposable portion) and/or with a remote controller.

(144) “Dispensing assembly sensor” shall mean a mechanism for determining the volume of fluid present in the dispensing chamber.

(145) A “sharp” shall mean anything that is capable of puncturing or poking an animal's skin, especially a human's skin. A Sharp may include a cannula, a cannula insertion device, an analyte sensor, or an analyte sensor insertion device. Sharps may be provided individually or may be provided together, for example, in a cartridge.

(146) “Disposable” refers to a part, device, portion or other that is intended to be used for a fixed duration of time, then discarded and replaced.

(147) “Non-disposable” refers to a reusable portion that is intended to have an open-ended duration of use.

(148) “Patch-sized” shall mean of a size sufficiently small as to be secured, by means such as adhesive or straps, to the skin of a patient and worn as a medical device over a course of administration of substance contained within the device. A medical device small enough to function as an implant is within the scope of this definition.

(149) “Normally present finite fluid impedance” shall mean a finite fluid impedance that is present in the routine course of fluid delivery, i.e., when a fault condition (e.g., an occlusion) is absent.

(150) A “passive” impedance is one that is not actively controlled during a pumping cycle.

(151) “Acoustic volume measurement” shall mean quantitative measurement of a relevant volume using acoustical techniques such as described in U.S. Pat. Nos. 5,349,852 and 5,641,892, as well as the techniques described herein.

(152) A “temperature sensor” includes any mechanism for measuring temperature and communicating temperature information to a controller. The device may include one or more temperature sensors for measuring such things as skin temperature, AVS temperature, ambient temperature, and fluid temperatures.

(153) Embodiments of the device, pumping mechanism, system and methods described herein relate to fluid delivery including pumping and volume measurement of fluid as well as the actuation and control of same. Embodiments of the device include a portable or non-portable device for fluid delivery. Some embodiments of the device include a base portion that is disposable and a top portion that is non-disposable. The device includes embodiments where an infusion device is inserted through the base portion and directly into a patient. These device embodiments are patch pump devices. The patch pump may be adhered to the patient using an adhesive, a strap, or other suitable arrangement. The adhesive may have a protective peelable strip which may be removed to expose the adhesive prior to use.

(154) However, in other embodiments, the fluid delivery device is a portable device where tubing is connected to a fluid line. The tubing is typically connected to a patient through a cannula.

(155) In some embodiments where a disposable base and non-disposable top are implemented, the base portion includes parts that are wetted, while the parts included in the non-disposable top portion are typically non-wetted parts.

(156) Various embodiments of the pumping mechanism include an upstream inlet valve, a pumping actuation member, a downstream exit valve and a moveable member. In some embodiments, the pumping actuation member and downstream valve functions are implemented using the same device. The pumping mechanism pumps fluid from a reservoir through a fluid line to an exit. The pumping mechanism is typically employed with a non-pressurized reservoir, however, the scope of the present invention is not limited accordingly.

(157) In one embodiment of the fluid delivery system, the device includes an analyte sensor housing. An analyte sensor is introduced into the patient through the analyte sensor housing of the base portion of the device. In these embodiments, an infusion device is also introduced through a cannula housing on the base portion of the device. In these embodiments, the device is worn by the user as a patch pump.

(158) The system typically includes a controller, which may include a wireless transceiver. Thus, the device may be controlled exclusively or in part through a wireless controller device. The controller device may receive information through wireless communication from the analyte sensor and/or the fluid delivery device. The patient or a third party can control the function of the fluid delivery device using the controller device.

(159) In one embodiment of the fluid delivery device, the device is an insulin pump and the analyte sensor is a blood glucose sensor. The controller, receiving information relating both to the volume of insulin delivered (or the number of pump strokes over time) and blood glucose data, assists the user in programming the actuation schedule for the pump mechanism.

(160) An exemplary dispensing assembly and volume sensing device is described herein. The dispensing assembly includes at least one microphone and a loudspeaker. The assembly determines the volume change in a dispensing chamber to determine the volume of fluid pumped. The volume sensing data is used to determine the status of the fluid delivery device. Thus, various controls may rely on the volume sensing data.

(161) In an embodiment of the invention, a user configures the fluid-delivery device via a user interface in order to cause the fluid-delivery device to deliver a fluid in an appropriate manner. In one embodiment, the user interface resides on a separate hand-held user-interface assembly that may communicate wirelessly with the patch. The patch may be disposable, or partially disposable.

(162) An exemplary use of embodiments of the device is for the delivery of insulin to diabetic patients, but other uses include delivery of any fluid, as described above. Fluids include analgesics to those in pain, chemotherapy to cancer patients and enzymes to patients with metabolic disorders. Various therapeutic fluids may include small molecules, natural products, peptide, proteins, nucleic acids, carbohydrates, nanoparticulate suspensions, and associated pharmaceutically acceptable carrier molecules. Therapeutically active molecules may be modified to improve stability in the delivery device (e.g., by pegylation of peptides or proteins). Although illustrative embodiments herein describe drug-delivery applications, embodiments may be used for other applications including liquid dispensing of reagents for high throughput analytical measurements such as lab-on-chip applications and capillary chromatography. For purposes of description below, terms “therapeutic” or “fluid” are used interchangeably, however, in other embodiments, any fluid, as described above, can be used. Thus, the device and description included herein are not limited to use with therapeutics.

(163) Typical embodiments include a reservoir for holding a supply of fluid. In the case of insulin, the reservoir may be conveniently sized to hold an insulin supply sufficient for delivery over one or more days. For example, a reservoir may hold about 1 to 2 ml of insulin. A 2 ml insulin reservoir may correspond to about 3 days supply for about 90% of potential users. In other embodiments, the reservoir can be any size or shape and can be adapted to hold any amount of insulin or other fluid. In some embodiments, the size and shape of the reservoir is related to the type of fluid the reservoir is adapted to hold. The fluid reservoir may be eccentrically or irregularly shaped and/or may be keyed in order to deter incorrect installation or usage.

(164) Some embodiments of the fluid delivery device are adapted for use by diabetics, thus, in these embodiments, the device delivers insulin which supplements or replaces the action of the patient's pancreatic islet beta cells. Embodiments adapted for insulin delivery seek to mimic the action of the pancreas by providing both a basal level of fluid delivery as well as bolus levels of delivery. Basal levels, bolus levels and timing can be set by the patient or another party by using a wireless handheld user interface. Additionally, basal and/or bolus levels can be triggered or adjusted in response to the output of an integral or external analyte sensor, such as a glucose monitoring device or blood glucose sensor. In some embodiments, a bolus can be triggered by a patient or third party using a designated button or other input means located on the fluid-delivery device. In still other embodiments, the bolus or basal can be programmed or administered through a user interface located on the fluid delivery device.

(165) FIG. 1 shows a patient 12 wearing a fluid-delivery device 10 and holding a wireless user interface assembly 14 for monitoring and adjusting operation of the fluid-delivery device 10, in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the present invention. The user interface assembly 14 typically includes apparatus for entering information (such as touch-screen or keypad) and for transmitting information to the user (such as an LCD display, a speaker or a vibrating alarm). The fluid delivery device is typically small and lightweight enough to remain comfortably adhered to the patient for several days.

(166) Although the fluid delivery device 10 is shown worn on the arm of a patient 12 in FIG. 1. In other embodiments, the fluid-delivery device 10 may be worn at other positions on the patient where the particular fluid being delivered can be utilized advantageously by the patient's body. For example, fluid may be delivered advantageously to the patient's abdominal area, kidney area, leg or otherwise.

(167) Referring now to FIG. 2A, a schematic representation of a fluid delivery device 10 having a feedback loop 360 from a dispensing assembly 120 to a pumping assembly 16 is shown. The pumping assembly 16 pumps fluid to the dispensing assembly 120; the fluid then exits through an exit assembly 17, which includes a flow restrictor 340 and an output. The output typically includes a cannula and leads to a patient. The dispensing assembly 120 may include a resilient, variable-volume dispensing chamber and at least one microphone and a loudspeaker for measuring parameters related to flow through the output over time. The feedback loop 360 allows adjustment of the operation of the pumping assembly 16 based on repeated measurements made by the sensor. The flow restrictor 340 creates high impedance between the dispensing assembly 120 and the output of the flow line 5010. The flow restrictor 340 could be, for example, a section of narrow-bore tubing or microtubing. Referring now to FIG. 2B, in one embodiment, the pumping assembly 16 pumps fluid from a reservoir 20 to a dispensing assembly 120.

(168) Referring now to FIG. 3, a block diagram of a further embodiment employing fluidic principles is shown. A flow line 310 couples a reservoir 20, a pumping assembly 16, a dispensing assembly 120, and an exit assembly 17. The exit assembly 17 may include a high impedance flow restrictor 340 and an infusion device 501—for example, a cannula. The output of the flow restrictor 340 is sent to the infusion device 501 for delivery to a patient. The flow restrictor 340 has a higher flow impedance than that of the portion of the flow line 310 upstream of the dispensing assembly 120. Therefore, the pumping assembly 16 is capable of pumping fluid into the dispensing assembly 120 faster than the fluid can exit the exit assembly 17. The dispensing assembly 120 may include a variable volume dispensing chamber 122 having a resilient wall. In embodiments presented below, the resilient wall is a membrane. Examples of membrane materials include silicone, NITRILE, and any other material having desired resilience and properties for functioning as described herein. Additionally, other structures could serve the same purpose. Upon receiving a charge of fluid as a result of the action of the pumping assembly 16, the resilience of the membrane will allow the chamber 122 to first expand and then to provide the delivery pressure required to drive the fluid contents of the dispensing assembly 120 past the flow restrictor 340 to a patient. When equipped with an appropriate sensor (examples of which are described below), the dispensing assembly 120 may measure fluid flow through the variable volume dispensing chamber 122 and may provide feedback through the feedback loop 360 to control the timing and/or rate at which the pumping assembly 16 pumps or partially fills the dispensing chamber 122, thereby delivering a desired dose at a desired rate to a patient.

(169) Referring again to FIG. 3, additionally, the flow restrictor 340 prevents fluid flow above a specified flow rate. Furthermore, since pressurized fluid delivery is accomplished through the interaction of the pumping assembly 16, the dispensing assembly 120, and the flow restrictor 340, a non pressurized reservoir 20 can be employed.

(170) Still referring to FIG. 3, the feedback loop 360 may include a controller 501. The controller 501 may include a processor and control circuitry for actuating a pumping assembly 16 to pump fluid to the dispensing assembly 120. The controller 501 repeatedly receives a parameter related to fluid flow from a sensor, which may be integral to the dispensing assembly 120, and uses this parameter to control the pumping assembly 16 to achieve a desired flow through the output. For example, the controller 501 can adjust the timing or extent of actuation of the pumping assembly 16 to achieve a desired basal or bolus flow rate and/or to deliver a desired basal or bolus cumulative dose. In determining the timing or extent of pumping, the controller 501 may use the output of the sensor (not shown) to estimate (amongst other things) the rate of fluid flow, cumulative fluid flow, or both, and then, based on the estimation, determine an appropriate compensatory action. In the various embodiments, pumping may occur in pulses which can deliver anywhere between 10-9 liters per pulse to microliters per pulse. A basal or bolus dose may be achieved by delivering multiple pulses. (Examples of basal and bolus dosing are shown and described below).

(171) The use of a partially collapsible non pressurized reservoir 20 may advantageously prevent the buildup of air in the reservoir as the fluid in the reservoir is depleted. The reservoir 20 may be connected to the fluid line 310 through a septum (not shown). Air buildup in a vented reservoir could prevent fluid egress from the reservoir 20, especially if the system is tilted so that an air pocket intervenes between the fluid contained in the reservoir and the septum of the reservoir 20. Tilting of the system is expected during normal operation as a wearable device. FIGS. 104-106C depict various embodiments and views of one embodiment of the reservoir. Additionally, further description of the reservoir is included below.

(172) Referring now to FIGS. 4A-4C, various embodiments of the flow restrictor 340 are shown. Referring now to FIG. 4A, the flow restrictor is a molded flow channel 340, which may be a molded groove in a base (not shown). In one embodiment, the cross section of the molded flow channel 340 is approximately 0.009 inches. In this embodiment, the flow restrictor 340 is molded into an apparatus. Referring now to FIG. 4B, microtubing 340 is shown as an alternate embodiment flow restrictor. In one embodiment, the microtubing has an internal diameter of approximately 0.009 inches. Both the molded flow channel and the microtubing use a long path having a small internal diameter or cross section to impart flow impedance. Referring now to FIG. 4C, a precision orifice is shown as a flow restrictor 340. In one embodiment, the precision orifice is a plate with a laser drilled hole. In alternate embodiments, any flow impedance device or method known in the art can be used.

(173) In contrast to prior-art fluid delivery systems that have an active downstream valve, which may be generally considered to create, in a functional sense, an infinite fluid impedance, the flow restrictor 340 creates a finite fluid impedance. The impedance is also normally present; in contrast to prior-art systems that may occasionally be impeded due to an occlusion. As a result of the finite nature of the fluid impedance, in embodiments that include a dispensing chamber 122, fluid may leak through the exit even while the dispensing chamber 122 is expanding.

(174) FIGS. 5-8 schematically show sectional views of illustrative embodiments of the dispensing assembly 120. It is to be understood that the delivery of fluid for other purposes, such as industrial processes, is within the scope of the present invention, and that the description in particular terms is by way of example only. As shown in FIG. 5, the dispensing assembly 120 may include the variable volume dispensing chamber 122 and a sensor 550. The variable volume dispensing chamber 122 includes a resilient dispensing diaphragm 125, which allows the chamber 122 to expand and contract depending on the flow of fluid into and out of the dispensing assembly 120. In certain embodiments of the invention, the variable-volume dispensing chamber 122 may be detachable from other elements of the dispensing assembly 120, as further discussed herein. The concept of the resilient dispensing diaphragm 125 allowing the chamber 122 to expand and contract is illustrated by the double headed arrow. Metering chamber 122 is considered to comprise a portion of a line 110 characterized by a fluid flow, which is designated, in FIG. 5, by arrow 112. Neither the position nor the nature of the termination of fluid flow 112 or line 110 need limit the scope of the present invention as claimed in certain of the claims appended hereto. The flow restrictor 340 causes fluid to leave the dispensing chamber 122 more slowly than fluid enters the chamber 122 when pumped into the chamber 122 by the pumping assembly 16. As a consequence, the dispensing chamber 122 expands and is pressurized as a fluid charge enters. Dispensing diaphragm 125, deformed by virtue of the expansion of dispensing chamber 122, provides the force needed to deliver the metered volume past the flow restrictor 340 to the exit assembly 17. As discussed above, the sensor 550 repeatedly measures a parameter, such as a displacement, or a thermodynamic variable or capacitance, that can be related to the volume of the resilient dispensing chamber 122. The volume measurements produced by the sensor 550 may be used to control, through a feedback loop, the timing and rate at which the pumping assembly pumps fluid to the dispensing chamber 122 so that the proper flow of fluid is delivered to exit assembly 17 and to a subsequent line, and thence, for example, to the patient. The sensor 550 may employ, for example, acoustic volume sensing (described in more detail below), or other methods (optical, or capacitive, for other examples) for determining a volume, or a volume-related parameter. Acoustic volume measurement technology is the subject of U.S. Pat. Nos. 5,575,310 and 5,755,683 assigned to DEKA Products Limited Partnership, as well as the co-pending provisional U.S. patent application entitled "METHOD OF VOLUME MEASUREMENT FOR FLOW CONTROL", Ser. No. 60/789,243, filed Apr. 5, 2006, all of which are hereby incorporated herein by reference. Fluid volume sensing in the nanoliter range is possible with this embodiment, thus contributing to highly accurate and precise monitoring and delivery. Other alternate techniques for measuring fluid flow may also be used; for example, Doppler-based methods; the use of Hall-effect sensors in combination with a vane or flapper valve; the use of a strain beam (for example, related to a flexible member over a fluid chamber to sense deflection of the flexible member); the use of capacitive sensing with plates; or thermal time of flight methods.

(175) Referring now to FIGS. 6 through 9, embodiments are shown in which a sensor utilizes acoustic volume sensing (AVS) technology. A first discussion refers to embodiments depicted in FIGS. 6 and 7. The dispensing assembly 120 has a sensor that includes a reference chamber 127, and a variable volume measurement chamber 121 that is coupled by a port 128 to a fixed-volume chamber 129. While the invention may be practiced with a reference chamber 127, as shown in FIGS. 6 and 7, in certain other embodiments of the invention, no reference volume is provided. It is to be understood that volume 129 is referred to, herein, as "fixed" as a matter of terminology, but that the actual volume may vary slightly, on the time scale of acoustic excitation, as when the region referred to as fixed volume 129 is driven by a speaker diaphragm. Fluid flows from the pumping assembly 16 to an input 123, through the resilient dispensing chamber 122, and out of an exit channel 124. Due to the high downstream impedance, as fluid enters the dispensing chamber 122, the dispensing diaphragm 125 expands into the variable volume chamber 121. An electronics assembly, which may be arranged on a printed circuit board 126, has a loudspeaker 1202, a sensing microphone 1203, and a reference microphone 1201 for measuring acoustic parameters associated with a gas (typically air) in the variable volume chamber 121, the volume of which is defined by the

position of the dispensing diaphragm 125. Sound waves induced by the loudspeaker 134 travel through the fixed volume chamber 129 to the variable volume chamber 121 via the port 128; sound waves also travel to the reference chamber 127. As the dispensing diaphragm 125 moves with the flow of fluid through the flow line, the volume of air in the variable volume chamber 121 varies, causing related changes in its acoustic characteristics, which may be detected by the loudspeaker and microphone 1203. For the same acoustic stimulations, the reference microphone 1201 may detect acoustic characteristics of the fixed reference volume 127. These reference measurements may, for example, be used to factor out imprecision and to reject common-mode inaccuracies in acoustic stimulation, and other errors. The volume of fluid displaced may be determined by comparing the measured volume of the variable volume chamber 121 to an initial volume of the variable volume chamber 121. Since the total combined volume of the dispensing chamber 122 and variable volume chamber 121 stays constant, the absolute volume of the dispensing chamber 122 can also be estimated.

(176) The embodiment shown in FIG. 6 utilizes an inherently resilient dispensing diaphragm 125, while the embodiment shown in FIG. 7 utilizes a resilient dispensing spring 130, which when combined with a dispensing diaphragm 125, increases the resiliency of the dispensing chamber 122 and may allow the use of a more compliant (i.e., less resilient) dispensing diaphragm 125 than would be required in the embodiment shown in FIG. 5. The dispensing spring 130 is typically positioned adjacent to the dispensing diaphragm 125 on a side of the diaphragm 125 opposite to the dispensing chamber 122.

(177) Alternately, to reduce background noise from the microphone, the loudspeaker 1202 and the sensing microphone 1203 may be coupled to the variable volume chamber 121 via separate ports. As schematically shown in FIG. 8, a loudspeaker 1202 generates pressure waves in a fixed loudspeaker volume 6000 which is acoustically coupled with the variable volume chamber 121 via a loudspeaker port 6020. Pressure waves travel from the loudspeaker 1202, through the loudspeaker port 6020 to the variable volume chamber 121 and then through a microphone port 6010 before being recorded by the sensing microphone 1203. The loudspeaker port 6020 may include a tube portion 6040 with a flared aperture 6030. The flared aperture 6030 serves to create a uniform length along which sound waves travel for all axial paths of the tube portion 6040. For example, the tube portion 6040 can have the geometry of a cylinder, such as a right cylinder or right circular cylinder. A similarly flared aperture may also adjoin a tube portion to define the microphone port 6010. In contrast to the AVS sensor of FIGS. 6 and 7, in the embodiment of FIG. 8, pressure waves traveling from the loudspeaker 1202 do not have a direct path to the sensing microphone 1203. Thus, pressure waves from the loudspeaker 1202 are prevented from directly impacting the sensing microphone 1203 without first passing through the variable volume 121. A lower background signal is therefore received by the microphone and a better signal/noise ratio is achieved. Additionally, an upper shelf 6050 may be included in any of the embodiments of FIGS. 6-8 advantageously reducing the volume of the reference chamber 127.

(178) In embodiments to be further described, it may be convenient to separate the sensor and metering chamber portions of the dispensing assembly such that the dispensing chamber is detachable and disposable. In this case, the dispensing chamber resides in a disposable section of the patch, while the sensor resides in the reusable section. The dispensing chamber may be bounded by a resilient fluid dispensing diaphragm (as shown in FIG. 6 as 122 and 124). Alternately, as in FIG. 7, the dispensing chamber 122 may be bounded by a compliant diaphragm 125. In this case, a dispensing spring 130 can be used to impart resiliency on the dispensing chamber 122. When the sensor 550 and dispensing chamber 122 are brought together, the dispensing spring 130 covers the compliant dispensing diaphragm 125. The dispensing spring 130 and dispensing diaphragm 125 may alternately be employed as a single part defining the dispensing chamber 122.

(179) As shown in FIG. 9, an alternate embodiment of the dispensing assembly is shown. In an embodiment of dispensing assembly 120 depicted in FIG. 9, variable-volume measurement chamber 121 shares a compliant wall (here shown as compliant diaphragm 125) with dispensing chamber 122. Port 128 acoustically couples measurement chamber 121 to fixed volume chamber 129, so as to form an acoustically contiguous region designated generally by numeral 1290. A compressible fluid (typically, air, or another gas) fills the acoustically contiguous region 1290 and is excited by a driving member 1214, itself driven by an actuator 1216. Driving member 1214 may be a diaphragm of a speaker, such as a hearing aid speaker, where actuator 1216 is a voice coil solenoid or piezoelectric element, for example. Within the scope of the invention, driving member 1214 may also be coextensive with actuator 1216, such as where driving member 1214 may, itself, be a piezoelectric element. Driving member 1214 may be contained within a driver module 1212 that may contain, on a side of driving member 1214 distal to fixed volume 129, a reference volume 1220. However, reference volume 1220 is typically not employed in practice of the invention.

(180) A reference microphone 1208 is shown in acoustic communication with fixed volume 129, while a signal microphone 1209 is acoustically coupled to measurement chamber 121. The volume of measurement region 121 may be determined from electronic signals provided by one or more microphones 1208, 1209 on the basis of pressure variations (or, equivalently, acoustic signal) measured at their respective positions within the acoustically contiguous region 1290. Phase measurements may be performed by comparing the phase of response at one or more microphones relative to the phase of acoustic excitation or relative to the phase of response at a position of another microphone. The volume of measurement region 121, and, by implication, of dispensing chamber 122, is determined, on the basis of phase and/or amplitude measurements, as discussed below, by a processor 1210, which derives power from power source 1211, shown, representatively, as a battery.

(181) For the purposes of precise delivery of minute amounts of therapeutic agents, the delivery of small, but very accurately metered, quantities per pump stroke is desirable. However, if minute volumes of fluid are to be pumped through line 110 during the course of each pump stroke, extremely high resolution is required of the metering process. Consequently, in accordance with embodiments of the present invention, changes in volume are measured by sensor 550 with a resolution of at least 10 nanoliters. Measurements of resolution 0.01% of the empty volume of measurement region 121 may be achieved in some embodiments of the invention. In accordance with other embodiments of the invention, sensor 550 provides resolution of better than 13 nanoliters. In other embodiments yet, sensor 550 provides resolution of better than 15 nanoliters, and in yet further embodiments, resolution of better than 20 nanoliters is provided. In such cases, the total volume of acoustically contiguous region 1290 may be less than 130 μ l, and, in other embodiments, less than 10 μ l.

(182) In accordance with various embodiments of the present invention, use may be made of a priori modeling of the response of the volume of dispensing chamber 122, and, consequently of variable-volume chamber 121 (which may also be referred to, herein, as a "metering volume"), based upon the filling of the dispensing chamber due to a pumped volume of fluid entering through input 123. While other models are within the scope of the present invention, one model that may be employed expresses the volume of fluid within dispensing chamber 122, in response to a pumped influx of fluid and a outlet of fixed flow impedance, as the sum of a baseline volume $V_{sub.B}$ and an exponentially decaying volume characterized by a peak displacement $V_{sub.D}$, such that the metering chamber volume during a measurement is characterized as a function of time t , as:

$$(183) V = V_D \exp(-\frac{t}{\tau}) + V_B .$$

(184) In order to fit a parameterization of the modeled exponential decay (or other functional model) to a succession of acoustic measurements, the response of systems such as depicted in FIGS. 6 through 9 is developed as follows. For purposes of modeling the response, port 128 is characterized by a length l and a diameter d . The pressure and volume of an ideal adiabatic gas can be related by $PV^\gamma = K$, where K is a constant defined by the initial conditions of the system.

(185) The ideal adiabatic gas law can be written in terms of a mean pressure, P , and volume, V , and a small time-dependent perturbation on top of those pressures, $p(t)$, $v(t)$:

$$(P+p(t))(V+v(t)).sup.\gamma = K.$$

(186) Differentiating this equation yields

$$\{ \dot{p} \over (p) \} (t) (V+v(t)).sup.\gamma + \gamma (V+v(t)).sup.\gamma - 1 (P+p(t)) \{ \dot{v} \over (v) \} (t) = 0$$

(187) Or, simplifying,

$$(188) p(t) + \frac{P+p(t)}{V+v(t)} v(t) = 0$$

(189) If the acoustic pressure levels are much less than the ambient pressure the equation can be further simplified to:

$$(190) \dot{p}(t) + \frac{P}{V} v(t) = 0.$$

(191) Applying the ideal gas law, $P = \rho RT$, and substituting in for pressure gives the result:

$$(192) \dot{p}(t) + \frac{\rho RT}{V} v(t) = 0.$$

(193) This can be written in terms of the speed of sound, $a = \sqrt{\gamma RT}$, as:

$$(194) \dot{p}(t) + \frac{a^2}{V} v(t) = 0.$$

(195) Also, an acoustic impedance for a volume is defined as:

$$(196) Z_v = \frac{p(t)}{v(t)} = -\frac{1}{(\frac{V}{a^2})s} = -\frac{a^2}{V} \text{ .Math. } \frac{1}{s}.$$

(197) In accordance with one set of models, the acoustic port is modeled assuming that all of the fluid in the port essentially moves as a rigid cylinder reciprocating in the axial direction. All of the fluid in the channel (port **128**) is assumed to travel at the same velocity, the channel is assumed to be of constant cross section, and the “end effects” resulting from the fluid entering and leaving the channel are neglected.

(198) Assuming laminar flow friction of the form $\Delta P = R_p \{\dot{v}\}$, the friction force acting on the mass of fluid in the channel can be written: $F = R_p A \cdot \dot{v}$.

(199) A second order differential equation can then be written for the dynamics of the fluid in the channel:

$$\rho L A \frac{d^2 v}{dt^2} = \Delta p A - R_p A \cdot \dot{v}$$

or, in terms of volume flow rate:

$$(200) \dot{V}^{\text{Math.}} = -\frac{R_p A}{L} v + p \frac{A}{L}.$$

(201) The acoustic impedance of the channel can then be written:

$$(202) Z = \frac{p}{\dot{V}} = \frac{L}{A} (s + \frac{R_p A}{L}).$$

(203) Using the volume and port dynamics define above, the acoustic volume sensor system can be described by the following system of equations (with index k denoting the speaker, and r denoting the resonator):

$$(204) \dot{p}_0 - \frac{\rho a^2}{V_0} v_k = 0.$$

(205) Following the same convention

$$(206) 0 v_k > 0 \text{ .Math. } p_1 < 0 \text{ and } \dot{v}_r > 0 \text{ .Math. } p_1 > 0 p_1 + \frac{a^2}{V_1} (\dot{v}_k - \dot{v}_r) = 0$$

(207) In addition,

$$(208) \dot{v}_r > 0 \text{ .Math. } p_2 < 0, p_2 + \frac{a^2}{V_2} v_r = 0$$

(209) The volume tends to accelerate in a positive direction if p.sub.2 is larger than p.sub.1.

$$(210) \dot{V}_r^{\text{Math.}} = -\frac{R_p A}{L} v_r + \frac{A}{L} (p_2 - p_1).$$

(211) Reducing the number of equations (treating p.sub.0 as input), and substituting

$$(212) v_k = \frac{V_0}{a^2} \dot{p}_0, p_1 + \frac{V_0}{V_1} \dot{p}_0 - \frac{a^2}{V_1} v_r = 0 p_2 + \frac{\rho a^2}{V_2} v_r = 0 \text{ .Math. } \dot{V}_r = -\frac{R_p A}{L} v_r + \frac{A}{L} p_1 - \frac{A}{L} p_2$$

(213) This leads to one simple expression using these equations:

$$(214) \frac{a^2}{V_2} v_r = \frac{V_1}{V_2} \text{ .Math. } (\frac{a^2}{V_1} v_r) = \frac{V_1}{V_2} p_1 + \frac{V_0}{V_2} \dot{p}_0 + \frac{V_0}{V_2} \dot{p}_0 + \frac{V_1}{V_2} p_1 = 0 V_0 \dot{p}_0 + V_1 \dot{p}_1 = -V_2 p_2 - \frac{V_0 \dot{p}_0 + V_1 \dot{p}_1}{p_2} = V_2, \text{ or } V_0 p_0 + V_1 p_1 = -V_2 p_2 - \frac{V_0 \dot{p}_0 + V_1 \dot{p}_1}{p_2} = V_2$$

(215) These equations can also be expressed in transfer function form. The “cross-speaker” transfer function, p.sub.1/p.sub.0, is:

$$(216) s \text{ .Math. } p_1 + \frac{V_0}{V_1} s \text{ .Math. } p_0 - \frac{a^2}{V_1} s \text{ .Math. } v_r = 0 s \text{ .Math. } p_2 + \frac{a^2}{V_2} s \text{ .Math. } v_r = 0 s^2 \text{ .Math. } v_r = -\frac{R_p A}{L} s \text{ .Math. } v_r - \frac{A}{L} p_1 + \frac{A}{L} p_2$$

$$p_2 = -\frac{a^2}{V_2} v_r s^2 v_r = -\frac{R_p A}{L} s \text{ .Math. } v_r + \frac{A}{L} (-\frac{a^2}{V_2} v_r) - \frac{A}{L} p_1 (s^2 + \frac{R_p A}{L} s + \frac{A a^2}{L V_2}) v_r = -\frac{A}{L} p_1 v_r = \frac{-A/L}{s^2 + R_p A/L s + A a^2/L V_2} p_1 \text{ or } \frac{p_1}{p_0} = -\frac{V_0 s^2 + 2 \zeta \omega_n s + \omega_n^2}{V_1 s^2 + 2 \zeta \omega_n s + \omega_n^2} \text{ where } \frac{2}{n} = \frac{a^2 A}{L} (\frac{1}{V_1} + \frac{1}{V_2}); \quad \zeta = \frac{R_p A}{2L}; \text{ and } \omega_n = \frac{V_1}{V_1 + V_2}.$$

(217) Similarly, the “cross system” transfer function, based on measurements on either end of port **128**, is p.sub.2/p.sub.0, is given by:

$$(218) s \text{ .Math. } p_1 + \frac{V_0}{V_1} s \text{ .Math. } p_0 - \frac{a^2}{V_1} s \text{ .Math. } v_r = 0 s \text{ .Math. } p_2 + \frac{a^2}{V_2} s \text{ .Math. } v_r = 0 s^2 \text{ .Math. } v_r = -\frac{R_p A}{L} s \text{ .Math. } v_r - \frac{A}{L} p_1 + \frac{A}{L} p_2$$

$$p_1 = \frac{a^2}{V_1} v_r - \frac{V_0}{V_1} \dot{p}_0 s^2 v_r = -\frac{R_p A}{L} s \text{ .Math. } v_r - \frac{A}{L} \text{ .Math. } \frac{a^2}{V_1} v_r - \frac{A}{L} (-\frac{V_0}{V_1} \dot{p}_0) + \frac{A}{L} p_2 v_r = \frac{\frac{A V_0}{L V_1}}{s^2 + \frac{R_p A}{L} s + \frac{A a^2}{L V_1}} p_0 + \frac{\frac{A}{L}}{s^2 + \frac{R_p A}{L} s + \frac{A a^2}{L V_1}} p_2$$

$$s \text{ .Math. } p_2 + \frac{a^2}{V_2} s \text{ .Math. } [\frac{\frac{A V_0}{L V_1}}{s^2 + \frac{R_p A}{L} s + \frac{A a^2}{L V_1}} p_0 + \frac{\frac{A}{L}}{s^2 + \frac{R_p A}{L} s + \frac{A a^2}{L V_1}} p_2] = 0 [s^2 + \frac{R_p A}{L} s + \frac{A a^2}{L V_1} + \frac{A a^2}{L V_2}] p_2 = -\frac{A a^2}{L V_2} \text{ .Math. } \frac{V_0}{V_1} p_0 \frac{p_2}{p_0} = -\frac{V_0}{V_1} \frac{s^2 + 2 \zeta \omega_n s + \omega_n^2}{s^2 + \frac{R_p A}{L} s + \frac{A a^2}{L V_2}} \text{ .Math. } \frac{V_1 + V_2}{V_1}$$

$$\frac{p_2}{p_0} = -\frac{V_0}{V_1} \frac{\frac{2}{n}}{s^2 + 2 \frac{\zeta}{n} s + \frac{\omega_n^2}{n}}$$

Volume Estimation Using Cross-System Phase

(219) Similarly, using the same principles, a transfer function is readily derived, expressing a pressure in the fixed volume chamber **129** in terms of the pressure in the variable volume chamber **121** to which it is coupled via port **128**. In particular, the transfer function is:

$$(220) \frac{p_2}{p_1} = \frac{1}{\frac{V_2 L_p}{a^2 A_p} s^2 + \frac{R V_2}{a^2} s + 1} = \frac{\frac{a^2 A_p}{V_2 L_p}}{s^2 + \frac{R V_2}{a^2} s + \frac{a^2 A_p}{V_2 L_p}} = \frac{\frac{2}{n}}{s^2 + \frac{R A}{L_p} s + \frac{\omega_n^2}{n}}.$$

(221) In either of the foregoing cases, the resonant frequency of the system may be expressed as a function of the variable volume, V.sub.2:

$$(222) \frac{2}{n} = \frac{a^2 A}{L} (\frac{1}{V_1} + \frac{1}{V_2}), \text{ or } \frac{1}{V_2} = \frac{\frac{2}{n} L}{a^2 A} - \frac{1}{V_1}.$$

(223) Since all of the other parameters are known, variable volume V.sub.2 can be calculated based, for example, on the resonant frequency, although other methods of deriving V.sub.2 may be advantageous, and are described further in the course of the present application. The one parameter that is not a constant in this equation is the speed of sound, a, which may be calculated, based on a knowledge of the pertinent temperature, or otherwise derived or measured.

(224) As stated, various strategies may be employed to interrogate the system so as to derive volume V.sub.2. In accordance with certain embodiments of the current invention, the system is excited by driving member **1214** at a single frequency, while monitoring the response of one or more transducers (microphones **1208** and **1209**, in FIG. **9**). The response is captured as a complex signal, retaining both amplitude and phase of the pressure variation. It is advantageous that the single interrogating frequency lie close to the resonance of the system in mid-stroke, since the largest phase changes with volume over the range of a full to empty chamber is thereby achieved.

(225) The response of the signal microphone **1208** may be corrected to reject common-mode effects due to the frequency-dependent characteristics of the exciting loudspeaker **1202** (shown in FIG. **6**) or driving member **1214** (shown in FIG. **9**). The corrected signal, obtained as a complex ratio of the microphone signals, may be expressed as m_i , where the index i denotes successive time samples of the signal.

(226) Expressed, in transfer function form, in analogy, to a second-order mechanical Helmholtz resonator, the signal may be represented as:

(227)

(241) FIG. 11B shows a kinetic profile of a bolus delivery of fluid by the fluid delivery device 10. A rapid succession of about 29 pump actuations (i.e., pulses) each displace fluid from a fluid source into the resilient dispensing chamber 122, thus causing corresponding changes in the parameter measured by the acoustic volume measurement sensor 550. It can be seen that the volume of the dispensing chamber 122 expands on the first pump pulse to about 1.5 μl , a value similar to that observed in FIG. 11A. The dispensing chamber 122 volume further expands upon additional pulsatile pumping at pulse intervals shorter than the time period required to achieve full discharge of the dispensing assembly 120; the expansion reaches a

maximum of about 6 μ l. Cessation of the pump pulsing occurs after about 85 seconds and the volume of the chamber 122 is seen to decrease with an exponential decay kinetic resulting in complete discharge of its contents by about 30 seconds after cessation of pumping. The $t_{sub.1/2}$ for this final discharge is approximately the same as for the basal delivery shown in FIG. 11A. The calculated cumulative output volume is seen to rise during pumping with an approximately linear kinetic and plateau upon cessation of pumping.

(242) In the described system, fault conditions are detected by volume measurements rather than by pressure measurements, thus, faults may be determined in seconds. FIGS. 11C-11F illustrate the sensor 550 of FIGS. 5-7 detection various types of fault conditions. All description with respect to FIGS. 11C-11F are described with reference to FIGS. 5-7.

(243) FIG. 11C shows a kinetic profile of sensor 550 output over time for a pumping pulse under normal operating conditions. In contrast, FIG. 11D shows an expected result of an occlusion downstream of the dispensing assembly 120; the increasing (or not decreasing) volume of fluid in the dispensing chamber 122 is quickly detected by the sensor 550.

(244) Low volume conditions are shown in FIGS. 11E-11F. In FIG. 11E, an approximate maximum sensor signal is reached, followed by an overly fast decay; this condition may indicate an internal leak in the pump 16, line 310, or dispensing assembly 120. The kinetic profile of FIG. 11F has a low peak volume signal and may be representative of a pump failure, an empty reservoir 20, or an occlusion that is upstream of the dispensing chamber 122. Delayed expansion of the dispensing chamber 122 in response to pump actuation may also indicate a problem in the flow line 310. The sensor 550 may also be capable of detecting bubbles in the fluid. An alarm can be activated in response to detection of a fault condition.

(245) FIG. 12 shows a flow chart depicting a cycle of acoustic volume sensing and compensation (corresponding to control loop 360 of FIGS. 2A-3). The sensor may measure the amount of fluid dispensed from the device 10 based on measures of the magnitude of the cyclical changes in the variable volume chamber 121 induced by the pumping cycles. For example, the sensor 550 may repeatedly acquire acoustic spectra of the resonant variable volume 121 and the reference volume chamber 127 (step 2611) and maintains a parameter, which, for each pumping pulse, is updated to incorporate the decrease in volume of gas in the variable volume chamber 121. Accordingly the updated parameter indicates the net quantity of fluid that has entered the dispensing chamber 122. The fluid entering the dispensing chamber 122 is approximately equal to the volume that has been dispensed by the device 10 if there is sufficient delay between pulses. Alternately, the sensor 550 can repeatedly measure the increase in the volume of gas in the variable volume chamber 121 to determine the amount dispensed by the device (if there is a sufficient delay between pulses). Acoustic spectra are compared to model spectra in a lookup table that may correspond to any or all of a dispensing chamber 122 with a bubble, without a bubble, or with bubbles of varying sizes (step 2621). The lookup table may hold data acquired experimentally, determined using a model, or determined to work empirically. The lookup table may contain data representing varying bubble containing and/or normal conditions for multiple degrees of expansion of dispensing chamber 122. If the spectrum and updated sum fit a model of normal flow (step 2631), another acoustic spectrum is acquired and the cycle is repeated at step 2611. If the spectrum and/or the updated sum do not fit a model of normal flow, the presence of a low or occluded flow will be determined (step 2641). A low or occluded flow may be indicated by a persistently out-of-range volume of the variable volume chamber 121, by an updated sum that is lower than a predicted or set value, or both. If a low or occluded flow condition is detected, an alarm will be triggered (step 2671). Alarms may include audible signals, vibrations, or both. If no condition of low or occluded flow is found, the device determines if the spectrum fits a model corresponding to a condition of a bubble in the dispensing chamber 122 (step 2661). If a bubble is determined to be present, a reaction is initiated that may include an alarm and/or compensatory action which may include temporarily increasing the rate of pumping (step 2651) and the cycle will begin again at step 2611. If it is determined that no bubble is present, an alarm is triggered to indicate an undetermined fault condition (step 2671). Embodiments of the present invention may also utilize bubble detection using AVS technology as disclosed in U.S. Patent Application, Ser. No. 60/789,243, which is incorporated herein by reference.

(246) The pumping assembly 16 of FIGS. 2A-3 urges fluid from the reservoir 20 to the dispensing assembly 120. When a dispensing assembly according to FIGS. 6-7 is used, it is not necessary to use a high precision pump, because the feedback provided from the dispensing assembly 120 to the pumping assembly 16 allows adjustment of the pumping assembly 16 based on exact measurements of the volume being delivered. The individual pumping pulses may be of sufficiently low volume to allow precise compensation based on the feedback. Many different pumping assembly 16 implementations can therefore be employed. Various possible embodiments of the pumping assembly 16 are described below.

(247) FIGS. 13 and 14 schematically show alternate embodiments of some of the components in a fluid delivery device according to an embodiment of the invention. FIG. 13 shows a flow line 310 with a pumping assembly 16 having a pumping element 2100 located between an upstream one way valve 21 and a downstream one way valve 22. The pumping element 2100 may use an actuator to deform a portion of the flow line to generate pressure in the flow line 310. The upstream one way valve 21 inhibits retrograde flow from the pumping element 2100 toward a fluid source (not shown), while the downstream one way valve 22 inhibits retrograde flow from the volume-sensing chamber 120 to the pumping element 2100. As a result, fluid is driven in the direction of the exit assembly 17, which, in one embodiment, includes a high-impedance passage.

(248) In an alternate embodiment shown in FIG. 14, the functions of the pumping element, i.e., generating pressure in the flow line 310, and the upstream one way valve 21 are performed by a combined valving pump 2200. Thus, the pumping assembly 16 in the FIG. 14 embodiment is made up of two components—the combined valving pump 2200 and the downstream one way valve 22—instead of the three components used in the FIG. 13 embodiment. Other embodiments of the pumping assembly 16 may be used. The combination of valving and pumping functions in valving pump 2200 may be accomplished by a variety of mechanisms, some of which are described below with reference to FIGS. 15A-16 and 22-56.

(249) In many of the embodiments described below, the poppet for the inlet valve 21, the poppet for the exit valve 22 and the pumping actuation member 54 are all either directly or indirectly (e.g., as in FIGS. 50-56) in communication with the fluid line 310 such that each of these elements are able to create or react to various fluid pressures. As noted above, the upstream and downstream valves—which may also be referred to herein as the inlet and exit valves—are one way valves. The valves can be volcano, flapper, check or duck-bill valves, amongst other types of one way valves, or other types of valves that bias the flow toward the device output. An example of volcano valves are disclosed in U.S. Pat. No. 5,178,182 issued Jan. 12, 1993 to Dean L. Kamen, and incorporated herein by reference.

(250) In the embodiment shown in FIGS. 15A-15D, the pumping assembly includes both an inlet valve 21 and an exit valve 22, each of which includes a fluid inlet, a fluid exit, and a moveable member (which is, for each valve, a portion of membrane 2356). The pumping assembly also includes a pumping element 2100. The pumping element is located downstream from the inlet valve 21 and upstream from the exit valve 22. In the following description, the exit valve will be starting from the closed position, i.e., fluid is not flowing through the exit valve. However, at a time when the fluid presents enough pressure, the fluid pressure opens the exit valve by placing pressure on the membrane and the exit valve's poppet 9221 to open the valve, and the fluid can then flow through the exit valve 22. The embodiment of FIGS. 15A through 15D may be considered to be a combined valving-pump (like item 2200 in FIG. 14), in the sense that a single mechanical action both occludes a pump inlet and then urges flow through a pump outlet.

(251) This pumping arrangement has the advantage of partitioning the moving parts and wetted line components to opposite sides of a flexible barrier membrane 2356. As a result, the moving parts may be located in a reusable component and the wetted parts (fluidic line 310) may be located in a disposable component.

(252) In a preferred embodiment of the pumping mechanism, the fluid source is a non-pressurized reservoir. When the moveable member of the inlet valve is in the open position, and a negative pressure exists in the pumping chamber, a pressure differential exists that pulls the fluid from the reservoir towards the inlet valve. This negative pressure may be created by the resiliency of the membrane in the pumping chamber. In one alternative embodiment, a spring—which may be built into the membrane—may be used to assist in the recoil of the membrane in the pumping chamber. The non-pressurized reservoir may be collapsible, so that when fluid is drawn from it, a corresponding collapse in the reservoir reduces its volume. As a result, build-up of negative pressure, or air in the reservoir is prevented.

(253) In a preferred embodiment of the pumping mechanism, after the inlet valve is closed, pressure is applied to the pumping chamber forcing fluid from the pumping chamber towards the exit valve. Pressure created by the pumping motion opens the exit valve and allows fluid to flow through the exit valve's fluid exit.

(254) The moveable member can be anything capable of functioning as described above. In some embodiments, the moveable member is a flexible membrane or a resilient pumping diaphragm. In other embodiments, the moveable member is a ball-shaped rigid structure or another object capable of preventing fluid from flowing out of an opening in the fluid path.

(255) In practice, the pumping mechanism may be primed prior to use. Thus, the pumping mechanism cycles through a number of strokes, purging air from the fluid line, until most or all of the air in the fluid line is purged. Many of the pumping mechanisms disclosed herein have the ability to "self-prime" because the fluid volume contained outside the pumping chamber, but between the valves, is small. When the pump squeezes air in the pump chamber, it generally builds up enough pressure to blow past the exit valve. The subsequent return stroke can therefore develop sufficient negative pressure for the pump to pull liquid from the reservoir. If the "dead" volume of the pump is too large, the air in the pumping chamber may not build up enough pressure to escape the exit valve. As a result, the pump may stall.

(256) FIGS. 15A-15D, 16 and 22-56 show several embodiments of the pumping mechanism. Referring now to FIGS. 15A-15D, one embodiment of the pumping mechanism is shown exemplifying several steps in the pumping process: 1. fluid passing through the inlet valve 21 (as shown in FIG. 15B); 2. the inlet valve closed (as shown in FIG. 15C); and 3. the pumping actuation member 54 forcing fluid downstream, with fluid pressure opening the exit valve 22 and flowing through the fluid exit (as shown in FIG. 15D).

(257) The pumping mechanism of FIGS. 15A-15D includes a moveable member, which, in this embodiment, is a portion of the flexible membrane 2356. The inlet and exit valves include poppets 9221, 9222 that function as valve occluders. Each of the poppets 9221, 9222 and the pump actuation member 54 include a spring 8002, 8004, 8006. The pump plate 8000 is attached to both the pump actuation member 54 and the inlet poppet 9221 and serves as a terminus to their respective springs 8004, 8002.

(258) The term "poppet" is used to denote a member that applies pressure against the moveable member (i.e., the membrane) to affect the position of the membrane. Although other designs may be used, some specific examples of spring-loaded poppet valves that utilize structures and principles of mechanical advantage are described below (in connection with FIGS. 50-56). However, mechanisms other than poppets can be used to perform the same function. In FIGS. 15B-15D, the inlet valve 21 includes a fluid inlet and fluid exit, part of the membrane 2356, and a poppet 9221. The exit valve 22 includes a fluid inlet and fluid exit, part of the membrane and a poppet 9222.

(259) In the embodiment shown in FIGS. 15A-15D, the fluid path 310 is defined by a structure (item 9310 in FIG. 15A), which may be rigid or have some flexibility (preferably less flexibility than membrane 2356. As shown in FIG. 15A, the housing structure 9310 defines the valving chambers 9321, 9322 and the pumping chamber 2350; all three of these chambers are in the fluid path 310.

(260) Referring now to FIGS. 15B-15D, the inlet valve 21, exit valve 22 and pump element 2100 each have a fluid inlet and a fluid exit. The pumping actuation member 54 has a pumping chamber 2350 where the fluid flows after exiting the inlet valve. Pumping actuation member 54 applies pressure onto the membrane 2356, creating positive pressure in the fluid line.

(261) As shown in FIGS. 15B-15D (and similarly for the valve seat 4070 for the outlet valve shown in FIGS. 50-56), the valve seat 9121 in the inlet valve 21 is preferably spaced away from the membrane 2356, when the membrane is not being actuated by the poppet 9221 of the inlet valve.

(262) The fluid line 310 is partially defined by a membrane 2356. In this embodiment, the membrane 2356 separates parts of the pumping mechanism from the fluid. Thus, the fluid line 310 is wetted and the pumping actuator 54 and the valve poppets 9221, 9222 are not wetted. However, alternative embodiments of the pumping assembly do not need to include a membrane 2356 that is in contact with the fluid line 310. Instead, a different moveable member may be used for the valves and/or pump. In still other embodiments, only parts of the fluid line 310 are separated from the pumping mechanism, thus partially wetting the pumping assembly.

(263) The inlet poppet 9221 includes an end 8018 referring to the surface area of the inlet poppet that contacts the membrane portion of the fluid line 310. The pumping actuation member 54 includes an end 8012 that contacts the membrane portion of the fluid line 310. Likewise, the exit poppet 22 includes an end 8022 that contacts the membrane portion of the fluid line 310. The ends 8018, 8022 of the valve poppets apply pressure onto their respective areas of the membrane 2356, blocking or unblocking the respective portions of the flow path 310. The end 8012 of the pressure actuation member also applies pressure onto its respective area of the membrane, so as to cause flow through the fluid line 310.

(264) The pumping actuation member 54 is surrounded by a plunger biasing spring 8004. The plunger biasing spring 8004 has both a terminus at the pump plate 8000 and at 8014, a support structure that also holds the pumping actuation member.

(265) The inlet poppet 21 is surrounded by an inlet poppet spring 8002, although in alternate embodiments, the inlet poppet itself is resilient and so serves the function of the spring. The inlet poppet spring 8002 has both a terminus at the pump plate 8000 and near the end 8018 of the inlet poppet 9221.

(266) The exit poppet 9222 is surrounded by a passive exit poppet spring 8006. The exit poppet spring 8006 has both a terminus at an exit poppet plate 8024 and the lip 8020 near the end of the exit poppet 9222.

(267) In each case, the springs 8002, 8004, 8006 terminate before the respective ends and do not interfere with the surface areas 8018, 8012, 8022 that contact the membrane 2356.

(268) In a preferred embodiment, the fluid pumping device also includes at least one shape memory actuator 278 (e.g., a conductive shape-memory alloy wire) that changes shape with temperature. The temperature of the shape-memory actuator(s) may be changed with a heater, or more conveniently, by application of an electric current. FIGS. 15B-15D show an embodiment with one shape memory actuator 278, however, in other embodiments (described below) there may be more than one shape memory actuator 278. In one embodiment, the shape memory actuator is a shape memory wire constructed of nickel/titanium alloy, such as NITINOL™ or FLEXINOL®. However, in other embodiments, any device capable of generating a force, such as a solenoid, could also be used. In certain embodiments, the shape memory actuator 278 has a diameter of about 0.003 inches and is about 1.5 inches in length. However, in other embodiments, the shape memory actuator 278 may be made from any alloy capable of contraction with heat (and expansion may be aided by a mechanism that imparts force on the alloy so as to stretch the alloy to the original length, i.e., a spring, although such a mechanism is not required) so as to actuate the pumping mechanism as described in the embodiments herein. In certain embodiments, the diameter of the shape memory actuator 278 can be from 0.001 inches to any diameter desired and the length can be any length desired. Generally speaking, the larger the diameter, the higher the available contraction force. However, the electrical current required to heat the wire generally increases with diameter. Thus, the diameter, length and composition of the shape memory alloy 278 may affect the current necessary to actuate the pumping mechanism. Irrespective of the length of the shape memory actuator 278, the actuation force is approximately constant. Increase in actuation force can be imparted by increasing the diameter of the shape memory actuator 278.

(269) The shape memory actuator 278 connects to the pump plate 8000 through connector 8008. Connector 8008 is described in more detail below. The shape memory actuator 278 connects to a fluid pumping device by way of terminus connector 8010. Depending on the device or system in which the pumping mechanism is used, the terminus connection location will vary. The terminus connector 8010 is described in more detail below.

(270) FIGS. 15B-15D show the pumping mechanism and fluid line 310 having already been primed as discussed above. Referring now to FIG. 15B, the inlet valve 21 is open, and the pumping actuation member 54 is not pressing against the membrane 2356. The exit valve 22 is in the closed position. The shape memory actuator 278 is in an expanded position. In this configuration, fluid is pulled from a reservoir (not shown) to the inlet valve 21 fluid inlet. (Although shown as a bulge in the membrane in the inlet valve region, the pulling of fluid in this step may cause a depression in the membrane, or no deformation of the membrane). When the inlet poppet is in the open position, the fluid can flow from the fluid inlet to the fluid exit and into the pumping chamber 2350. At this point, the exit poppet end 8022 is firmly pressed against the membrane 2356 and seals the exit valve

22.

(271) Referring next to FIG. 15C, electrical current has been applied to the shape memory actuator 278, and the shape memory actuator is contracting from a starting length towards the desired end length. The contracting of the shape memory actuator 278 pulls the pump plate 8000 towards the fluid line 310. The inlet poppet 9221 and the pumping actuation member 54 are both connected to the pumping plate 8000. The motion of the plate 8000 pulls both the inlet poppet 9221 and pumping actuation member 54 towards the membrane 2356. As shown in FIG. 15C, the inlet poppet end 8018 is pressed firmly against the membrane 2356, sealing the membrane against the valve seat 9121 and, closing the inlet valve 21. (The motion of the inlet poppet can force a small amount of fluid in the inlet valving chamber, item 9321 in FIG. 15A, through either the fluid inlet or the fluid exit of the inlet valve 21.)

(272) Simultaneously, the pumping actuation member 54 begins its path towards the pumping chamber 2350. During this process, as the inlet poppet spring 8002 is compressed (at this point, the inlet poppet end 8018 is pressing firmly against the fluid line 310), the pump plate 8000 and pumping actuation member 54 continue traveling towards the fluid line 310. The inlet poppet spring 8002 allows the pump plate 8000 to continue moving toward the fluid line 310 with the pump actuation member 54 even when the inlet poppet 9221 can not travel any further.

(273) Referring now to FIG. 15D, the pumping actuation member 54 presses against the area of the membrane 2356 over the pumping chamber 2350 and the fluid is pumped so as to increase the pressure of the fluid in the pumping chamber 2350. The exit poppet end 8022 remains pressing firmly (aided by the exit poppet spring 8006) on the membrane 2356 sealing the fluid inlet and fluid exit of the exit valve 22 until the pressure from the fluid flowing from the pumping chamber 2350 forces exit valve 22 open. Upon reaching a sufficient pressure, the fluid exits through the fluid exit of the exit valve 22, thus overcoming the pressure exerted against the membrane 2356 by the exit valve 22. Upon cessation of flow, the exit valve 22 is forced closed by the passive spring 8006.

(274) During the work stroke, the pump actuation member spring 8004 is loaded. Eventually, the pump actuation member spring 8004 will pull the pump actuation member 54 away from the membrane 2356. As a result, during the relaxation stroke, the spring 8004 returns the pump actuation member 54, and pumping plate 8000 to the relaxed position of FIG. 15C; the loaded inlet poppet spring 8002 may also contribute energy to the return stroke. As the pumping plate 8000 nears its relaxed position, it engages a cap of the inlet poppet 9221 to lift and unseat the inlet poppet so as to open the inlet valve 21. The pump actuation member spring 8004 also unloads during the return stroke.

(275) The pump plate 8000, reaching a threshold distance where the inlet poppet spring 8002 is at the same level as the pump plate 8000, will unload with the pump actuation member spring 8004. The membrane 2356 in the pumping chamber 2350, being resilient, will return to its starting position. This creates a negative pressure and as the inlet valve opens, fluid will flow through the inlet valve's fluid inlet to the fluid exit and towards the pumping chamber 2350. Thus, the pumping mechanism will now be in the state as shown in FIG. 15B.

(276) The entire pump sequence described with respect to FIGS. 15B-15D will repeat each time the pump is actuated through application of current onto the shape memory actuator 278.

(277) The membranes referred to herein, including membrane 2356, may be made from any resilient material capable of imparting the necessary characteristics to function as described herein. Additionally, the membrane material may include a biocompatible material so as not to impede operation of the pump or diminish the therapeutic value of the fluid. Multiple biocompatible resilient materials may be suitable, including nitrile and silicone. However, different therapeutic fluid compositions may require different choices of resilient material.

(278) The pumping mechanism described above and also various embodiments as described herein can be described in terms of stroke length. One way to determine stroke length is by the total change in the length of the shape memory actuator during one cycle of contraction and expansion of the shape memory actuator. This difference will determine the total distance the pump rod travels and thus, the total amount of fluid that flows out of the inlet chamber 2354 to the pumping chamber 2350, to the exit chamber 2352 and finally, out the exit chamber 2352. Another way to determine stroke length is the travel distance of the pump plate 8000. For a partial stroke, the pump plate 8000 will not reach its maximum travel distance. In one embodiment, very small or micro-strokes are initiated continuously, pumping micro-liter volumes of fluid on a continuous or regular basis, from the reservoir to the exit. For example, a micro-stroke may displace less than 20%, 10% or 1% of the volume of the pumping chamber 2350.

(279) FIG. 16 shows a variation of the pumping mechanism embodiment shown in FIG. 15B. In FIG. 16, two different shape memory actuators—a longer one and a shorter one—are used. FIG. 16 shows an embodiment of the pumping mechanism shown in FIG. 15B in which the shape memory wire 278 is tensioned around a pulley 286 and splits into longer and shorter strands. A common juncture serving as a negative terminal may be located where the longer and shorter strands split off. Completion of a circuit with either or both of the alternate paths allows adjustment of the pumping force and/or stroke length. In an alternative embodiment, a piece of material, such as Kevlar material, extends from the common junction around the pulley to the force plate 8000, while two separate pieces of shape memory wire extend from the common junction to their respective supports. These embodiments provide both a pumping mode and an air purging mode, as described below, by using two wires with different lengths.

(280) With respect to varying stroke using the shape memory actuator variables, for a given length of shape memory actuator, the stroke is dependent on a number of variables: 1. total time electricity/heat is applied; 2. total voltage of the electricity; and 3. the diameter of the shape memory actuator. Some variable embodiments are shown in FIGS. 17-19. However, in some embodiments, the stroke can be varied while maintaining the length, electricity time and voltage. These embodiments include multiple shape memory actuators (see FIG. 19) and multiple switches on a single shape memory wire (see FIG. 17). As discussed above, the desired stroke length can also be attained by modifying any one or more of the variables.

(281) Additionally, the timing of the application of heat or electric current to the shape memory actuation can vary to control the stroke. Each time the shape memory actuator is heated can be termed a pulse. Factors such as the pulse frequency, pulse duration, and stroke length may affect the amount of fluid delivered over time.

(282) FIGS. 17-19 additionally depict embodiments of pumping assemblies which have both a fluid pumping mode and an air purging mode. When activated, the air purging mode applies a compression stroke of increased displacement and/or increased application of force by a force application member. The air purging mode may be activated based on the likelihood or knowledge of air being present in the pumping assembly. For example, the air purging mode may be activated when the line is attached to a reservoir, when a bubble is detected by a sensor or sensing apparatus, or when insufficient flow is detected by a sensor or sensing apparatus.

(283) Alternately, the two modes may be used to select between displacing a smaller and a larger volume of fluid for a given pumping pulse.

(284) Referring now to FIG. 17, a schematic shows a pumping assembly actuated by a shape memory actuator 278 and having multiple modes of operation. When a pumping chamber 2350 is filled with fluid, the pumping assembly operates in a fluid pumping mode. During fluid pumping mode, electrical current flows between a negative electrical lead 2960 and a positive electrical lead 2961, causing resistive heating of the alloy shape memory actuator 278 and a resultant phase change and power stroke. In one embodiment, during priming of the pumping mechanism or when a bubble 2950 is suspected to be in the pumping chamber 2350, the air purging mode is activated and electrical current flows along a path of extended length between a negative electrical lead 2960 and a positive electrical lead 2965; the result is a compression stroke of greater force on and displacement of force application member 2320 which should be sufficient to displace air 2950 from the pumping chamber 2350 to the pump outlet 2370. In alternate embodiments, the positive and negative leads may be reversed.

(285) Referring now to FIG. 18, a schematic shows an alternate pumping assembly having a plurality of shape memory actuators 278 having the same length. The additional actuators may be used to increase the actuating pressure on the pumping chamber 2350, for example, to remove an occlusion or air bubble in the fluid line, pumping chamber or other area of the pumping mechanism. The additional actuators may also provide a redundancy to any pumping device. A single shape memory actuator may be capable of imparting sufficient force to remove an air-bubble from the pumping chamber. Additionally, in the embodiment shown in FIG. 18, an additional return spring may be necessary depending on the length of the second shape memory actuator.

(286) When a reservoir is first attached to a flow line having a pumping assembly (item 16 in FIGS. 13-14) is typically filled with air. Air can also enter the pumping mechanism during normal operation for various reasons. Since air is more compressible than fluid, application of a compression stroke of a length that is sufficient to displace a fluid may be insufficient to generate enough pressure to overcome the cracking pressure of a one way valve of the pumping mechanism if there is a substantial amount of air in the fluid line. Accordingly, the pumping mechanism may stall. However, it may be desired to force air through the line during priming or when an innocuously small amount of air is present in the pumping assembly. Thus, the embodiments shown in FIG. 18 can be used to impart additional force in this situation.

(287) FIG. 19 schematically shows an alternative pumping assembly 16 having a plurality of shape memory actuators. A first, shorter, shape memory actuator 2975 has a first electrical lead 2976 and a second electrical lead 2977. The shorter actuator 2975 is capable of generating compression strokes that are sufficient to displace fluid in the pumping chamber 2350; the shorter shape memory alloy actuator 2975 is used during normal fluid pumping mode operations. When an air purging mode is indicated, or a larger pumped fluid volume is required, a second longer shape memory alloy actuator 2970 may be used by sending a current along an actuator length disposed between a first electrical lead 2973 and a second electrical lead 2972. The longer shape memory alloy actuator 2970 may also be used as a backup actuator for fluid pumping mode operation by creating a shorter circuit which includes an electrical path between a first electrical lead 2972 and a second electrical lead 2971. The shorter shape memory actuator 2975 may also be used to vary the stroke volume to provide better control at lower fluid volume rates. The multiple mode actuators of FIGS. 17-19 are not limited to use with the pump components shown and may be employed with any of the various embodiments of pumping mechanisms described herein including those using fluid pumping devices as described below and those employing valving pumps as described below. Thus, the desired stroke length can be initiated by applying electricity/heat to the length shape memory actuator that will provide the desired stroke length.

(288) Referring now to FIGS. 20A and 20B, each shows one embodiment for attaching the shape memory actuator. These various embodiments can be used in any of the mechanisms or devices described herein which employ a shape memory actuator 278. Referring to both FIG. 20A and FIG. 20B, the shape memory actuator 278 is fed into a grommet 280. The grommet 280 is then attached to a part 284. Although only two embodiments of this mode of attachment are shown, various other modes are used in other embodiments. Other modes of attaching a grommet to a part or any fixed location can be used.

(289) Referring now to FIGS. 21A and 21B, two exemplary embodiments of attaching the shape memory actuator 278 for use with a pumping mechanism 16 are shown. In each of these embodiments, the shape memory actuator 278 is designed to turn around a pulley 286. Referring to FIG. 21A, the shape memory actuator 278 is attached to a piece 288, preferably made of KEVLAR material, by way of grommet 280. One end of the shape memory actuator 278 is shown attached to a part 284 by way of a set screw attachment 289. Referring now to FIG. 21B, one end of the shape memory actuator is shown attached to a part 284 by a grommet 280.

(290) Various embodiments of the pumping mechanism are shown in herein. The pumping mechanisms may include an inlet valve, a pumping actuation member and an exit valve. As discussed above, different types of one way valves may be used in alternative embodiments. Although the schematic shown in FIGS. 15A-15D shows one embodiment, the following figures show alternate embodiments.

(291) Referring now to FIG. 22 and FIG. 23, a side view and a cross section of a section of a pumping mechanism is shown. In this embodiment, the pumping actuation member is a pumping elongate finger 32. When force is exerted onto the finger 32, the finger 32 depresses the moveable member and reduces the internal volume of the fluid line. The section of the pumping mechanism in FIGS. 22 and 23 shows only the pumping chamber. When combined with one way valves (items 21 and 22 of FIG. 13), application of a deforming force to moveable member 23 urges fluid to flow toward an exit assembly (not shown). As shown in FIGS. 22 and 23, the finger 32 is pointed for focusing of force, but in other embodiments, the finger 32 may be flat, or of any other suitable shape. A spring 31 serves to bias the finger 32 toward a retracted position with respect to the resilient member 23 so that the finger 32 returns to the retracted, non depressing position in the absence of application of force. As shown in FIG. 23, a motor can be used to apply force onto the finger 23. However, in other embodiments, a shape memory actuator is used. Various types of motors will be suitable including electric motors and piezoelectric motors.

(292) Referring to both FIGS. 22 and 23, a backstop 33 limits the potential travel of the finger 32, supports the moveable member 23, and ensures a reduction of volume in the fluid line or pumping chamber by preventing the moveable member 23 from moving out of position in response to application of force by the finger 32. As seen in FIG. 22, the backstop 33 may advantageously have a shape complementary to the resilient member 23. In various embodiments, the pumping assembly 16 may include a lever or crank driven on one end by a motor, compressing the resilient member 23 at another end.

(293) Referring now to FIG. 24, another embodiment of the pumping actuation member is shown in relation to one section of the pumping assembly. A motor or shape memory actuator (not shown) applies a rotating force to a grouping of coupled projections 42. These projects 42 serve as the pumping actuation member and, in turn, apply force to the moveable member 23 in turn. Accordingly, intermittent pulses of force are applied to the moveable member 23. The backstop 33, as shown, can travel within a housing 44 and is upwardly biased toward the resilient member 23 by a spring 46.

(294) Referring now to FIG. 25, an embodiment of a force application assembly with a pumping actuation member (here, a plunger) 54 inside a barrel 52 is shown. A motor causes the plunger 54 to be alternately withdrawn and inserted into the barrel. When the plunger 54 is withdrawn, a negative pressure draws fluid from the reservoir (not shown) into a channel 51 and a lumen 56. When the plunger 54 is inserted, the increased pressure in combination with the one way valves (not shown) drives fluid towards the dispensing assembly (not shown). The lumen 56 is connected to the channel 51 via a connecting channel 58 and the volume of the barrel lumen 56 decreases with the plunging action of the plunger 54 thereby urging fluid through the flow line 310.

(295) FIGS. 26 and 27 show another embodiment where the pumping actuation member is a plunger 54. A force application assembly and a linear actuator, that includes a shape memory actuation 278, drive the plunger 54. In FIG. 26, a shape memory wire 278 is in a cool, expanded state and is attached to a first support 241 and a plunger attachment cap 244. The cap 244 is in turn attached to a biasing spring 243 which is in turn attached to a second support 242. When the wire 278 is in an expanded state, the biasing spring 243 is in a relaxed state. FIG. 27 shows the shape memory actuator 278 in a contracted state due to application of an electric current to the wire 278 and coincident heating. Upon contraction, a force is exerted on the cap 244 causing an inserting movement of a plunger 54 and a corresponding pumping action. In the contracted state, the biasing spring 243 is in a high potential energy state. Upon cessation of application of the electric field, the Nitinol wire 278 cools and expands again, allowing the biasing spring 243 to return the plunger 54 to its retracted state. As shown in FIG. 21A-21B, a shape memory actuator 278 may be wound around one or more pulleys.

(296) FIGS. 28-30 show a variety of embodiments in which pumping is accomplished by a pumping actuation member 54 using a shape memory actuator 278 to compress a moveable member forming a pumping chamber. The pumping chamber is bounded by one way valves 21, 22. FIG. 28 shows an embodiment including a pumping mechanism where the pumping actuation member is a plunger 54 in a barrel 52. The mechanism also includes a lever 273, a fulcrum 274, and a shape memory actuator 278. A shape memory actuator 278 is held within a housing 298 and is attached at one end to a conductive support 279 and at the other end to a positive terminal 275 of a lever 273. The lever 273 is in turn attached at its center to a fulcrum 274 and at a second end to a plunger 54. An electric current is applied to cause current to flow through the terminal 275, the shape memory actuator 278, and the conductive support 279, thereby causing the shape memory actuator 278 to contract, causing lever 273 to pivot about the fulcrum 274 and effect withdrawal of the plunger 54. Cessation of the current allows cooling of the shape memory actuator 278, allowing it to expand. The return spring 276 acts via the lever 273 to return the plunger 54 to an inserted position within the barrel 52. The return spring 276 is held in a housing 277. An o-ring 281 prevents leaking of fluid from the plunger 54-barrel 52 assembly. The insertion and withdrawal of plunger 54 causes fluid to flow through the flow line in a direction determined by the orientation of two check valves: a first one way valve 21 and a second one way

valve 22. Any suitable backflow prevention device may be used, which include one way valve, check valves, duck bill valves, flapper valves, and volcano valves.

(297) FIG. 29 shows another embodiment of a pumping mechanism having a plunger 54, a barrel 52, and a force application assembly that includes a shape memory actuator 278. However, this embodiment, unlike the embodiment shown in FIG. 28, does not include a lever. A shape memory actuator 278 is held within a housing 298 and is attached at one end to a conductive support 279 and at the other end to a plunger cap 244 by way of contact 275. The plunger cap 244 is attached to the plunger 54. Once ample electric current is applied through a contact 275, the shape memory actuator 278 contracts. This contraction causes a pulling on the plunger cap 244 to effect insertion of the plunger 54 into the barrel 52. Cessation of the current allows cooling and of the shape memory actuator 278, thereby allowing it to expand. Upon expansion of the wire, the return spring 276 acts to return the plunger 54 to a withdrawn position within the barrel 52. The return spring 276 is held in a housing 277. O-rings 281 prevent fluid from leaking plunger 54-barrel 52 assembly. The insertion and withdrawal of the plunger 54 causes fluid to flow through the flow line in a direction determined by the orientation of a first one way valve 21 and a second one way valve 22.

(298) Referring now to FIG. 30, an embodiment of a pumping device using a plunger 54 and a barrel 52 is shown. In this embodiment, a shape memory actuator 278 in the form of a wire positioned in a shaft within the plunger 54 is used to impart force on the plunger. The shape memory actuator 278 extends from a plunger cap 272 through a shaft in a plunger 54 and through a channel 58 to a supporting base 299. O-rings 281 and 282 seal the plunger 54, barrel 52, and channel 58. Application of electrical current to a first lead 258 and a second lead 257 causes heating of the shape memory actuator 278 which results in contraction of the shape memory actuator 278. Contraction of the shape memory actuator 278 causes a downward force sufficient to overcome the upward bias of a return spring 276 to be exerted on the plunger cap 272, thereby driving the plunger 54 into the lumen 290 of the barrel 52. Expansion of the shape memory actuator 278 allows the return spring 276 to return the plunger 54 to a withdrawn position. The insertion and withdrawal of plunger 54 causes fluid to flow through the flow line in a direction determined by the orientation of a first one way valve 21 and a second one way valve 22.

(299) An alternate embodiment of the pumping mechanism is shown in FIG. 31. The pumping actuation member is an assembly 101 that combines the functions of a reservoir and pumping mechanism. Under the command of a controller 501, a motor 25 drives a plunger 102 to create pressure in a reservoir 104, thereby forcing fluid through a first one way valve 106. Fluid then enters the resilient dispensing chamber 122 of a volume sensing assembly 120 with a sensor 550, and to an exit assembly 17. An optional second one way valve 107 may be included. Feedback control between the sensor 550 and the motor 25 via the controller 501 assures the desired flow of fluid to the patient. The first one way valve 106 serves to prevent reverse flow of fluid due to the resilient force of the dispensing chamber 122 of the volume sensing assembly 120 when the chamber is filled and extended. The second one way valve 107 serves to prevent reverse flow of fluid from the exit assembly 17 or patient 12 into the dispensing chamber 122. In this embodiment, the sensor 550 can immediately detect the volume in the dispensing chamber 122.

(300) FIGS. 32-34 schematically show sectional views of a combined valving pump 2200. FIG. 32 shows the valving pump 2200 with a collection chamber 2345 and a pumping chamber 2350 in a resting position, prior to actuation; FIG. 33 shows the valving pump 2200 in an actuating state during a compression stroke; and FIG. 34 shows the pump in an actuated state at the end of a compression stroke. A pump inlet 2310 is in fluid communication with an upstream fluid source, such as a reservoir, and connects to a first end of a channel 2360. The channel 2360 connects at a second end to the collection chamber 2345, which is in fluid communication with a diaphragm aperture 2390 disposed in a resilient pumping diaphragm 2340. The collection chamber 2345 is bounded on a first side by the resilient pumping diaphragm 2340 and on a second side by a resilient pumping membrane 2330. The pumping membrane 2330 may be made from, among other things, latex or silicone rubber. The downstream side of the diaphragm aperture 2390 opens into the pumping chamber 2350. During priming of the pump and between actuation cycles, fluid travels from a fluid source such as a reservoir, through the pump inlet 2310, the channel 2360, the collection chamber 2345, and the diaphragm aperture 2390, and then arrives in the pumping chamber 2350. A one way valve 22 prevents fluid from leaving the pumping chamber 2350 via a pump outlet 2370 until and unless ample fluid pressure is exerted against the one way valve 22 such that the one way valve 22 is open. In FIG. 32 a pumping actuation member 2320 is shown in a resting position, and the resilient pumping membrane 2330 is shown in a relaxed configuration of minimal surface area, thereby maximizing the volume of the collection chamber 2345. Although in this embodiment, the pumping actuation member is shown as a ball, in other embodiments, the pumping actuation member can be anything capable of actuation and applying ample force against the resilient pumping membrane 2330 in order to actuate the pumping mechanism.

(301) As can be seen from FIG. 33, when the pumping actuation member 2320 is actuated during a compression stroke, the pumping actuation member 2320 begins to travel toward the diaphragm aperture 2390 of the resilient pumping diaphragm 2340 and distends the resilient pumping membrane 2330, causing retrograde flow of fluid that has collected in the collection chamber 2345. Later in the force application stroke, as shown in FIG. 34, the pumping actuation member 2320 will sealingly lodge the resilient pumping membrane 2330 against the diaphragm aperture 2390. To aid in sealing, the pumping actuation member 2320 may have a shape that is complementary to the shape of the diaphragm aperture 2390. For example, the pumping actuation member 2320 may be spherical or conical and the diaphragm aperture 2390 may be a cylindrical through-hole. At this stage of the force application stroke, retrograde flow from the pumping chamber 2350 will be inhibited. Continued travel of the pumping actuation member 2320 will deform the resilient pumping diaphragm 2340 and increase the pressure in the pumping chamber 2350, while continuing to seal the diaphragm aperture 2390 against retrograde flow from the pumping chamber 2350. When the pressure within the pumping chamber 2350 provides ample fluid pressure against the one way valve one way valve 22, fluid will flow from the pumping chamber 2350 through the pump outlet 2370. During the return stroke, the pumping actuation member 2320, resilient pumping membrane 2330 and resilient pumping diaphragm 2340 return to the relaxed positions shown in FIG. 32. During the return stroke, the internal pressure of pumping chamber 2350 and collection chamber 2345 will drop, which should encourage refilling of the valving pump 2200 by inducing flow of fluid from the fluid source through the pump inlet 2310 and channel 2360.

(302) Referring now to FIG. 35, a schematic sectional view of one embodiment of a resilient pumping diaphragm 2340 is shown. A diaphragm body 2515 may be constructed of a resilient material such as silicone rubber. A diaphragm spring 2510 may also be included to impart resiliency to a flexible, or already resilient, body 2515. The diaphragm spring 2510 may be embedded within the resilient pumping diaphragm 2340 or disposed adjacent to the resilient pumping diaphragm 2340. An example of one embodiment of a diaphragm spring 2510 can be seen in FIG. 36. A combination of a diaphragm body 2515 that includes a compliant material, and a diaphragm spring 2510 that includes a resilient material may be used; the result is a pumping diaphragm 2340 that will exhibit a high degree of sealing when contacted with the resilient pumping membrane 2330 deformed by a pumping actuation member (not shown, see FIGS. 32-34) and also have a high degree of resiliency. A valve seat 2517 may be positioned around the diaphragm aperture 2390. The valve seat 2517 may function as a receptacle for the deformed portion of the resilient pumping membrane 2330. The force application member 2320 may deform the pumping membrane 2330, causing the membrane 2330 to deform and sealingly contact the valve seat 2517. If sufficient force is applied, the valve seat may be resiliently deformed to ensure a thorough seal against retrograde flow of fluid. The ratio of the section height to the section width of the valve seat 2517 can generally be selected differently and matched to the circumstances of the flow.

(303) Now referring to FIG. 36, an example of a diaphragm spring 2510 for use in the pumping diaphragm 2340 of FIG. 35 is shown. An outer annulus 2520 and an inner annulus 2540 are connected by at least three resilient arms 2530. The center of the inner annulus 2540 has a spring aperture 2550, which may be aligned with the diaphragm aperture 2390 of the pumping diaphragm 2340 as shown in FIG. 35.

(304) Referring now to FIG. 37, a schematic is shown representing a sectional view of the valving pump 2200 previously shown in FIGS. 32-34 in combination with a force application assembly which includes a pumping actuation member 2320, an actuator, and a lever 273. When energized by an actuator, such as a shape memory actuator 278, the lever 273 pivots around a fulcrum 274 to initiate a compression stroke. A hammer 2630

protrudes from the lever 273. During the compression stroke, the hammer 2630 contacts a rounded pumping actuation member 2320, causing the pumping actuation member to travel within a void in a support structure 2660, and pushing the pumping actuation member 2320 against a resilient pumping membrane 2330 until the pumping actuation member 2320 is held sealingly against a diaphragm aperture 2390 located in the resilient pumping diaphragm 2340. As the lever 273 continues travel, the pumping actuation member 2320 causes deformation of a pumping diaphragm 2340. When enough fluid pressure is exerted onto the one way valve 22, the one way valve 22 opens. This allows the fluid to flow from a pumping chamber 2350 through a pump outlet 2370. Upon cooling of the shape memory actuator 278, the resiliency of the pumping diaphragm 2340 and the resilient pumping membrane 2330 will cause return of the lever 273 to a starting position determined by a lever stop 2650 and lever catch 2640. Alternately, a return spring (not shown) may be used to return the lever 273 to the starting position. Although shown as a sphere, the force application member 2320 may alternately be a piston, a protrusion of the lever 273 or other suitable form.

(305) FIG. 38 schematically shows a sectional view of an embodiment of a valving pump using a resilient cylindrical flexure 2670. In one embodiment, the resilient cylindrical flexure is made from rubber, but in other embodiments, it can be made from any resilient material. The cylindrical flexure 2670 has a central passageway 2675, and a plurality of resilient radial fins 2672 that are sealingly arranged against a housing 2673. Fluid entering through a pump inlet 2310 passes through a channel 2360 and collects in regions upstream of a one way valve 22: a collection chamber 2345, the central passageway 2675 of the cylindrical flexure 2670, and a pumping chamber 2350. The pumping chamber is coupled in fluid communication with the collection chamber 2345 through the central passageway 2675. During the pumping mechanism's compression stroke, a pumping actuation member 2320 applies force to, and deforms, a resilient pumping membrane 2330 until the resilient pumping membrane 2330 is sealingly held against a valve seat 2680 of the cylindrical flexure 2670; retrograde flow to the pump inlet 2310 from the collection chamber 2345 is thereby blocked. Continued travel of the pumping actuation member 2320 causes deformation of the cylindrical flexure 2670; the pressure within the pumping chamber 2350 increases until such time that it is ample to open the one way valve 22. Fluid can then flows through a pump outlet 2370.

(306) The pumping actuation member 2320 is shown as a ball shape in FIG. 38. However in other embodiments, the pumping actuation member 2320 can be any shape that can function as described above.

(307) Referring now to FIG. 39, an alternate embodiment of the cylindrical flexure 2670 (shown in FIG. 38) employing a resilient portion 2680 and a rigid cylindrical support 2690 is shown. Like the cylindrical flexure 2680 of FIG. 38, the resilient portion of the cylindrical flexure 2670 includes a valve seat 2680 which seals the central passageway 2675 upon application of force by a pumping actuation member 2320. Thus, the resilient portion 2680 of the cylindrical flexure 2670 deforms to transmit pressure to the pumping chamber 2350.

(308) FIGS. 40-44 schematically show sectional views of an alternate embodiment of a valving pump in various states of actuation. The valving pumps 2200 of FIGS. 40-44 have a resilient diaphragm spring 6100 and a resilient sealing membrane 6120 which together serve a function that is similar to that of the resilient pumping diaphragm 2340 of the valving pump 2200 shown in FIGS. 32-34. FIG. 40 shows the valving pump 2200 in a resting state. In the resting state, fluid may flow from the inlet 2360, into an upper portion 2346 of the collection chamber 2345, through an aperture 6110 in the diaphragm spring 6100 and into a lower portion 2347 of the collection chamber 2345. Fluid then may proceed through one or more openings 6130 in a sealing membrane 6120 and into the pumping chamber 2350. Under low-pressure conditions, further fluid flow is hindered by a one way valve 22. The spring diaphragm 6100 and sealing membrane 6120 may both be constructed from resilient, biocompatible materials. The spring diaphragm 6100 may have a greater resiliency than the sealing membrane 6120. For example, the spring diaphragm 6100 may be a circular piece of flexible bio-inert plastic and the sealing membrane 6120 may be a sheet of silicone or fluorosilicone elastomer.

(309) FIGS. 41 and 42 show the valving pump 2200 in two intermediate, partially actuated states. The pumping actuation member 2320 deforms the pumping membrane 2330 and forces it through the collection chamber 2345 and against the spring diaphragm 6100, which, in turn, is deformed and forced against the sealing membrane 6120. At this point in the compression stroke, retrograde flow through either the aperture 6110 of the spring diaphragm 6100, or through openings 6130 in the sealing membrane 6120, or both, are suppressed. Offset placement of the sealing membrane openings 6130 relative to the spring aperture 6100 allows a seal to be created between the spring diaphragm 6100 and the sealing membrane 6120. In some embodiments this seal may be supplemented with a redundant seal between the fill chamber resilient pumping membrane 2330 and the spring diaphragm 6100 (the embodiments of FIGS. 43-44, for example, lack this redundant seal). A circumferential ridge (not shown) around the spring diaphragm aperture 6110 may act as a valve seat to enhance the seal.

(310) Referring now to FIG. 42, continued travel of the pumping actuation member 2320 causes further deformation of the pumping membrane 2330, spring diaphragm 6100, and sealing membrane 6120. As a result, fluid in the pumping chamber 2350 is compressed until the fluid pressure forces the one way valve 22 open; further compression causes fluid egress through the outlet 2370.

(311) An alternate embodiment of the valving pump 2200 of FIGS. 40-42 is shown schematically in FIG. 43. In this embodiment, a pumping actuation member 2320 traverses the resilient pumping membrane 2330. The pumping membrane 2330 is sealingly attached to the circumference of the pumping actuation member 2320 at a midpoint along the length of the pumping actuation member 2320. When actuated, the diaphragm spring aperture 6110 is sealed against backflow by the sealing membrane 6120 alone; the resilient pumping membrane 2330 will not contact the aperture 6110. An alternate embodiment of the device shown in FIG. 40 is shown in FIG. 44.

(312) Referring now to FIG. 45, a sectional view of an alternate embodiment of a combined valving pump 2200 is shown. A shape memory actuator 278 actuates a compression stroke which causes a resilient pump blade 2710 to lever about a fulcrum 274, causing the resilient pumping membrane 2330 to be deformed. The resilient pump blade 2710 and resilient pumping membrane 2330 apply pressure to fluid in a graded pumping chamber 2720 having a shallow region 2730 and a deeper region 2740. Early in the compression stroke, the pump blade 2710 induces the resilient pumping membrane 2330 to obstruct a channel 2360 that connects a pump inlet 2310 to the graded pumping chamber 2720. As the compression stroke continues, force is applied to the fluid in the graded pumping chamber 2720 until the fluid pressure in the graded pumping chamber 2720 is great enough to open a one way valve 22. Fluid then exits a pump outlet 2370. The pump blade 2710 may be constructed entirely or partly from a resilient material such as rubber. In some embodiments, the resilient material includes a non-resilient spline. Alternately, in some embodiments, the resiliency is imparted through a resilient region 2750, thus, the resilient region 2750 is the only resilient part of the pump blade 2710 in these embodiments. In these embodiments, the resilient region 2750 contacts the bottom of the graded pumping chamber 2720. The resiliency of pump blade 2710 allows the compression stroke to continue after the pumping blade 2710 contacts the base 2780 of the shallow region 2730. A return spring (not shown) returns the pump blade 2710 to a starting position during the return stroke.

(313) Referring now to FIG. 46, a sectional view of an alternate embodiment of a pumping mechanism is shown. This embodiment includes a resilient pump blade 2710. The resilient pump blade 2710 includes a resilient region 2830 which provides resiliency to the pump blade 2710. The resilient region 2830 joins a pumping actuation member 2820 to a pump blade 2810. When used with a valving pump (not shown) the resilient pump blade 2710 of FIG. 42 will occlude the inlet channel (not shown, shown in FIG. 45 as 2360) and then bend at the flexible region 2830 to allow the force application member 2820 to apply further pressure to the fluid in the graded pumping chamber (not shown, shown in FIG. 45 as 2720). The force application member 2820 may be constructed entirely of a resilient material such as rubber. However, in alternate embodiments, only a region that contacts the bottom of the pumping chamber (not shown) is made from resilient material. The resilient pump blade 2710 will return to its relaxed conformation during the return stroke.

(314) Referring now to FIG. 47, a sectional view of another embodiment of pumping mechanism is shown. The pumping mechanism is shown where the lever is at the intermediate stage of actuation with the inlet valve 2941 closed. The pumping mechanism includes a fluid line 2930, a moveable member 2330, which is a membrane in this embodiment, an inlet valve 2941 poppet 2940, a pumping actuation member 2942, a pumping chamber 2350, and an exit valve 22. The inlet valve 2941 and the pumping actuation member 2942 are each actuated by the shape memory actuator 278 which is surrounded by return spring 276 and connected to a lever 273. The lever 273 actuates both the inlet valve 2941 and the pumping actuation member

2942. The lever **273** includes an elongate and spring member **2910** that is attached to the lever **273** hinged to fulcrum **274** and terminated in a valve actuation hammer **2946**. The spring member **2910** may be curved. The spring member **2910** biases the position of the valve actuation hammer **2946** away from the lever **273** and toward the inlet valve **2941**. The lever **273** has a pump actuation hammer **2948**, which is not attached to the spring member **2910**, and is positioned adjacent to the pumping actuation member **2942**.

(315) Electric current causes the shape memory actuator **278** to contract and the lever **273** pivots about the fulcrum **274**. The pivoting places the valve actuated hammer **2946** in position to force the inlet valve **2941** closed. As the shape memory actuator **278** continues to contract, the lever **273** continues pivoting and the pump actuation hammer **2948** forces the pump actuation member **2942** against the pumping chamber **2350**, even while further compressing the elongate spring member **2910**. Upon achieving sufficient pressure, the fluid pressure opens the exit valve **22**, and fluid exits through the valve.

(316) During the relaxation stroke, the return spring **276** unloads and returns the lever **273** to the starting position, releasing the pumping actuation member **2942**. The inlet valve **2941** opens. The resiliency of the pumping chamber **2350** causes the pumping chamber **2350** to refill.

(317) Referring now to FIGS. **48** and **49** schematically show a cross section of an embodiment in which a pumping mechanism employs a bell crank **7200** and combines a valving pump **2200** with a flow biasing valve. The bell crank **7200** converts force produced by the linear shape memory actuator **278** into a transverse pumping force. FIG. **48** shows the mechanism in a resting or refilling mode and FIG. **49** shows the mechanism in an actuated state. Contraction of the actuator **278** causes the bell crank **7200** to rotate around a shaft **7210** and press upon the force application member **2320**, which drives a resilient membrane **7220** to seal against the resilient pumping diaphragm **2340** and urge fluid from the pumping chamber **2350** toward the dispensing chamber **122**. The return spring **276** cooperates with a return spring support **7221** to release the pumping force, causing the pumping chamber **2350** to expand and draw fluid from the reservoir **20**. Still referring to FIGS. **48** and **49**, the flow biasing valve **4000** is also shown, having a valve spring **4010**, a poppet or plunger **4020**.

(318) In some of the embodiments of the pumping mechanism described above, one or more aspects of the following valving operation description is relevant. Referring now to FIG. **50**, an example of a flow biasing valve **4000** is shown, closed. A valve spring **4010** exerts force on a poppet **4020** to sealingly press a valve membrane **4060** against a valve seat **4070** surrounding a terminal aperture of a valve outlet **4040**. The valve seat **4070** may include a circumferentially raised portion to improve sealing. As explained below with references to FIGS. **54-55**, back pressure created by the action of a resilient dispensing assembly should be insufficient to cause retrograde flow through the flow biasing valve **4000**. As shown in FIG. **51**, when the pumping assembly is actuated, sufficient pressure should be generated to unseat the membrane **4060** and the poppet **4020** from the valve seat **4070** thereby allowing fluid to flow from the valve inlet **4030**, through an inlet chamber **4050** and to the valve outlet **4040**. FIGS. **52-53** shows an alternate valve that has a valve seat **4070** without a circumferentially raised portion.

(319) Referring now to FIGS. **54** and **55**, illustrations of how an exemplary flow biasing valve discriminates between forward and retrograde flow are shown. FIG. **54** schematically represents the valve in a closed position. Back pressure in the outlet **4040** applies force to a relatively small area of the flexible valve membrane **4060** adjacent to the valve seat **4070** and is thus unable to dislodge the poppet **4020**. Referring now to FIG. **55**, this FIG. schematically represents the valve during the actuation of a pumping actuation member. The pressure of the pumped fluid applies force over an area of the membrane **4060** that is larger than the area adjacent to the valve seat. As a result, inlet pressure has a larger mechanical advantage for unseating the poppet **4020** and forward flow should ensue in response to the action of the pumping actuation member. Thus, the critical pressure needed to displace the poppet **4020** is lower in the inlet than in the outlet. Accordingly, the spring biasing force and the size of the force application areas associated with both the fluid inlets and fluid exits may be chosen so that flow is substantially in the forward direction.

(320) Referring now to FIG. **56**, a sectional view of an adjustable flow biasing valve **4130** which operates on a principal similar to the flow biasing valve in FIG. **50**, but allows adjustment of the pressure necessary to open the valve, i.e., “cracking pressure” (which, in some embodiments, can be from 0.2 to 20 pounds per square inch or “psi”) is shown. The cracking pressure is adjusted by turning a spring tensioning screw **4090**, which alters the volume of the recess **4080** to compress or decompress the valve spring **4010** thereby altering the spring **4010** biasing force. The valve spring **4010** biases a plunger **4100** against the valve membrane **4060** to force it against the valve seat. The plunger **4100** serves a force application function similar to the fixed force poppet of the flow biasing valve (shown as **4020** and **4000** respectively, in FIGS. **50-53**). Compressing the valve spring **4010** will increase its bias, thereby increasing the cracking pressure. Conversely, decompressing the spring **4010** will decrease its bias and the associated cracking pressure. The valve spring **4010** is positioned coaxially around the shaft of a plunger **4100** and exerts its biasing force on the plunger **4100**. In some embodiments, the shaft of the plunger **4100** may be shorter than both the length of the valve spring **4010** and the recess **4080** to allow it to be freely displaced in response to increased fluid pressure in the fluid inlet **4030**. The plunger **4100** may be any size necessary to function as desired. As in the embodiment of FIGS. **50-53**, the wetted parts may reside in a disposable portion **2610** and the force application components (e.g., the plunger and spring) may reside in the reusable portion **2620**. The principal of operation is also similar; a larger mechanical advantage in the fluid inlet **4030** relative the outlet **4040** favors forward flow versus retrograde flow. Alternately, the plunger **4100** may be replaced by the poppet (shown as **4020** in FIGS. **50-55**). In some embodiments, it may be desirable to eliminate the raised valve seat; in these embodiments, the plunger may be ball shaped or another shape capable of concentrating the force.

(321) The flow biasing valve **4000** substantially reduces or prevents retrograde flow from the dispensing chamber **122** into the pumping chamber **2350**. As in FIGS. **50-56**, a valve spring **4010** biases a poppet or plunger **4040** to press the membrane **7220** against a valve seat **4070** in a way that provides mechanical advantage to forward flow through the line **310**. By serving the function of the pumping membrane **2330** and the valve membrane, membrane **7220** allows the line **310**, pumping chamber **2350** and pumping diaphragm **2340** to reside in one component (e.g., the disposable portion **2610**) and the remainder of the pumping mechanism in a second, removable component (e.g., the reusable portion **2620**). By placing the more durable and expensive components in the reusable portion **2620**, economy and convenience may be realized.

(322) The pumping mechanism described in the various embodiments above can be used in various devices to pump fluid. As an exemplary embodiment, the pumping mechanism described in FIGS. **59A-59E**, FIGS. **60A-60D** and FIGS. **60A-60C** will be described as integrated into a fluid pumping device.

(323) Referring FIGS. **57** and **58**, alternate ways are shown for the fluid schematic. These are two schematics where the reservoir **20** and pumping assembly **16** are coupled to the dispensing assembly **120**. In the embodiment shown in FIG. **57**, the reservoir and pumping assembly are coupled in series to the dispensing assembly **120**. In the embodiment shown in FIG. **58**, a shunt line **150** is coupled from the output of the pumping assembly **16** back to the reservoir **20**. Since much of the fluid output of the pumping assembly **16** is returned to the reservoir **20** via the shunt line **150**, the pumping assembly **16** can accommodate varieties of pumping mechanisms **16** that may not function as desired in the embodiment shown in FIG. **57**. Thus, in some embodiments, where a large volume pumping mechanism is employed, the shunt line **150** can impart small volume functionality to a large volume pumping mechanism. One way valves **21** and **22** are oriented in the same direction and included to prevent unwanted backflow.

(324) Referring now to FIG. **59A**, a fluid schematic of one embodiment of a fluid pumping device is shown. In this embodiment, fluid is located in a reservoir **20** connected to a fluid line **310**. Fluid line **310** is in communication with pumping mechanism **16**, separated by a membrane **2356**. The fluid is pumped through a flow restrictor **340** to an infusion device or cannula **5010** for delivery to a patient. It should be understood that the infusion device or cannula **5010** is not part of the device as such, but is attached to a patient for delivery of the fluid. System embodiments are described in more detail below and these include an infusion device or cannula **5010**.

(325) Referring now to FIG. **59B**, an alternate embodiment of the schematic shown in FIG. **59A** is shown. In the embodiment shown in FIG. **59A**, the fluid is pumped through a flow restrictor **340** then through a cannula **5010**. However, in FIG. **59B**, the fluid is not pumped through a flow restrictor; rather, the fluid is pumped, having the same impedance, through the cannula **5010**.

(326) In both FIGS. **59A** and **59B**, the volume of fluid pumped to the patient, in one embodiment, is calculated roughly by pump strokes. The length

of the stroke will provide a rough estimate of the volume pumped to the patient.

(327) Referring now to FIG. 59C, a fluid schematic of one embodiment of a fluid pumping device is shown. In this embodiment, fluid is located in a reservoir **20** connected to a fluid line **310** by a septum **6270**. Fluid line **310** is in communication with pumping mechanism **16**, separated by a membrane **2356**. The fluid is pumped to a variable volume delivery chamber **122** and then through a flow restrictor **340** to a cannula **5010** for delivery to a patient.

(328) The volume of fluid delivered is determined using the dispensing assembly **120** which includes an acoustic volume sensing (AVS) assembly, as described above, a variable volume delivery chamber **122**, and a dispensing spring **130**. Similarly to the pumping mechanism, a membrane **2356** forms the variable volume dispensing chamber **122**. The membrane is made of the same material (or, in some embodiments, different material) from the membrane **2356** in the pumping mechanism **16** (described in detail above). The AVS assembly is described in greater detail above.

(329) Referring now to FIG. 59D, an alternate embodiment to the embodiment shown in FIG. 59C, in this embodiment, there is no flow restrictor between the variable volume delivery chamber **122** and the cannula **5010**. Referring now to FIG. 59E, an alternate embodiment to the embodiment shown in FIG. 59C is shown, with an alternate pumping mechanism **16**.

(330) Referring now to FIGS. 59A-59E, the reservoir **20** can be any source of a fluid, including but not limited to a syringe, a collapsible reservoir bag, a glass bottle, a glass vial or any other container capable of safely holding the fluid being delivered. The septum **6270** is the connection point between the fluid line **310** and the reservoir **20**. Various embodiments of the septum **6270** and the reservoir **20** are described in more detail below.

(331) The fluid delivery device embodiment shown in FIGS. 59A-59E can be used for the delivery of any type of fluid. Additionally, the embodiments can be used as one, two or three separate mating parts. Referring now to FIGS. 60A-60D, the same embodiments described with respect to FIGS. 59A-59D are shown as separated into mating parts. Part X includes the movable parts while part Y includes the fluid line **310** and the membrane **2356**. In some embodiments of this design, part Y is a disposable portion while part X is a non-disposable portion. Part X does not come into contact directly with the fluid, part Y is the only part having wetted areas. In the above embodiments, the reservoir **20** can any size and is either integrated into the disposable or a separate disposable part. In either embodiment, the reservoir **20** can be refillable. In embodiments where the reservoir **20** is integrated into the disposable part Y, the reservoir **20** can either be manufactured filled with fluid, or, a patient or user fills the reservoir **20** using a syringe through the septum **6270**. In embodiments where the reservoir **20** is a separate mating part, the reservoir **20** can either be manufactured filled with fluid, or, a patient or user fills the reservoir **20** using a syringe (not shown) through the septum **6270** as part of a reservoir loading device (not shown, described in more detail below) or manually using a syringe through the septum **6270**. Further detail regarding the process of filling a reservoir **20** is described below.

(332) Although various embodiments have been described with respect to FIGS. 59A-59E and FIGS. 60A-60D, the pumping mechanism can be any pumping mechanism described as embodiments herein or alternate embodiments having similar function and characteristics. For example, referring now to FIG. 61A, a similar embodiment as that shown in FIG. 59A is shown having a representative block that includes pumping mechanism **16**. This is to show that any pumping mechanism **16** described herein or functioning similarly can be used in the fluid pumping device. Likewise, FIG. 61B and FIG. 61C are representations of systems encompassing the embodiments FIG. 59B and FIG. 59C respectively.

(333) The schematics of a fluid pumping device described above can be implemented in a device usable by a patient. There are a number of embodiments. The device can be a stand-alone device or be integrated into another device. The device can be any size or shape. The device can be either portable or non-portable. The term “portable” means a patient can, transport the device either in a pocket area, strapped to the body, or otherwise. The term “non-portable” means that the device is in a healthcare institution or in the home, but the patient does not carry the device almost everywhere they move. The remainder of this description will focus on portable devices as the exemplary embodiment.

(334) With respect to portable devices, the device can be worn by a patient or carried by a patient. In the embodiments where the device is worn by a patient, this is referred to as a “patch pump” for purposes of this description. Where the device is carried by a patient, this is referred to as a “portable pump” for purposes of this description.

(335) The following description is applicable to various embodiments for either the patch pump embodiments or the portable pump embodiments. In various embodiments, the device includes a housing, a pumping mechanism, a fluid line, a moveable member, a reservoir, a power source and a microprocessor. In various embodiments, a dispensing assembly, for example a volume sensing device, which in some embodiments includes an AVS assembly, are included in the device. Also, an embodiment can also include a fluid restrictor, although it is not depicted in the following figures, as the fluid line is shown as homogeneous to simplify the illustration. For purposes of this description, where a dispensing assembly is included, the exemplary embodiment will include an AVS assembly. Although an AVS assembly is a preferred embodiment, in other embodiments, other types of volume sensing device can be used. In some embodiments, however, no volume sensing device is used, but rather, either the reservoir itself will determine the volume of fluid delivered, the pump stroke is used to roughly determine the amount of volume delivered. It should be understood that the schematic devices shown herein are meant to illustrate some of the variations in the device. The embodiments represented by these schematics can each also include a sensor housing, a vibration motor, an antenna, a radio, or other components that are described with respect to FIGS. 70-70D. Thus, these depictions are not meant to limit the components but rather to illustrate how various components could interrelate in a device.

(336) Referring now to FIG. 62A, schematics of a stand alone device **10** are shown. The housing **10** can be any shape or size and accommodates the intended use. For example, where the device is used as a patch, the device will be compact enough to be worn as such. Where the device is used as a portable pump, the device will be compact enough to be used accordingly. In some embodiments, the housing is made from plastic, and in some embodiments, the plastic is any injection molded fluid-compatible plastic, for example, polycarbonate. In other embodiments, the housing is made from a combination of aluminum or titanium and plastic or any other material, in some embodiments the materials are light and durable. Additional materials may include, but are not limited to, rubber, steel, titanium, and alloys of the same. As shown in FIG. 62A, the device **10** can be any size or shape desired.

(337) FIGS. 62A-69B are schematics showing representative embodiments. The exact design is dependant on many factors, including, but not limited to, size of the device, power restrictions and intended use. Thus, FIGS. 62A-69B are intended to describe the various features of a device and the possible combinations, however, actual devices can be readily designed and implemented by one or ordinary skill in the art. As examples, embodiments of devices are described and shown below. However, these are not intended to be limiting, but rather, are intended to be examples.

(338) Referring now to FIG. 62B, with respect to the patch device, in some embodiments, the housing **10** includes an insertion area viewing window **342**. This allows for the area on a patient where the infusion device or cannula (not shown) is inserted to be viewed. Shown here is the cannula housing **5030** area of the device **10**. The viewing window **342** is made from any material capable of being transparent, including, but not limited to, plastic. Although the viewing window **342** is shown to be in one particular location on one particular shaped device, a viewing window **342** can be integrated in any location desired in any housing embodiment.

(339) Referring now to FIG. 63A, a device **10** is shown. A reservoir **20** is shown connected to a fluid line **310**, which is then connected to a pumping mechanism **16**. A dispensing assembly **120** is shown connected to the fluid line **310**. The pumping mechanism **16** and dispensing assembly **120** are separated from the fluid line **310** by a membrane **2356**. The cannula housing **5030** is downstream from the volume measuring device. Shape memory actuators **278** are shown connected to the pumping mechanism **16**. A microprocessor on a printed circuit board **13** as well as a power source or battery **15** are included. A flow impedance as described above can also be implemented between the dispensing assembly **120** and the cannula housing **5030**.

(340) Referring now to FIG. 63B, a similar device **10** as shown in FIG. 63A is shown, except in this embodiment, a dispensing assembly is not included. In this embodiment, the volume of fluid delivered will depend on either the pump strokes (number and length), the reservoir **20** (volume and time), both, or any other method described previously with respect to monitoring the volume of fluid delivered.

(341) Referring now to FIG. 63C, a similar device **10** as shown in FIG. 63B is shown, except the device **10** includes a dispensing chamber **122** and sensor housing **5022**.

(342) Referring now to FIG. 64A, one embodiment of the patch pump device **10** is shown. This embodiment is based on the embodiment of the device **10** shown in FIG. 63A. In this embodiment, the patch pump device **10** is divided into two sections: a top X and a base Y. The top X contains the pumping mechanism **16**, a dispensing assembly **120** (which is optional, but is shown as an exemplary embodiment), the power supply **15**, and the microprocessor and printed circuit board **13**. These are the non-wetted elements, i.e., they do not come into direct contact with the fluid. The base Y contains the fluid line **310** and the membrane **2356**. Where the reservoir **20** is built into the device, the reservoir is also contained on the base Y. However, in embodiments where the reservoir **20** is a separate mating part, the reservoir **20** is connected to the fluid line when fully assembled (see FIG. 66A-66D and description referring thereto), however, is not built into the device.

(343) The patch pump device also includes a cannula housing **5030**. This is the area the cannula line **5031** is located. Part of the fluid line **310**, the cannula line **5031** allows a cannula (or other infusion device) to receive the fluid and deliver the fluid to a patient (not shown).

(344) Referring now to FIG. 65A, in some embodiments, the cannula **5010** is inserted through the housing **5030** directly into the patient. The cannula **5010** is connected to a septum (not shown) connecting the cannula line **5031** to the cannula **5010**. Referring now to FIG. 65B, in other embodiments, an insertion set, (including the cannula and tubing, not shown in FIG. 65B, but shown in FIG. 64B as items **5033** and **5010**) is used; thus, the tubing **5033** of the insertion set will connect to the cannula line **5030** on one end and will connect to the cannula (not shown) on the opposite end of the tubing.

(345) Referring again to FIG. 64A, in use, the reservoir **20**, having fluid contained inside (which, as described above, is either molded into the base Y or is separate and attached to the base Y) is connected to the fluid line **310**. The microprocessor on the printed circuit board **13** sends a signal to activate the pumping mechanism **16** and a stroke is initiated through electrical current being applied to the shape memory actuators **278**. The fluid flows from the reservoir **20**, in the fluid line **310** to the dispensing assembly **120**, or AVS assembly. There, the exact volume of fluid inside the AVS chamber is determined and the fluid is forced out of the AVS chamber, to the cannula line **5031** and the cannula housing **5030**.

(346) Referring now to FIG. 64B, the device shown in FIG. 64A is shown connected to an insertion set, tubing **5033** and cannula **5010**. In FIG. 64C, the base Y of the device is shown using an adhesive patch or pad **3100** to the body of a patient **12**. It should be noted that in this embodiment, the element **3100** can be either a pad or patch. However, as described in more detail below, item **3100** is called a patch, and item **3220** is called a pad. For simplicity purposes only, item **3100** is used; however, in some embodiments, a pad is used, thus item **3220** would be appropriate in those circumstances.

(347) The cannula **5010**, which is inserted through the cannula housing **5030** so that it mates by way of the cannula septum **5060** to the cannula line **5031**, is inserted into a patient **12**. However, as shown and described above with respect to FIG. 2B, the base Y can be fluidly attached to a patient through an insertion set, which includes a tubing **5033** and a cannula **5010**. In both FIGS. 64B and 64C, the base Y can be adhered to a patient either before or after insertion of the cannula **5010**. Referring again to FIG. 2C, the cannula **5010**, once inserted into the patient **12**, will receive fluid from the device directly without an infusion set tubing (shown in FIG. 64B). The base Y is adhered to the patient **12** with an adhesive patch **3100** either before or after insertion of the cannula **5010**. Referring now to FIG. 64D, the top X of the device **10** is then attached to the base Y of the device **10** after the cannula **5010** has been inserted into the patient **12**.

(348) As described below, the adhesive patch can have many embodiments and in some cases, the patch is placed on top of the device. Thus, the patch shown in these embodiments is only one embodiment. As described above, a pad, if used, would be placed in the same location as the patch in FIGS. 64A-64D.

(349) Referring now to FIGS. 66A-66D, in this embodiment, the reservoir **20** is shown as a separate part. As shown in FIG. 66A, the base Y includes a reservoir cavity **2645** with a septum needle **6272**. Shown in FIG. 66B, the reservoir **20** is first placed in a top reservoir cavity **2640**. At this point, the reservoir **20** is not attached to the device. Now, referring to FIG. 66C, when the top X is placed over the base Y, the reservoir **20** is sandwiched into the base reservoir cavity **2645**. Shown in FIG. 66D, the force created by the attachment of the top to the base Y push the septum needle **6272** into the septum **6270** of the reservoir **20** connecting the reservoir **20** to the fluid line **310** of the base Y.

(350) Referring now to FIGS. 67A-F, alternate embodiments of the embodiments shown in FIGS. 64A, 64C and 66A-66D are shown. In these alternate embodiments, in addition to a cannula housing **5030**, the base Y includes a sensor housing **5022**. Referring now to FIGS. 69A-69B, both the sensor housing **5022** and the cannula housing **5030** include an exit to the underside of the base Y, shown in FIG. 69A as **5022** and **5030** respectively. FIG. 69B depicts the embodiment shown in FIG. 69A with the sharps protruding through the housings. The sensor housing accommodates a sensor. In some embodiments, the sensor is an analyte sensor. Analytes sensed include blood glucose, but in other embodiments, this analyte sensor can be any type of analyte sensor desired.

(351) Referring now to FIG. 67B, the base Y is shown on the body of a patient **12**. The sensor **5020** is shown having been inserted through the base Y sensor housing **5022** and into the patient **12**. Referring now to FIG. 67C, in some embodiments, the cannula **5010** and sensor **5020** are inserted through their respective housing (**5030** and **5022**) and into the patient **12** simultaneously. Referring next to FIG. 67D, the base Y is shown attached to the patient with both a cannula **5010** and sensor **5020** attached to the patient **12** through the base Y.

(352) Referring now to FIG. 67E, the base Y is shown attached to a patient **12** and the cannula **5010** inserted through the cannula housing **5030**. In this embodiment, the sensor housing **5022** is shown without a sensor. However, a sensor **5020** is shown inserted into the patient **12** in another location. Thus, the sensor **5020** is not required to be inserted through the base Y, but embodiments described below relating to monitoring blood glucose and pumping insulin through a cannula can be implemented in this way. Additionally, other embodiments relating to administering a fluid in response or relation to an analyte level can be administered this way.

(353) Referring now to FIG. 67F, the device **10**, having both a sensor **5020** and a cannula **5010** through the base Y is shown with the top X placed on. Again, in the embodiments shown in FIGS. 66A-66D, once the top X is placed onto the base Y, the reservoir **20** is fluidly connected to the fluid line **310**.

(354) Referring now to FIG. 68, one embodiment of the portable pump embodiment of the device **10** is shown. In this device **10**, an insertion set, including a cannula **5010** and tubing **5033**, is necessary to connect the fluid line in the device **10** to the patient **12**. Thus, the cannula **5010** is not connected, in this embodiment, through the portable pump device **10** to the patient **12** directly. Additionally, although this embodiment can function as described below with respect to an analyte sensor and a fluid pump, the sensor **5020** will be located outside the portable pump device **10** similar to the embodiment of the sensor **5020** shown in FIG. 5F.

(355) Referring now to FIGS. 70-70D, both the patch pump and portable pump embodiments as described additionally contain various components of the dispensing assembly (in applicable embodiments) and for embodiments including the AVS assembly, the various components thereof, including, at least one microphone, a temperature sensor, at least one speaker, a variable volume dispensing chamber, a variable volume chamber, a port and a reference chamber. In some embodiments, the device contains one or more of the following: a vibrator motor (and, in those embodiments, a motor driver), an antenna, a radio, a skin temperature sensor, a bolus button, and in some embodiments, one or more additional buttons. In some embodiments, the antenna is a quarter-wavelength trace antenna. In other embodiments the antenna may be a half-wavelength or quarter wavelength trace, dipole, monopole, or loop antenna. The radio, in some embodiments, is a 2.4 GHz radio, but in other embodiments, the radio is a 400 MHz radio. In still other embodiments, the radio can be any frequency radio. Thus, in some embodiments, the device includes a radio strong enough to communicate to a receiver within a few feet in distance from the device. In some embodiments, the device includes a second radio. In some embodiments, the second radio may be a specific long-range radio, for example, a 433 or 900 MHz radio or, in some embodiments, any frequency within the ISM band or other bands. Not shown in FIGS. 70-70D, the device, in some embodiments, contains a screen and/or a user interface.

(356) The following description of these components and their interconnections are applicable to both device types, and further, to the various embodiments described with respect to each device type. Referring now to FIG. 67F, for illustration purposes only, both the cannula **5010** and the sensor **5020** have been inserted into the device **10**. Also, referring to FIGS. 70-70D, the various components, some of which will not necessarily be included in all embodiments, are shown in a schematic representing the electrical connections of those components. FIGS. 70-70D therefore represent the various elements that could be included in the device. These can be mixed and matched depending on size requirements, power restrictions, usage and preferences, as well as other variables. FIG. 70 shows the relation of FIGS. 70A-70D.

(357) The device contains at least one microprocessor **271**. This can be any speed microprocessor capable of processing, at a minimum, the various electrical connections necessary for the device to function. In some embodiments, the device contains more than one microprocessor, as seen in FIGS. 70A-70B, the device is shown having two microprocessors **271**.

(358) The microprocessor **271** (or in some embodiments, microprocessors) is connected to the main printed circuit board (hereinafter, the "PCB" refers to the term "printed circuit board") **13**. A power source, which in some embodiments is a battery **15**, is connected to the main PCB **13**. In one embodiment, the battery **15** is a lithium polymer battery capable of being recharged. In other embodiments, the battery can be a replaceable battery or a rechargeable battery of any type.

(359) In some embodiments, the device includes a radio **370** connected to the main PCB **13**. The radio **370** communicates to a remote controller **3470** using the antenna **3580**. The communication between the device **10** and the remote controller **3470** is therefore wireless.

(360) In some embodiments, the device contains a vibration motor **3210**. The vibration motor **3210** is connected to a motor driver **3211** on the main PCB **13** motor driver **3211**.

(361) Some embodiments include a bolus button **3213**. The bolus button **3213** functions by a user applying force to a button form **3213**, which can be made from rubber or any other suitable material. The force actuates the bolus button actuation, which is attached to a bolus button switch **3214** on the main PCB **13**. The switch **3214** activates a single bolus which will indicate a particular pre-determined volume of fluid is to be delivered to the patient. After the user presses the bolus button **3213**, in some embodiments, the device **10** will generate an alarm (e.g., activate the vibration motor **3210** and/or send a signal to the remote controller) to signal to the user that the button **3213** was pressed. The user will then need to confirm the bolus should be delivered, for example, by depressing the button **3213**. In still other embodiments, the remote controller **3470** queries the user to confirm the bolus should be delivered.

(362) A similar query/response sequence may be used in various embodiments to test and report on patient responsiveness. For example, the device may be configured to test patient responsiveness by generating an alarm (e.g., an audible and/or tactile alarm) and awaiting a response from the patient (e.g., actuation of the button **3213**). Such a test may be performed at various times (e.g., every five minutes) or upon detection of a condition such as an abnormal analyte level monitored via an analyte sensor or an abnormal body temperature monitored via a temperature sensor. If the patient does not provide an appropriate response within a predetermined amount of time, the reusable portion may send an alarm to a remote controller or caretaker. Such testing and reporting might be particularly valuable for patients who could become unconscious or incapacitated, either from a device malfunction or otherwise.

(363) The NITINOL circuit (referring to the shape memory actuator, which in some embodiments, is a NITINOL strand) **278** on the main PCB **13** provides electrical current to the NITINOL connectors. As shown in FIG. 67F and FIG. 70A, the device can include two NITINOL connectors **278** (and two NITINOL strands). However, as described above, in some embodiments, the device includes one NITINOL connector (and one NITINOL strand).

(364) In some embodiments, the device includes a temperature sensor **3216** shown on FIG. 70B. The temperature sensor **3216** is located on the underside of the base **Y** and senses the temperature of the patient's skin. The skin temperature sensor **3216** is connected to a signal conditioner, represented by **3217**. As shown in FIG. 70B, the signal conditioning **3217** is represented as one block, however the device includes multiple signal conditioners, as needed, each filtering different the signals. Following, the AVS temperature sensor **132**, AVS microphones **133**, and analyte sensor **5020** are all connected to a signal conditioner, represented in one block as **3217**.

(365) The AVS speaker **134** is connected to the speaker drive **135** on the main PCB **13**. The AVS speaker **134**, in one embodiment, is a hearing aid speaker. However, in other embodiments, the speaker **134** (a speaker containing a voice coil, a magnet with an electromagnetic coil) is a piezo speaker (shown in FIG. 50, representing one embodiment of the device).

(366) Referring still to FIGS. 70-70D, in some embodiments, the antenna **3580** has a dedicated PCB **3581**, which is then connected to the main PCB **13**. Also, in some embodiments, the AVS microphones **133** each have a dedicated PCB **1332**, **1333**, connected to the main PCB **13**. The various PCBs may be connected to the main PCB **13** using conventional methods, for example, flexible circuits or wires.

(367) Referring to FIG. 67F, the device **10** is shown as an exemplary embodiment for description purposes. However, the layout of the various parts can vary and many of the embodiments are shown below. However, additional alternate embodiments are not shown but can be determined based on size, power and use.

(368) In accordance with an alternate embodiment, the disposable portion **2610** may include the reservoir **20** and optionally, a battery. The reservoir **20** may be integral to the disposable portion or otherwise coupled to the disposable portion. The battery may be the primary or sole power source for the device or may be a backup power source, and may be used to provide electrical power to electronics on the reusable portion and/or the disposable portion. Both the reservoir **20** and the battery will typically require regular replacement, so including both of these components in the disposable portion **2610** may provide to the user the increased convenience of simultaneous replacement. Additionally, by replacing the battery every time the reservoir is changed, the user may be less likely to allow the battery to run down.

(369) The disposable portion **2610** could additionally or alternatively include a processor that may be used, for example, to continue certain device operations in the event of a failure (e.g., a failure of a main controller in the reusable portion), to generate an alarm in the event of a failure, or to provide status information to the reusable portion. With regard to status information, the processor could keep track of the operation history and various characteristics of the disposable and hold status information for access by the user, the fluid delivery device **10**, and/or the user interface **14** including during installation of the disposable portion **2610**. For instance, the processor can store status related to shelf life, maximum exposure or operation temperature, manufacturer, safe dispensing limits for the therapeutic, etc. If any of these status indicators is determined by the device to be unacceptable, the device can refuse to power the pumping assembly and dispensing assembly and indicate to the user that the disposable is not usable. The processor may be powered by a battery in the reusable portion or the disposable portion.

(370) More generally, the device may be configured to obtain status information from any of the disposables (including, for example, the disposable portion **2610** and any disposable component used therewith, such as the fluid reservoir, battery, or sharps cartridge or individual sharps component), for example, from a processor disposed in disposable portion, via bar code reader, or via RFID technology. If the device detects a problem with the disposables (e.g., invalid model number for use with the reusable portion or an expiration date of the fluid has passed), then the device may take remedial action, such as, for example, preventing or terminating operation of the device and generating an appropriate alarm.

(371) Additional components may be included in some embodiments. For example, redundant failure detection and announcement mechanisms can be employed. The device may employ an audible alarm. The loudspeaker **1202** of the sensor **550** may be used for the audible alarm or an additional speaker may be included loudspeaker and used for the audible alarm. The device vibrating mechanism **3210** can also be used as an alarm. If a system failure is detected that requires immediate attention, both alarms can be activated. Additionally, a secondary battery or supercapacitor may be employed as a backup to the primary battery. If either battery fails, the controller can activate one or more alarms so that at least one announcement of battery failure occurs.

(372) The alarms can also be used to indicate to a user that the device is working properly. For example, a user might program the device for a bolus

delivery over a certain period of time. The user may desire to know that the programmed delivery is occurring properly. The processor can use the vibrating motor or an audio sound to indicate successful programmed delivery. Thus, some mechanisms can be employed in some embodiments of the device to provide feedback, whether positive or negative, to the patient or user.

(373) A microphone may also be used to detect any abnormal vibration or lack of normal vibrations and trigger an alarm condition. In various embodiments, a microphone of the acoustic volume sensing system may be used to perform such monitoring, or a separate microphone may be included for such monitoring. Periodic checks can also be performed to determine that the device is operating by checking for expected pump vibrations with the microphone. If improper vibrations are detected, or if proper vibrations are not detected by the microphone, an alarm can be activated.

(374) Referring now to FIG. 71, various components of a device 10 are shown schematically. In one embodiment of the device 10, a top X portion mates with a base portion Y and a reservoir 20 is sandwiched between the top X and base Y. The force of the sandwiching allows the reservoir septum 6272 to mate with the base portion Y. In some embodiments, both an infusion device 5010 and an analyte sensor 5020 are inserted through the base Y and into a patient (not shown).

(375) In many embodiments, the base Y and the reservoir 20 are disposable portions and the top X is a non-disposable portion. Both the infusion device 5010 and the analyte sensor are also disposable.

(376) As previously discussed, the patch pump device may be entirely or partially disposable. FIG. 72 shows an embodiment of a fluid delivery device 10 having disposable and non-disposable portions. In this embodiment, the disposable portion Y contains components that come into direct contact with the fluid, including the collapsible reservoir 20, pumping assembly (not shown), the variable volume dispensing chamber 122 (part of the dispensing assembly 120, located on the top X) and the flow restrictor (not shown), as well as one way valves (not shown) and a fluid path (not shown) connecting the reservoir to the pumping mechanism to the variable volume dispensing chamber 122. Additionally, the disposable portion Y includes a reservoir cavity 2645

(377) The reusable portion X includes elements of the dispensing assembly 120 except the variable volume dispensing chamber 122, which is located on the disposable portion Y. In some embodiments, the dispensing assembly 120 is an AVS assembly. The AVS assembly is described in detail above. Referring now to FIG. 73, an integrated acoustic volume measurement sensor is shown on a PCB.

(378) Referring now to FIG. 74, the device 10 shown in FIG. 49 is shown. The base disposable portion Y includes a reservoir cavity 2645. The top non-disposable portion X includes battery 15 and a dispensing assembly 120. A microphone 133 is shown as well as a diaphragm spring 130. In some embodiments, the dispensing assembly 120 includes more than one microphone. Although throughout this description, each microphone is referred to as 133, this does not infer that the microphones are always identical. In some embodiments, the microphones are the same, in other embodiments, the microphones are different.

(379) In the FIG. 74, the top non-disposable portion X also includes main PCB 13, a vibration motor 3210 and a pumping actuation member 54. The top, non-disposable portion X includes the AVS assembly or dispensing assembly 120. In FIG. 74, a microphone 133 is shown. The top, non-disposable portion X also includes a battery 15, which may be used to provide electrical power to electronics on the non-disposable portion and/or the disposable portion. In some embodiments, this battery 15 is rechargeable. Recharging can be done by methods described below. The disposable portion Y includes the wetted components including a fluid line (not shown) and the pumping assembly. In FIG. 74, only the pumping plunger 54 can be seen. This embodiment of the device 10 can also include many of the elements described above, including, but not limited to, a fluid impedance, a flexible membrane, a cannula housing and a sensor housing. Any pumping mechanism can be used.

(380) Referring now to FIG. 75, the device 10 is shown in another view where more elements are visible. In FIG. 75, the device 10 is shown with base disposable portion Y including a coiled microtubing flow restrictor 340 and a fluid line 310 connecting the inlet 21 and outlet 22 valves. The pumping actuation member 54 is also shown. The top X includes a main PCB 13, a vibration motor 3210, two microphones 133, a speaker 134, a reference chamber 127 and a fixed volume chamber 129. A battery 15 is also shown. Since choosing a very small diameter for the flow restrictor 340, may cause occlusion of the line 310 (for example, due to protein aggregates in a therapeutic fluid), it may be desirable to use a longer length of tubing with a larger diameter. However, in order to pack a longer length of tubing within a patch-sized housing, it may be necessary to bend the tubing in to form a tortuous path, e.g., a coiled or serpentine shape.

(381) Referring now to FIG. 76, an exploded view of the device 10 shown in FIGS. 72, 74 and 75 is shown. The top, non-disposable portion X is shown separated from the base disposable portion Y. In practice, a reservoir (not shown) would be placed in between the top X and base Y portions. Once the top X and base Y are assembled to form a device 10, the reservoir will become connected to the fluid line 310.

(382) Referring now to FIG. 77, an exploded view of another embodiment of a device 10 including a disposable base Y and non-disposable top X part is shown. Also included is a reservoir 20, an adhesive 3100 and a bridge 5040 apparatus holding an infusion device 5010 and a sensor 5020. This device 10 includes a more rounded footprint and a dome shape. A battery 15 and a main PCB 13 are shown located on the top X. The base Y includes a reservoir cavity 2645. An adhesive 3100 is shown in a two piece embodiment. The bridge 5040 is used to insert the infusion device 5010 and sensor 5020 through the base Y. The reservoir 20 is shown as having an irregular shape, however, in other embodiments, the reservoir 20 can have any shape and can vary in size according to the fluid capacity desired. In this embodiment of the device 10, the non wetted components are in the top non-disposable X and the wetted components are in the base disposable Y.

(383) When assembled, the device 10 may be adhered together using a center region of the adhesive (not shown). Alternately, the device 10 may be locked together mechanically using any of many embodiments described herein for latching. Although some embodiments are described below herein, many others will be apparent and as the shape of the device varies, in many cases, the latch will also.

(384) Referring now to FIG. 78, an exploded view of another embodiment of the device 10 is shown. The top non-disposable portion X is mostly dome shaped, however, a protrusion X1 is shown to accommodate the mechanisms inside the top X. Thus, the shape of the device can vary and can include polyps and protrusions, dimples and other texture-like features to accommodate various designs of the device.

(385) The reservoir 20, infusion device 5010 and sensor 5020 are shown. The infusion device 5010 and sensor 5020 can be inserted through the base Y and into a patient (not shown). The base Y is shown with an adhesive 3100 or pad 3220 underneath. In practice, the adhesive 3100 or pad 3220 can be first adhered to the skin and base Y. Next, the infusion device 5010 and sensor 5020 are inserted through the base Y into a patient (not shown, shown in FIG. 79 as 5020 and 5010). The reservoir 20 is then placed into the reservoir cavity 2645 either by first placing the reservoir 20 into the top X then sandwiching the top X and the base Y, or, placing the reservoir 20 into the reservoir cavity 2645 and then sandwiching the top X and the base Y. Either way can be used. The final result is the reservoir 20 becomes connected to the fluid line (not shown) located in the base Y through a septum (shown upside down) on the reservoir 20 and a septum needle (not shown, see 6272). The top X is then fastened to the base X either through use of an adhesive, or in this embodiment, mechanically using a latch 654 to clamp the top X and base Y together.

(386) The base Y includes those components that are wetted. The base Y is disposable. The top X includes non wetted components. The top X is non-disposable. Referring now to FIG. 79, the base Y includes a variable volume dispensing chamber 122, an inlet valve 21, and exit valve 22 and a pumping chamber 2350. As shown in this figure, those elements are shown as the membrane covering the area that acts as either the chambers or the valves. Thus, the base Y includes the membrane that securely maintains the wetted areas, thus, maintaining the non wetted areas as such in the top (not shown). As shown in FIG. 79, the sensor 5020 and the infusion device 5010 have been inserted into their respective housings and through the base Y to the patient (not shown). The base Y is shown with the reservoir cavity 2645, but the reservoir (not shown) need to be connected so that the fluid lines from the reservoir to the chamber and to the infusion device are connected.

(387) Referring now to FIG. 80, the top X of the device is shown. The top X includes those non wetted components including, as shown, a temperature sensor 3216, a diaphragm spring 130, an inlet valve poppet 21, and exit valve poppet 22 and a pumping actuation member 54. The top Y

also includes a relief **2640** to accommodate the reservoir (not shown).

(388) Referring now to FIGS. **81A-81C**, a sequence is shown to illustrate the process of sandwiching the reservoir **20** between the top X and base Y. As seen in FIG. **81A**, the top X as well as the reservoir **20** outside of the top X are shown. The reservoir includes a septum **6270**. The top X includes a reservoir relief **2640**. Next, as shown in FIG. **81B**, the top is prepared to sandwich with the base Y. Referring now to FIG. **81C**, the reservoir **20** is placed, septum side down, inside the base Y. The septum will connect with a cannulated septum needle (not shown) inside the base Y and connect the reservoir to the fluid line (not shown). In alternate embodiments, the reservoir may include a cannulated needle rather than a septum and the fluid path may include a reservoir interface with a septum rather than a cannulated needle.

(389) Referring next to FIG. **82**, the top X is shown with one embodiment of the pumping mechanism **16** exploded. The pumping mechanism **16** fits into the pumping mechanism housing **18** in the top X. The base Y is also shown as well as one part of the latch **654** that will clamp the top X and base Y together.

(390) Referring now to FIG. **83**, the base Y is shown with the fluid path assembly **166** as the membrane **2356** exploded from the base Y. This illustrates that in some embodiments of the device, the fluid path assembly **166** is a separate part that is inserted into the base Y and sandwiched with the membrane **2356**. Also shown in this figure, the adhesive or pad **3100/3220** in some embodiments, includes apertures for the infusion device and sensor (not shown). Referring now to FIG. **84**, a bottom view of the base Y is shown. The bottom of the fluid path assembly **166**.

(391) Referring now to FIGS. **85A** and **85B**, another embodiment of the device is shown. In this embodiment, the top X, also non-disposable, includes a bolus button **654**. The reservoir **20** is shown in an exploded view, however, in one embodiment, the reservoir **20** is built into the base Y. In another embodiment, the reservoir **20** is removable and placed into the reservoir cavity **2645** using a process similar to that described above with respect to another embodiment of the device.

(392) The base Y is disposable and includes the wetted parts of the device **10**. The sensor **5020**, the cannula **5010**, the variable volume dispensing chamber **122**, the inlet valve area **21**, the exit valve area **22** and the pumping chamber **2350**. The volume dispensing chamber, the inlet valve area **21**, the exit valve area **22** and the pumping chamber **2354** are all covered by membrane material, which may be in the form of a single membrane or distinct membranes.

(393) The device **10** is clamped together by a latch mechanism **654** on the top X and the base Y. Referring now to FIGS. **85C-85D**, the device **10** is the latching mechanism **654** is shown in an open position (FIG. **85C**) and a clamped or closed position (FIG. **85D**). The bolus button **3213**, as described in further detail above, can also be seen.

(394) A cover (not shown) may be provided for use in any of the embodiments of the device, to replace the reservoir and top portion when the reservoir is removed while the base is connected to the patient. The cover would not contain electrical components, thus, could be used in wet conditions. However, in some instances, the reservoir can be removed without the use of any cover.

(395) Cannula and Inserter

(396) FIG. **86A** schematically shows a representative embodiment of the infusion and sensor assembly **5040** including both an infusion device, which can be a cannula or a needle **5010** and an analyte sensor, which includes a sensor probe **5025** and a sensor base **5023**. A bridge **5070** rigidly joins an infusion cannula **5010** and the analyte sensor base **5023**. The infusion device **5010** is bounded on an upper side by a septum **5060** which allows for fluid to flow from a source and be administered through an infusion device **5010** to a patient. The sensor base **5023** is the section of the analyte sensor that is not inserted into the patient. In one embodiment, the base **5023** contains electronic contacts for the electrochemical analysis of blood glucose. A probe **5025** protrudes from the base **5023** of the analyte sensor **5020**.

(397) Referring now to FIG. **86B**, in this embodiment, the infusion device **5010** is a cannula that is introduced into the patient using an introducing needle **5240**. The introduction needle **5240** is inside the cannula **5010** when being inserted into a patient. After insertion of the cannula **5010** into the patient, the introduction needle **5240** is removed and the septum **5060** is sealed to a fluid source, which, in some embodiments of the device described herein, is the fluid line. In some embodiments, the sensor probe **5025** is associated with an introduction needle **5072** which aids in skin puncture for insertion of the sensor probe **5025**. The sensor introduction needle **5072**, in some embodiments, at least partially surrounds the sensor probe **5025** while the sensor probe **5025** is being inserted into a patient.

(398) In other embodiments, the infusion device **5010** is a needle and does not require an introduction needle **5240**. In these embodiments, the infusion device **5010** is inserted into the patient and the septum **5060** seals with a fluid source.

(399) In both FIGS. **86A** and **86B**, upon both the infusion device **5010** and sensor probe **5025** being lined up appropriately, force is applied to the bridge **5070**. This forces both the infusion device **5010** and sensor probe **5025** into the patient. Once in the patient, releases **5052** are actuated through holes, separating the infusion device **5010** and septum **5060**, as well as the sensor base **5023**, from the bridge **5070**. Referring to FIG. **86B**, where introduction needles **5240** and **5072** are used, they will typically remain attached to the bridge **5070** following insertion.

(400) The bridge can be made from any material desired, including plastic. The cannula can be any cannula in the art. The septum **5060** can be made from rubber or plastic and have any design capable of imparting the functions desired. In the embodiments where the infusion device is a needle, any needle may be used. In embodiments where introduction needles are used, any needle, needle device or introduction device can be used.

(401) The infusion and sensor assembly requires force be applied in order to be inserted into a patient. As well, the infusion and sensor assembly requires that the infusion device and sensor are released from the infusion and sensor assembly. Thus, both the force and the release can be actuated manually, i.e., a person performs these functions, or an insertion device may be used to actuate the assembly properly. Referring now to FIGS. **87A-87E**, an example of an inserter **5011** that can be manually operated is shown. The infusion device **5010** and sensor **5023** are held by the bridge **5070**. The inserter **5011** includes covers **5012** for both the infusion device **5010** and the sensor **5023**. As shown in FIGS. **87B-87E**, using the inserter **5011**, both the infusion device **5010** and the sensor **5023** are inserted through a device **10**. Although FIG. **87A** shows the sharps exposed, in some embodiments, the covers **5012** completely encase the sharps prior to the insertion process.

(402) The inserter **5011** could be operated manually, but could also be incorporated into another inserter device such that a mechanical advantage can be applied. Referring now to FIGS. **88A-88B**, one embodiment of an inserter device **5013** is used with an apparatus similar to the inserter **5012** shown in FIGS. **87A-87E**. The mechanism of the inserter device **5013** is shown in FIGS. **88C-88D**. An actuation lever **5014** either releases a spring (as shown in FIGS. **88C-88D**) or provides another mechanical advantage that allows for the inserter **5012** to be inserted through a device (not shown). The inserter **5012** will thus release the infusion device **5010** and sensor **5023** and then, the inserter **5012** can either be removed from the inserter device **5013** and the inserter device **5013** refilled, or, the inserter device **5013** and inserter **5012** can be discarded.

(403) Various insertion devices are described herein. However, in other embodiments, different insertion devices are used or the infusion device and sensor are introduced manually.

(404) Features may be included for securing the infusion and sensor assembly **5040** to an automatic inserter. For example, the releases shown in FIGS. **86A-86B** as **5052** may receive pins of an automatic insertion device. Referring to both FIGS. **89A** and **89B** a representative embodiment of an automatic inserter **5100** is shown. As shown in the front view of FIG. **89A**, the inserter **5100** includes pins **5130** which travel in pin slots **5140** within an inserting cartridge recess **5120**. In practice, the infusion and sensor assembly (not shown, shown in FIGS. **86A** and **86B** as **5040**) is pressed into the cartridge recess **5120**, causing pins **5130** to be inserted into the holes in the infusion and sensor assembly (shown as **5052** in FIGS. **86A** and **86B**). As shown in the rear view of FIG. **89B**, a cocking lever **5145** is used to ready the inserter **5100** for firing. The inserter **5100** is then either held against the skin or aligned with a cannula housing and sensor housing on a base (not shown) and fired by pressing a trigger **5110**. Upon firing, the pins **5130** travel in their slots **5140**, thereby forcing the infusion device and sensor (both not shown) into a patient. Inserter foot **5160** limits the downward travel of the infusion and sensor assembly. The inserter may also automatically withdraw the introduction needles (not shown, see FIG. **86B**) from the infusion and sensor assembly.

(405) The infusion and sensor assembly may be preloaded to an end user. As shown in FIG. 90, in other embodiments, a cartridge 5080 may be used to protect a user and to protect the sharps held in the assembly shown as 5040 in FIGS. 56A and 56B. Referring to both FIGS. 90 and FIGS. 86A-86B and FIG. 89A, in the cartridge embodiment 5080, the infusion and sensor assembly 5040 is embedded in the cartridge 5080. The cartridge 5080 is mounted in the cartridge recess 5120. The pins 5130 may project through the holes 5052 and into grooves 5090 in the cartridge 5080. Upon actuation of the inserter 5100, the pins travel within the grooves 5090 as the 5080 travels toward the patient to insert the sharps. The cartridge 5080 may be constructed of a rigid material.

(406) Referring now to FIGS. 91A-91C, several views of an embodiment of an inserter mechanism for an inserter, such as the one shown in FIGS. 89A and 89B as 5100, are shown. FIG. 91A shows a perspective view, FIG. 91B shows a front view, and FIG. 91C shows a side view of one embodiment of an inserter mechanism. The inserter 5100 has a cocking lever 5145, which connects via cocking linkages 5350 to a hammer cocking slide 5330, and is used to move the cocking slide 5330 to a charged position. A power spring 5390 connects the hammer cocking slide 5330 to a trigger 5110 and, when compressed, provides the downward force necessary for insertion of an infusion device or an infusion and sensor assembly (not shown). A trigger hammer 5340 is disposed under the hammer cocking slide 5330 and between a pair of cocking linkages 5350; the trigger hammer 5340 transmits the kinetic energy that is released from the power spring 5390 upon pressing the trigger 5110. The energized trigger hammer 5340 impacts a cartridge bolt 5380, positioned below. The cartridge bolt 5380 is linked to a cartridge housing 5370, which holds the cartridge, for example, the one shown in FIG. 90. The cartridge bolt 5380 is also disposed atop a return spring 5360 for returning the cartridge housing 5350 to a retracted position.

(407) FIGS. 92A-92F schematically show a time sequence for the cocking and firing of an inserter 5100 of the type described with reference to FIGS. 91A-91C. FIG. 92A shows the inserter 5100 in a resting position. Lowering the cocking lever (not shown, see FIG. 91A 5145) causes the hammer cocking slide 5330 to lower and engage the trigger hammer 5340. FIG. 92B shows the hammer cocking slide 5330 in a lowered position in which it is engaged with the trigger hammer 5340. Raising the cocking lever causes the hammer cocking slide 5330 and hammer 5340 to be raised, thus compressing the power spring 5390; the resulting position is shown in FIG. 92C. After ensuring the proper positioning of the inserter 5100 with respect to a base (not shown) and/or the skin of a patient, the trigger is pressed, thereby sending the trigger hammer 5340 downward; FIG. 92D shows the trigger hammer 5340 in transit. As shown in FIG. 92E, the trigger hammer 5340 impacts the cartridge bolt 5380, causing it to travel downward, insert the needle or needles held in the cartridge housing (not shown) and compress the return spring 5360. FIG. 92F shows the return spring 5360 in the process of forcing the cartridge bolt 5380 upward; this causes retraction of the cartridge housing and the cartridge contained therein (not shown) and any associated introduction needles used.

(408) Referring now to FIGS. 93A-93C, one embodiment of a temporal sequence for inserting and securing an infusion device (i.e., cannula or needle 5010) into a base Y is shown. FIG. 93A shows a base Y with a locking feature 5210 positioned above a cannula housing 5030. The base Y is typically positioned against the skin of a patient 5220 when inserting an infusion device or cannula 5010. FIG. 93B shows a cannula 5010 being forced through the cannula housing 5030 in the base Y. In this figure, an introduction needle 5240 is used that traverses a septum (not shown) and is positioned coaxially in the cannula 5010; a sharp point of the introduction needle 5240 emerges from the tip (not shown) of the cannula 5010 to help puncture a patient 5220. The resilient locking feature 5210 is pushed aside during insertion of the cannula 5010. FIG. 93C shows the cannula 5010 fully inserted through the cannula housing 5030 of the base Y, with the tip of the cannula fully inserted into the patient 5220. The introduction needle 5240 has been removed and the septum 5060 has self-sealed to a fluid source or fluid line (not shown). The resilient locking feature 5210 is engaged with the cannula 5010, thereby preventing the cannula 5010 from moving in relation to the base Y. Although FIGS. 93A-93C show a cannula 5010, the infusion and sensor assembly shown in FIG. 86B can be inserted using the locking feature 5210 and method shown and described in FIGS. 93A-93C.

(409) Referring now to FIGS. 92G-92H, an inserting cartridge bolt locking mechanism for use with an inserter, such as the one shown in FIGS. 91A-92F, as 5100 is shown. The cartridge bolt locking mechanism can function as an interlock to prevent accidental firing while the mechanism is being cocked. The locking mechanism includes a catch 5420, which when engaged in a catch recess 5410, prevents downward movement of the cartridge bolt 5380. As shown in FIG. 92G, when the cocking lever 5145 is in a closed position, the cocking lever 5145 contacts a catch lever 5440, which rotates the catch 5420 and prevents the catch 5420 from inserting into the catch recess 5410. A catch spring 5430, disposed between the catch 5420 and a catch spring support 5450, is in a compressed position. The cartridge bolt 5380 and trigger hammer 5340 are free to move. As shown in FIG. 92H, when the cocking lever 5145 is rotated into a downward position, the catch lever 5440 is released, thereby allowing the catch spring 5430 to force the catch 5420 to insert into the recess (here the catch 5420 is shown inside the recess, but the recess is shown in FIG. 92G as 5410); downward movement of the cartridge bolt 5380 is thereby prevented. Return of the cocking lever 5145 then returns the catch 5420 to an unlocked position. The cartridge bolt 5380 is then free for downward movement in the triggering process.

(410) Referring now to FIGS. 94A-94C, one embodiment of the process of mating a cannula 5010, where the cannula is a traditional cannula requiring an introduction needle (as shown in FIG. 86B) to the base Y and establishes fluid communication with a fluid line 310 is shown. FIG. 94A shows a sectional view of a cannula 5010 with two septa: an introduction needle septum 5062 and a fluid line septum 5270. The introduction needle septum 5062 seals a passageway 5280 leading to the hollow needle (not shown, shown in FIG. 94B as 5290) of the cannula 5010. A cannula introduction needle 5240 is shown positioned above the introduction needle septum 5062 and just prior to insertion of the introduction needle 5240.

(411) Referring now to FIG. 94B, the introduction needle 5240 is shown inserted through the introduction needle septum 5062. A user mates the cannula 5010 into the base Y, which has an upwardly-pointing rigid, hollow needle 5290. During insertion of the cannula 5010 into the base Y, the introduction needle 5240 punctures the fluid line septum 5270 to establish fluid communication between the fluid line 310 and the passageway 5280. If the base Y is held against a patient (not shown) during insertion of the cannula 5010 into the base Y, fluid communication between the fluid line 310 and the passageway 5280 will be established at about the same time that the patient's skin is pierced. Referring now to FIG. 94C, the cannula 5010 is shown, fully inserted into the base Y, with the introduction needle removed and fluid communication established with the fluid line 310.

(412) In an alternate embodiment, insertion of an infusion device and/or sensor is assisted by a vibration motor coordinated with a fluid delivery device. Simultaneously with the insertion of the infusion device and/or sensor, a vibration motor may be activated.

(413) Adhesion

(414) Referring now to FIG. 95 a top perspective view of one embodiment of an adhesive patch 3100 for securing an object, such as a fluid delivery device 10, to the skin of a patient (not shown) is shown. Although the adhesive patch 3100 is shown in the present shape, other shapes can be used. Any adhesive patch 3100 that can securely hold a fluid delivery device can be used.

(415) Fluid delivery device 10 is securely held under a central region 3130 of the adhesive patch 3100, which is attached to the skin of a patient by adhesive members 3111. These adhesive members 3111 emanate from a central region 3130 in a radial pattern and are spaced apart from each other by intervening regions 3121. The radial arrangement of the adhesive members 3111 allows for attachment of the device 10 to the patient in secure manner. In some embodiments, the central region 3130 covers the entire device 10, however, in other embodiments, the central region 3130 covers a portion of the device 10. The central region 3130 may also include interlocking attachment features (not shown) that may be held by complementary interlocking features (not shown) of the device 10. In an alternate embodiment, the device 10 is securely attached atop the central region 3130 (for example, by an adhesive or interlocking feature).

(416) The adhesive patch 3100 is typically flat and composed of a polymeric sheet or fabric. The adhesive patch 3100 may be supplied with adhesive affixed on one side and protected by a peelable backing such as a peelable sheet of plastic to which the adhesive will adhere more loosely than to the patch 3100. The backing may be a single continuous piece, or may be divided into regions that may be removed separately.

(417) In an illustrative embodiment, the backing for the central region 3130 may be removable without removing the backing to the adhesive

members **3111**. To use the adhesive patch **3100**, a user removes the backing of the central region **3130** and presses the device **10** against the newly exposed adhesive of the central region to attach the device **10** to the central region **3130**. The user then places the device against the skin, removes the backing from an adhesive member **3111**, affixes the adhesive member to the skin, and repeats the affixation process with additional members. A user may affix all of the adhesive members **3111** or only some of the members, and save additional adhesive members **3111** for application on another day. Since adhesives typically used for attachment to skin only remain securely attached for several days, application of sets of adhesive members **3111** on different days (for example, staggered by 3 to 5 days) should extend the amount of time that the device **10** remains securely attached to the skin and reduce the of time, expense and discomfort that is often involved in reapplication of the device. The varying tabs may have indicia such as different colors or numbers to indicate to the appropriate time to affix the various adhesive members **3111**. The adhesive members **3111** may include perforations to render them frangible with respect to the central region **3130** so that used adhesive members may be removed after use. Additional embodiments for extending the duration during which device **10** remains affixed are discussed above with reference to FIGS. **79-83**. (418) FIG. **96** schematically shows a sectional view of a fluid delivery device **10**, with an inserted cannula **5010**, held securely under an adhesive patch **3100**. A pad **3220** may be included between the device **10** and a patient's skin **3250** and allow air to flow to the skin. Air flow to skin may be increased by the inclusion of passageways **3230** in the pad **3220**. Passageways **3230** may also be formed by using multiple pads that are spaced apart or by constructing pad **3220** from a highly porous material. Thus, the pad **3220** can be any shape and size and in some embodiments, the pad **3220** is made up of a number of separate pieces. Pads **3220** may be either adhered to the underside of the device **10** during manufacture or may be adhered to the device **10** by a user. Alternately, the pad **3220** may be loosely placed onto the skin by a user prior to application of the adhesive patch **3100**. The pad **3220** may include a compliant material, such as porous polymeric foam.

(419) FIG. **97** shows an embodiment of the invention that uses a first adhesive patch **3100** and an additional adhesive patch **3300** to secure a device (not shown) to a patient. First, a device (not shown) is positioned for use and secured to the skin (not shown) of a patient with an adhesive patch **3100** using tab-like adhesive members **3111**. The central region **3130** may be positioned atop (as shown), or secured below, the device. After a period of time, either prolonged or short, a second adhesive patch **3300** is positioned so that its central region sits atop the first adhesive patch **3100** and the second adhesive patch's adhesive members **3320** are secured to the skin of the patient in the intervening regions between the first adhesive patch's adhesive members **3111**. Frangible regions may be provided to aid in the removal of loose or unwanted adhesive members **3111** associated with the earlier placed patch **3100**.

(420) Referring now to both FIGS. **98** and **99**, embodiments in which an adhesive patch **3100** has been divided into at least two smaller adhesive patches are shown. In these embodiments, the adhesive patch **3100** is divided into two adhesive patches, **3410** and **3420**, each having adhesive members **3111** radially arranged around a central void **3430**. The two adhesive patches, **3410** and **3420**, each span a semi-circle of about 180°, but other configurations could be used such as: three patches, each spanning 120° or four patches each spanning 90°. In some embodiments, the adhesive can include greater than four patches. The configurations described with respect to these embodiments follow the formula $360^\circ/n$ where n is the number of patches. But, in other embodiments, depending on the shape of the device, the formula shown and described here does not apply. In still other embodiments, the patches may also cover more than 360°, and thus overlap.

(421) As shown in the perspective view of FIG. **99**, due to the presence of a central void (not shown, shown in FIG. **98**), the central region **3130** is in the form of a thin strip for adherently positioning along the perimeter of the device **10**. The two patches, **3410** and **3420**, together securely attach the device **10** to the skin (not shown). As in the embodiment described with reference to FIG. **95**, air may flow between the adhesive members **3111** and under the device **10**, especially if passageways **3230** are provided.

(422) FIG. **100** shows a perspective view of an embodiment that includes using the multiple adhesive patches to extend the time during which a device **10** remains adhered to a patient (not shown) before removal. One of the multiple partial adhesive pads **3420** is removed while the device **10** is held in place (either by a remaining adhesive patch **3410** and/or by a user). The removed adhesive patch **3420** is then replaced with a fresh replacement adhesive patch (not shown). The replacement adhesive patch may be identical to the removed pad **3420** or may have adhesive members **3111** that are positioned in an alternate configuration to allow adhesion to the fresh skin between the areas previously covered by adhesive patch **3420**. The remaining adhesive patch **3410** may then be replaced in a similar manner. Indicia such as color coding may be used to indicate the age of the adhesive patches. The patches may also have a color change mechanism to indicate that their useful life has expired. Decorative patterns, such as images and designs, may be included on the patches.

(423) FIG. **101** schematically shows an embodiment in which multiple adhesive members **3111** are affixed to a patient **12** and also connected to a ring like central region **3130** via tethers **3730**. The tethers **3730** may be fibers or cords and may be resilient to decrease the movement of the device **10** in response to movement of the patient **12**. The use of tethers **3730** also increases options available for skin positions of the adhesive members **3111**.

(424) The adhesive used in the embodiments described in FIGS. **95-101** can be any effective and safe adhesive available for use on a patient's skin. However, in one embodiment, the adhesive used is 3M product number **9915**, value spunlace medical non woven tape.

(425) Clamping and Latching

(426) FIGS. **102A-102C** schematically show one mechanism for clamping or latching together a top portion and a base portion of a fluid delivery device. Referring first to FIG. **102A**, an elevation view of a clamp **6410** is shown. FIG. **102B** shows a base portion **Y** with keyholes **6440** for two clamps; corresponding keyholes may also be included in the top portion (not shown). Referring now to FIG. **102C**, the top **X** and the base **Y** may be aligned and a clamp **6410** may be inserted through the keyholes (not shown, shown in FIG. **102B** as **6440**). Rotating the clamp **6410** by 90° causes a stud bar **6430** to move into a locking position. Depressing a cam lever **6400** engages a cam **6415**, that is hingedly connected to a clamp pin **6420**, to push against the top **X**. As a result, the top **X** and the base **Y** are held with a clamping force between the cam **6415** and the stud bar **6430**. Raising the cam lever **6400** releases the clamping force and the clamp **6410** may be rotated by 90° and withdrawn to allow disassembly of the top **X** and base **Y**. In some embodiments, the lever may act as a protective cover for the top **X**.

(427) An alternate embodiment for clamping together the portions of a device is shown in FIGS. **103A-103D**. FIG. **103A** shows a perspective view and FIG. **103B** shows a top view of a cam guide **6500**. The cam guide **6500** has a keyhole **6440** and sloped surfaces **6510**. FIG. **103C** shows a cam follower **6520** having a central pin **6540** with a head **6560** attached at a first end and a bar **6550** attached to an opposite end. As shown in the sectional view of FIG. **103D**, the cam follower (not shown, shown in FIG. **103C**) may be inserted into keyholes (not shown, shown in FIG. **103C**) in the top **X**, base **Y**, and cam guide **6500**. Movement of a lever **6530** attached to the central pin **6540** causes rotation of the cam follower (not shown, shown in FIG. **103C**), causing the bar **6550** to travel along the sloped surface (not shown, shown in FIG. **103C** as **6510**) and thereby transforming the rotational force to a force which clamps the base **Y** and top **X** firmly between the cam follower head **6560** and the bar **6550**.

(428) Reservoir

(429) Exemplary embodiments of collapsible reservoirs for holding fluids are shown in FIGS. **104-106C**. The collapsible reservoir has at least one section or wall that collapses as fluid is withdrawn, thereby maintaining ambient pressure in its interior. In most embodiments, a sealable port (e.g., a septum) is included in the reservoir. The port allows the reservoir to be filled with fluid by a syringe and also, for a leak free connection to a fluid line. Alternately, an adaptor may be used to connect the reservoir with the fluid line. Alternately, as shown above with reference to FIG. **71**, a needle may be associated with the reservoir and a septum may be associated with the terminus of the fluid line. The reservoir may be constructed of a plastic material known to be compatible, even if for a very short duration, with the fluid contained in the reservoir. In some embodiments, the reservoir is entirely collapsible, i.e., the reservoir does not include any rigid body surfaces.

(430) Referring now to FIG. **104** a sectional view of a reservoir **20** is shown. A cavity **2645** for holding a volume of fluid is formed between a rigid reservoir body **6200** and a flexible reservoir membrane **6330**. The flexible membrane **6330** is sealingly attached around the periphery of the cavity

2645 to hold fluid within the cavity **2645**. The flexible membrane **6330** imparts collapsibility to the reservoir **20**; it deforms inwardly as fluid is pumped from the cavity **2645**.

(431) A septum **6270** is seated in a neck **6240** extending from the body **6200**. The septum **6270** serves as an interface between the cavity **2645** and a fluid line. In some devices, the fluid line terminates in a needle (not shown). In these embodiments, the needle may be inserted through the septum **6270** to access a needle chamber **6280** portion of the cavity **2645**. The septum **6270** location can be maintained by its location between a cap **6250** and a ledge (not shown) formed at the junction of the inner wall **6281** of the needle chamber **6280** and the cap bore **6282**. The cap **6250** may be held by a friction fit within the cap bore **6282**. Upon insertion of the cap **6250**, its position is limited by the wall **6261** of the cap bore **6282**. The portion of the cap **6250** closest to the septum **6270** may have a central aperture to allow insertion of the needle through the cap **6250** and into the septum **6270**. Alternately, the cap **6250** may be punctured by the needle.

(432) FIG. **105** shows a perspective view of the inside of the collapsible reservoir **20**. A rim **6230** allows attachment of the flexible reservoir membrane, which may be attached by welding, clamping, adhering, or other suitable method to create a fluid tight seal. A guard structure **6290** may be included to allow fluid to flow to or from the cavity **2645**, but prevents a needle from entering the cavity, thereby preventing it from possible puncture of the reservoir membrane.

(433) FIGS. **106A-106C** show an alternate embodiment of a reservoir in which a cap **6250** sealingly attaches a septum **6270** to a wall **6320** of a reservoir. The wall **6320** could be constructed, for example, from a flexible sheet such as PVC, silicone, polyethylene or from an ACLAR film. In some embodiments, the wall **6320** may be constructed from a heat formable polyethylene laminate formed with an ACLAR firm. The flexible sheet is compatible with the fluid. The wall may be attached to a rigid housing, or part of a flexible plastic pouch, such as may be formed by folding and welding the ends of a plastic sheet. FIG. **106A** shows the cap **6250** sealed to a wall **6320** via a circular fin **6350**. The septum **6270** may be inserted into a turret **6340** that protrudes from the cap **6250**. The turret **6340** may be constructed from a material that is deformable at high temperature, but rigid at room temperature, for example, low density polyethylene. Referring now to FIG. **106B**, a hot press **6310**, or another apparatus or process for melting, is used to melt or bend the turret **6340** over the septum **6270**. Referring now to FIG. **106C**, the septum **6270** is shown immobilized to the cap **6250**.

(434) Certain fluids are sensitive to storage conditions. For example, insulin may be somewhat stable in the glass vials in which it is typically shipped, but may be unstable when left in prolonged contact with certain plastics. In some embodiments, the reservoir **20** is constructed of such a plastic. In this case, the reservoir **20** may be filled with fluid just prior to use so that the fluid and plastic are in contact for a shorter period time.

(435) Reservoir Filling Station

(436) Referring now to FIG. **107** a reservoir filling station **7000** for filling a reservoir **20** with a fluid is shown. The fluid may be withdrawn from its original container with a syringe **7040** and introduced into the reservoir **20** by using the fill station **7000**. The fill station **7000** may include a substantially rigid fill station base **7010** hinged to a substantially rigid fill station cover **7020** via a hinge **7030**. Accordingly, the station **7000** may be opened and closed to accept and hold the reservoir **20**. A needle **7050** attached to the syringe **7040** may then be inserted through a filling aperture **7060** in the cover **7020**, and through the reservoir septum **6270**. Since the fill station cover **7020** is rigid, it establishes a limit of travel upon the syringe **7040** and therefore controls the depth of needle **7050** penetration into the reservoir **20** to discourage puncture of the underside of the reservoir **20**. A leg **7070** holds the station **7000** in a tilted position when supported on a surface. Since the station **7000** is tilted, as the fluid is injected from the syringe **7040** into the reservoir **20**, air will tend to rise upwardly toward the septum **6270**. After the syringe **7040** injects the desired amount of fluid into the reservoir **20**, the syringe **7040** may be used to remove any remaining air in the reservoir **20**. Since the fill station base **7010** and cover **7020** are rigid, the flexible reservoir **20** generally cannot be distended past a fixed volume and overfilling of the reservoir **20** is discouraged. The base **7010** and cover **7020** may be locked together with a clasp, or a heavy cover may be used to further discourage overexpansion and overfilling of the reservoir.

(437) Referring now to FIGS. **108A** and **108B**, an alternate embodiment of the reservoir filling station **7000** is shown. In this embodiment, the reservoir (not shown) is placed in the space between the cover **7020** and the base **7010**. A hinge **7030** attached the cover **7020** and the base **7010**. As shown in FIG. **108B**, the reservoir (not shown) is inside, and a syringe (not shown) needle (not shown) is inserted into the filling aperture **7060**. The filling aperture **7060** connects directly to the reservoir's septum (not shown). A viewing window **7021** indicates the fluid line in terms of the volume of fluid that has been injected into the reservoir.

(438) A fluid delivery system typically includes a fluid delivery device and an external user interface, although in some embodiments a complete or partial internal user interface is included in the device. The device can be any device as described herein or a variation thereof.

(439) FIG. **109A** shows a flow diagram of a data acquisition and control scheme for an exemplary embodiment of a fluid delivery system. A patient or caregiver utilizes an external user interface **14** which is typically a base station or hand held unit housed separately from the fluid delivery device **10**. In some embodiments, the user interface **14** is integrated with a computer, cell phone, personal digital assistance, or other consumer device. The user interface assembly may be in continuous or intermittent data communication with the fluid delivery device **10** via wireless radio frequency transmission (for example, via LF, RF, or standard wireless protocols such as "Bluetooth") but could also be connected via data cable, optical connection or other suitable data connection. The external user interface **14** communicates with a processor **1504** to input control parameters such as body mass, fluid dose ranges or other data and receives status and function updates such as the presence of any error conditions resulting from occluded flow, leaks, empty reservoir, poor battery condition, need for maintenance, passage of an expiration date, total amount of fluid delivered or remaining or unauthorized disposable component. The interface **14** may transmit error signals to a patient's guardian or medical professional through a telephone, email, pager, instant messaging, or other suitable communication medium. A reservoir actuator assembly **1519** includes an actuator **1518** and a reservoir **1520**. The dispensing assembly **120** transmits data related to flow through the flow line to the processor **1504**. The processor **1504** uses the flow data to adjust the action of the actuator **1518** in order to increase or decrease flow from the reservoir pump assembly **1519** to approximate the desired dosage and timing. Optionally, a feedback controller **1506** of the processor **1504** may receive data related to the operation of the reservoir pump assembly **1519** for detection of conditions such as open or short circuit faults, or actuator temperature.

(440) FIG. **109B** shows an alternate embodiment of the flow diagram in FIG. **102A**. In this embodiment, the lack of dispensing assembly/sensor removes the feedback based on volume of fluid.

(441) Referring now to FIG. **110A**, a flow chart of one embodiment of the overall operation of a fluid delivery device within the fluid delivery system is shown. A user starts **2800** the system using a switch or from an external user interface (step **2800**). The system initializes by loading default values, running system tests (step **2810**) and obtaining variable parameters such as desired basal and bolus doses. Variable parameters may be selected by the user using the user interface, either using an input device such as a touch screen on the user interface or by loading saved parameters from memory (step **2820**). The actuator timing is calculated based on the predicted or calibrated performance of the fluid delivery device (step **2830**). The dispensing assembly is initiated at the start of the fluid delivery device activation (step **2840**). Dispensing assembly data collection **2835** continues through actuation and delivery. During operation, the dispensing assembly provides data that allows determination of the cumulative volume of fluid that has flowed through the dispensing chamber as well as the flow rate for one or more time periods. The fluid delivery device is activated to cause fluid to flow through the flow line into the dispensing chamber (step **2840**). Drug flows from the dispensing chamber to the patient at a rate determined by the impedance of the exit, and in some embodiments, the force exerted by a diaphragm spring, and the force exerted by the pumping assembly (step **2860**). The system will stop and the user will be notified if there is a user stop interrupt, a low flow condition, the reservoir is determined to be empty based on predicted cumulative flow or detection by an additional reservoir volume sensor, or any other alarm operation either part of the system or user specified (step **2870**). If there is no user stop signal, determination of an empty reservoir or another alarm indicator, then a check is made to determine if an adjustment to the actuator timing is needed due to a deviation between the actual and desired flow rate or due

to a change in desired flow rate by the user (step 2880). If no adjustment is needed, the process instead returns to step 2830. Referring now to FIG. 110B, a flow chart of another embodiment of the overall operation of a fluid delivery device within the fluid delivery system is shown. In this embodiment, the decision to adjust the actuation timing is made based on a user inputted variation or on another feedback. In this embodiment, a dispensing assembly with a sensor for determining volume is not included; thus the adjustments are made based on alternative feedback mechanisms.

(442) Wireless Communication

(443) Referring now to FIG. 111 a layout of an embodiment using coils for inductive charging and wireless communication in a fluid delivery system is shown. As previously described, the user interface assembly 14 can be embodied as a hand held user interface assembly 14 that wirelessly communicates with the fluid delivery device 10. A secondary coil (i.e. a solenoid) 3560 may be employed in the fluid delivery device 10 as a wireless transceiver antenna in conjunction with wireless controller 3580. The secondary coil 3560 may also serve as a secondary transformer for recharging the device battery 3150, at least partially, in conjunction with a battery recharging circuit 3540. In this embodiment, the user interface assembly 14 contains a primary coil 3490 for inductively coupling energy to a secondary coil 3560. When the user interface assembly 14 is in close proximity to the fluid delivery device 10, the primary coil 3490 energizes the secondary coil 3560. The energized secondary coil 3560 powers a battery recharging circuit 3540 for recharging the battery 3150 in the fluid delivery device 10. In some embodiments, the primary coil 3490 also functions as an antenna to transmit and receive information from the fluid delivery device 10 in conjunction with a wireless controller 3470.

(444) Referring now to FIG. 112, some embodiments include long range wireless communication (e.g., 20-200 ft or more) hardware in the fluid delivery device 10. Thus, the fluid delivery device 10 could be monitored from a distance.

(445) Still referring to FIG. 112, an intermediate transceiver 6600, typically carried by the patient, can provide the benefits of long range communication without increasing the size, weight and power consumption of the fluid delivery device 10. As shown in the data flow diagram of FIG. 112, a wearable fluid delivery device 10 uses short range hardware and associated software to transmit data to, or receive data from, the intermediate transceiver 6600. For example, the device 10 may be equipped to transmit data over distances of approximately 3-10 ft. The intermediate transceiver 6600 may then receive this data and use long range hardware and software to relay this data to a user interface assembly 14. The intermediate transceiver 6600 may also accept control signals from the user interface assembly 14 and relay these signals to the device 10. Optionally, the user interface assembly 14 may also be capable of communicating directly with the fluid delivery device 10, when in range. This direct communication may be configured to occur only when the intermediate transceiver 6600 is not detected, or alternatively, anytime the user interface assembly 14 and the fluid delivery device are within range of each other.

(446) Many types of data may be transmitted in this way, which include, but are not limited to: Data related to the timing of pump actuation and volume measurements and other data from the dispensing assembly may be transmitted to the intermediate transceiver 6600 and, in turn, to the user interface assembly 14; Alarm signals may be transmitted to and from the fluid delivery device 10; Signals to confirm the receipt of data may be transmitted from the user interface 14 to the intermediate transceiver 6600 and from the intermediate transceiver 6600 to the fluid delivery device 10; Control signals to change the operating parameters of the device 10 may be transmitted from the user interface assembly 14 to the fluid delivery device 10 using the intermediate transceiver 6600.

(447) Referring now to FIG. 113, a plan diagram of a specific embodiment of an intermediate transceiver 6600 is shown. A short range transceiver 6610 communicates with a nearby fluid delivery device. The short range transceivers of the device and the intermediate transceiver 6600 may communicate using one or more of many protocols and transmission frequencies known to be useful for short range communication, e.g. radio frequency transmission. Data received by the intermediate transceiver 6600 is conveyed to a microprocessor 6630, which may store the data in memory 6620 (e.g., a flash memory chip), and retrieve the data as needed. The microprocessor 6630 is also connected to a long range transceiver 6640, which is in data communication with the user interface. For example, the intermediate transceiver 6600 and user interface assembly may operate on the Bluetooth standard which is a spread-spectrum protocol that uses a radio frequency of about 2.45 MHz and may operate over a distance of up to about 30 feet. The Zigbee standard is an alternative standard that operates in the ISM bands around 2.4 GHz, 915 MHz, and 868 MHz. However, any wireless communication could be used.

(448) Optionally, the microprocessor 6630 analyzes received data to detect the presence of malfunctions or maintenance needs associated with the device. Some examples of fault conditions include, but are not limited to: a lack of received data for a time period that exceeds a set limit; a lack of data receipt confirmation signal from the device or the user interface assembly; an overflow or near overflow condition of the appliance memory 6620; low power; overly high, low or improperly timed volume measurements received from the fluid delivery device 10.

(449) Based on this fault analysis, the microprocessor 6630 may trigger an alarm 6650 (e.g., a bell or buzzer). The microprocessor 6630 may also communicate an alarm condition to a remote device. The remote device may be, for example, the user interface assembly using the long range transceiver 6640, the fluid delivery device 10 using the short range transceiver, or both the user interface assembly and fluid delivery device. Upon receiving an alarm signal, the user interface assembly may then relay the alarm signal over longer distances to a medical professional or patient guardian (e.g., by pager or telephone call or other methods of communication).

(450) The power supply 6670 may be rechargeable, and may store sufficient energy to operate continuously for a period of time, for example, at least 10 hours. However, the operation time will vary based on use and device. The size of the fluid delivery device may be reduced so that it may easily be carried in a pocket, purse, briefcase, backpack or the like. One embodiment of the device includes a means to withstand routine shocks or spills. Additional features may be included in some embodiments, including, but not limited to, decorative features, or any of a wide range of consumer electronics capabilities such as the ability to play video games, send and receive instant messages, watch digital video, play music, etc. Third party controls may be included to remove or limit the use of such functions during some or all hours of the day. Alternately, the device may be as small and simple as possible, and only serve to repeat short range signals over a longer range. For example, the memory and analysis capability may be omitted.

(451) Referring now to FIG. 114, a data flow diagram for an embodiment of the system is shown. An intermediate transceiver 6600 is shown operating as a universal patient interface that engages in short range communication with multiple devices and relays information from those devices over a long range to one or more user interfaces associated with those devices. Examples of devices include wearable, implantable or internal medical devices including a fluid delivery system, a glucose sensor, a knee joint with an integrated strain sensor, an instrumented enteric probe in pill form, a defibrillator, a pacemaker, and other wearable therapeutic delivery devices. Since different types of devices and devices from different manufacturers may utilize differing short range communication standards and frequencies, the intermediate transceiver 6600 may include hardware (e.g., multiple antennas and circuitry), and software to support multiple protocols.

(452) Battery Recharger

(453) Referring now to FIGS. 115 and 116. One embodiment of an apparatus is shown for recharging the battery 7100. In FIG. 115, the top, non-disposable portion of a fluid delivery device 2620 is shown disconnected from the base, disposable portion of a fluid delivery device. The battery recharger 7100 is used to recharge the battery (not shown) in the top 2620. In FIG. 116, the top 2620 is shown on the battery recharger 7100. The latches 6530 are shown closed, connecting the top 2620 to the battery recharger 7100. Thus, the latch 6530 used to connect a top portion 2620 to a base portion (not shown) is also used to connect the top 2620 to the battery recharger 7100. Docking may establish a direct power connection, or power may be transferred by way of inductive coupling. Also, in some embodiments of the system, the patient employs multiple non-disposable portions 2620 in rotation; i.e., recharging one non-disposable portion 2620, while using a second non-disposable portion (not shown).

(454) The various embodiments described herein include different types and configurations of elements such as, for example, pump architectures, pump actuators, volume sensors, flow restrictors, reservoirs (and reservoir interfaces), sharps inserters, housings, latching mechanisms, user

interfaces, on-board peripherals (e.g., controllers, power sources, network interfaces, sensors), and other peripherals (e.g., hand-held remote controller, base station, repeater, filling station). It should be noted that alternative embodiments may incorporate various combinations of such elements. Thus, for example, a pump architecture described with reference to one embodiment (e.g., the pump shown and described with reference to FIGS. 15A-15D) may be used with any of the various configurations of pump actuators (e.g., single shape-memory actuator with single mode of operation, single shape-memory actuator with multiple modes of operation, multiple shape-memory actuators of the same size or different sizes), and may be used in devices with various combinations of other elements (or absence of other elements) and/or any of the various flow restrictors.

(455) Furthermore, while various embodiments are described herein with reference to a non-pressurized reservoir, it should be noted that a pressurized reservoir may be used in certain embodiments or under certain conditions (e.g., during priming and/or air purging). Among other things, a pressurized reservoir might facilitate filling of the pump chamber, for example, following retraction of the pump actuation member 54 shown and described with reference to FIGS. 15A-15D.

(456) Additionally, while various embodiments are described herein with reference to a pump motor disposed in a reusable portion of a housing, it should be noted that a pump and/or a pump motor may alternatively be situated in the disposable portion, for example, along with various components that come into contact with the fluid. As with some of the other motors described herein, a motor disposed in the disposable portion may include one or more shape-memory actuators.

(457) It should be noted that section headings are included for convenience and are not intended to limit the scope of the invention.

(458) In various embodiments, the herein disclosed methods including those for controlling and measuring flow of a fluid and for establishing communication amongst linked components may be implemented as a computer program product for use with a suitable controller or other computer system (referred to generally herein as a "computer system"). Such implementations may include a series of computer instructions fixed either on a tangible medium, such as a computer readable medium (e.g., a diskette, CD-ROM, ROM, EPROM, EEPROM, or fixed disk) or transmittable to a computer system, via a modem or other interface device, such as a communications adapter connected to a network over a medium. The medium may be either a tangible medium (e.g., optical or analog communications lines) or a medium implemented with wireless techniques (e.g., microwave, infrared or other transmission techniques). The series of computer instructions may embody desired functionalities previously described herein with respect to the system. Those skilled in the art should appreciate that such computer instructions can be written in a number of programming languages for use with many computer architectures or operating systems.

(459) Furthermore, such instructions may be stored in any memory device, such as semiconductor, magnetic, optical or other memory devices, and may be transmitted using any communications technology, such as optical, infrared, acoustic, radio, microwave, or other transmission technologies. It is expected that such a computer program product may be distributed as a removable medium with accompanying printed or electronic documentation (e.g., shrink wrapped software), preloaded with a computer system (e.g., on system ROM, EPROM, EEPROM, or fixed disk), or distributed from a server or electronic bulletin board over the network (e.g., the Internet or World Wide Web). Of course, some embodiments of the invention may be implemented as a combination of both software (e.g., a computer program product) and hardware. Still other embodiments of the invention are implemented as entirely hardware, or substantially in software (e.g., a computer program product).

(460) It should be noted that dimensions, sizes, and quantities listed herein are exemplary, and the present invention is in no way limited thereto. In an exemplary embodiment of the invention, a patch-sized fluid delivery device may be approximately 6.35 cm (~2.5 in) in length, approximately 3.8 cm (~1.5 in) in width, and approximately 1.9 cm (~0.75 in) in height, although, again, these dimensions are merely exemplary, and dimensions can vary widely for different embodiments.

(461) While the principles of the invention have been described herein, it is to be understood by those skilled in the art that this description is made only by way of example and not as a limitation as to the scope of the invention. Other embodiments are contemplated within the scope of the present invention in addition to the exemplary embodiments shown and described herein. Modifications and substitutions by one of ordinary skill in the art are considered to be within the scope of the present invention.

Claims

1. A system for pumping a medical fluid through a line in an infusion pump, the system comprising: a pumping chamber in the infusion pump comprising: an inlet in fluid connection with a fluid source; and a pump outlet; an inlet sealing member comprising a sealing spring; a pump compressing member comprising a return spring; and a pump plate directly attached to the inlet sealing member and the pump compressing member; wherein during a compressive stroke the pump compressing member is driven towards the pumping chamber and the sealing spring transmits a driving force to the inlet sealing member, and wherein the compressive stroke causes a restriction of retrograde flow of fluid from the pumping chamber through the inlet and causes an increase in pressure within the pumping chamber.
2. A system according to claim 1, further comprising an exit valve outside of the fluid line adapted to control fluid flow through the pump outlet.
3. A system according to claim 2, wherein the increase in pressure within the pumping chamber opens the exit valve and urges fluid from the pumping chamber to the pump outlet.
4. A system according to claim 1, wherein the inlet sealing member and the pump compressing member are part of a force application assembly.
5. A system according to claim 1, wherein the pump plate is part of a driving member that actuates both the inlet sealing member and the pump compressing member.
6. A system according to claim 5, wherein the driving member includes a shape-memory actuator.
7. A system according to claim 6, wherein the driving member includes at least one pulley for folding the shape-memory actuator to fit within a reusable portion.
8. A system according to claim 5, wherein the driving member includes a motor.
9. A system according to claim 8, wherein the motor includes a shape-memory actuator.
10. A system according to claim 9, wherein the shape-memory actuator is electrically coupled so as to provide a plurality of electrical paths of different lengths through the shape-memory actuator.
11. A system according to claim 8, wherein the pump plate is coupled to the driving member for coordinated operation of the inlet sealing member and the pump compressing member.
12. A system according to claim 10, wherein the inlet sealing member and the pump compressing member are part of a force application assembly, wherein the force application assembly has a normal mode for operating the pumping chamber under normal pumping conditions and a priming mode for priming the pumping chamber, and wherein a shorter electrical path of the shape-memory actuator is used during the normal mode of the force application assembly and a longer electrical path is used during the priming mode of the force application assembly.
13. A system according to claim 8, wherein the motor includes a plurality of shape-memory actuators.
14. A system according to claim 13, wherein the inlet sealing member and the pump compressing member are part of a force application assembly, wherein the plurality of shape-memory actuators provide for redundant operation of the force application assembly.
15. A system according to claim 13, wherein different numbers of shape-memory actuators are used to provide different actuation forces or stroke lengths.
16. A system according to claim 13, wherein the plurality of shape-memory actuators includes shape-memory actuators of at least two different lengths.

17. A system according to claim 1, further comprising a downstream dispensing assembly in series with the pump outlet, the dispensing assembly comprising a resilient dispensing chamber.
18. A system according to claim 17, further comprising a sensor for measuring a parameter related to flow through the line.
19. A system according to claim 17, further comprising a tortuous high-impedance conduit located downstream of the dispensing assembly.
20. A system according to claim 4, wherein at least a portion of the line is integral to a disposable component, the force application assembly is integral to a detachable reusable component, and the system further comprising a membrane material on the disposable component contiguous to the reusable component.
21. A system according to claim 1, wherein the sealing spring is compressed while the pump compressing member exerts a pumping force upon the pumping chamber.
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